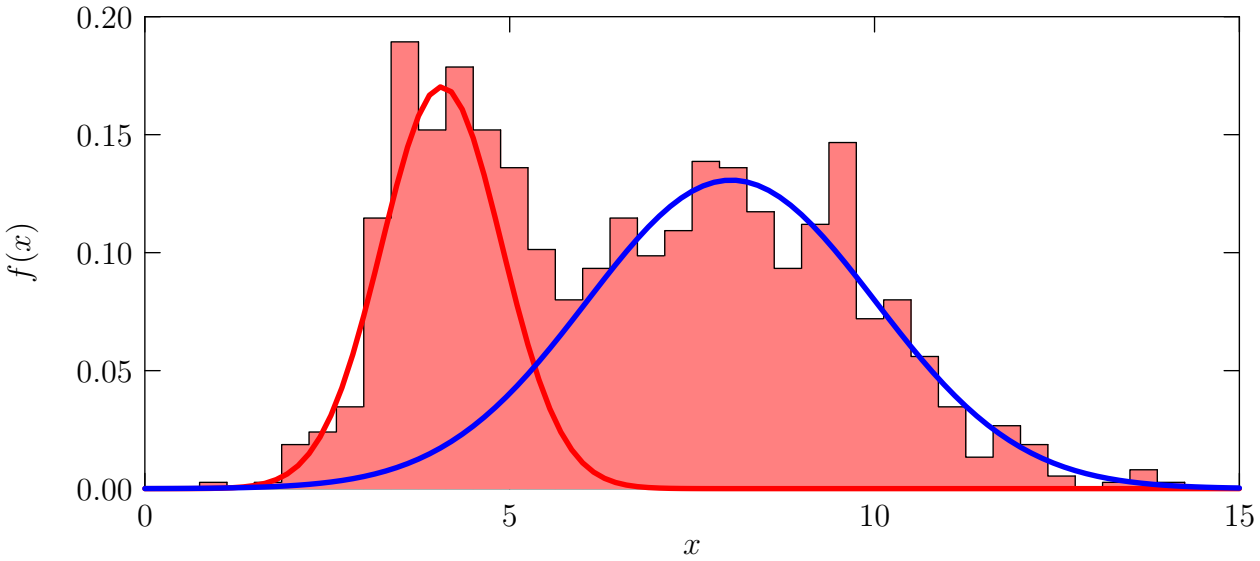
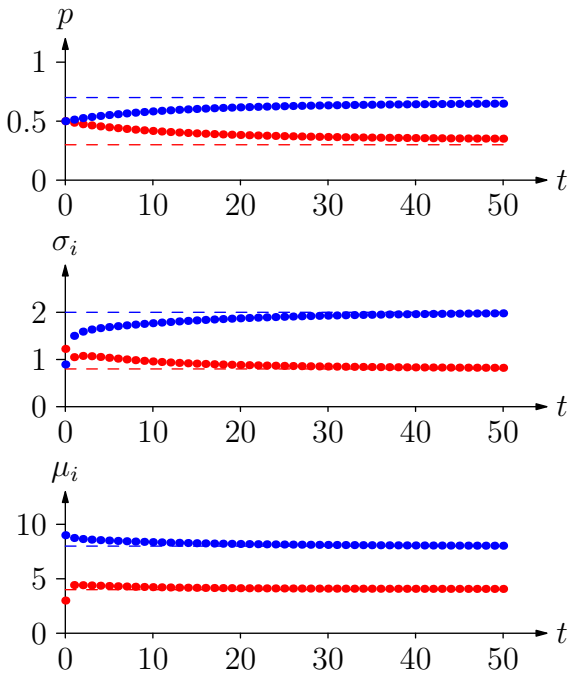
Mathematics of Machine Learning

Probabilistic Inference

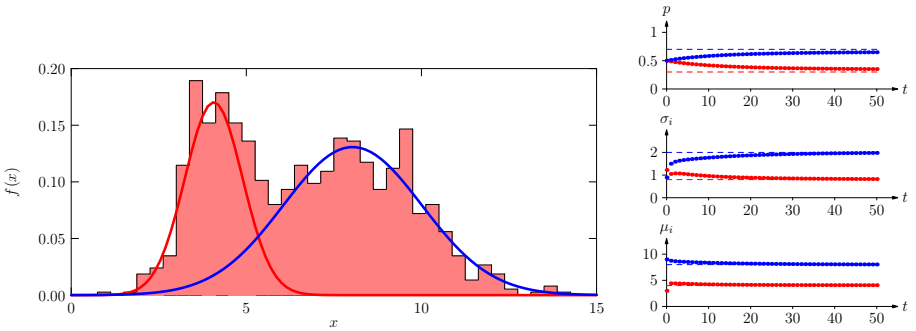




Generative Models, Hierarchical Models, MAP, Empirical Bayes, Mixture of Gaussians, Expectation Maximisation

Outline

1. **Building Probabilistic Models**
2. Hierarchical Models
3. Solution Strategies
4. Mixtures and EM



Beyond Conjugate Priors

- In the Bayes lecture we chose priors so that the posterior had the same form (conjugate priors)
- Real problems have many interacting random variables, some of which we never observe, and the posterior has no closed form
- This lecture: how to set up a probabilistic model, and simple strategies for using it (MAP, empirical Bayes, EM)
- The MCMC lecture shows how to compute the full posterior

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Two Rules

- Sum rule (marginalisation; see the probability lecture)

$$\mathbb{P}(X) = \sum_Y \mathbb{P}(X,Y) \qquad f(x) = \int f(x,y)\mathrm{d}y$$

- Product rule (the definition of conditional probability)

$$\mathbb{P}(X,Y) = \mathbb{P}(X|Y)\mathbb{P}(Y) = \mathbb{P}(Y|X)\mathbb{P}(X)$$

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- A **discriminative model** gives the prediction directly, e.g. $\mathbb{P}(C|\boldsymbol{x})$ for a class C given features $\boldsymbol{x}$

- A **generative model** describes how the features and the output are generated together: $\mathbb{P}(\boldsymbol{X}, Y)$

- Generative models are often more natural to think about

- And we can still use them to discriminate

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- If we have a latent variable Z and observed variable $\boldsymbol{X}$ and we are predicting a variable Y then we would **marginalise** over the latent variable

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Generative Stories

- Build a model by writing down how the data could have been generated (a simulator), each line drawing one variable given earlier ones

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theta = rng.beta(a, b, size=J)     # a rate for each product
k = rng.binomial(n, theta)         # observed positive reviews
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- The joint distribution is the product of the lines (product rule)

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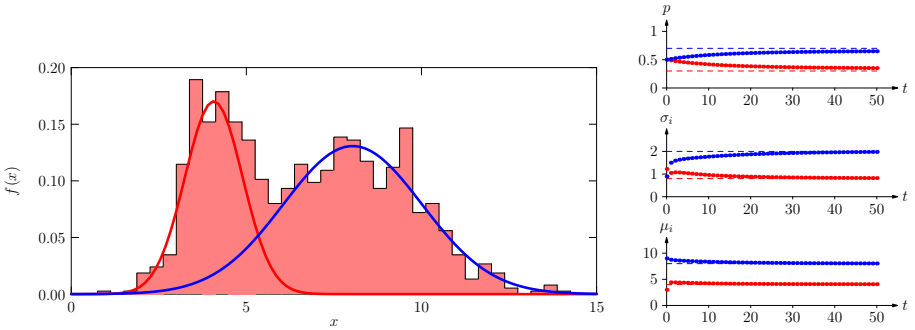
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Rating Products

- A shop lists products with the fraction of positive reviews: which is better?

	positive	fraction
Product A	3 of 3	100%
Product B	1840 of 2000	92%

- Ranking by the fraction puts every product with a handful of good reviews at the top
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A Model for Ratings

- Product j has an unknown probability θ_j that a review is positive; k_j of its n_j reviews are positive

$$k_j \sim \mathrm{Bin}(n_j, \theta_j)$$

- The products are different but similar: their θ_j come from a common population

$$\theta_j \sim \mathrm{Beta}(a, b)$$

- The **hyperparameters** a, b describe the population: $a/(a+b)$ is the typical rate and $a+b$ measures how alike the products are

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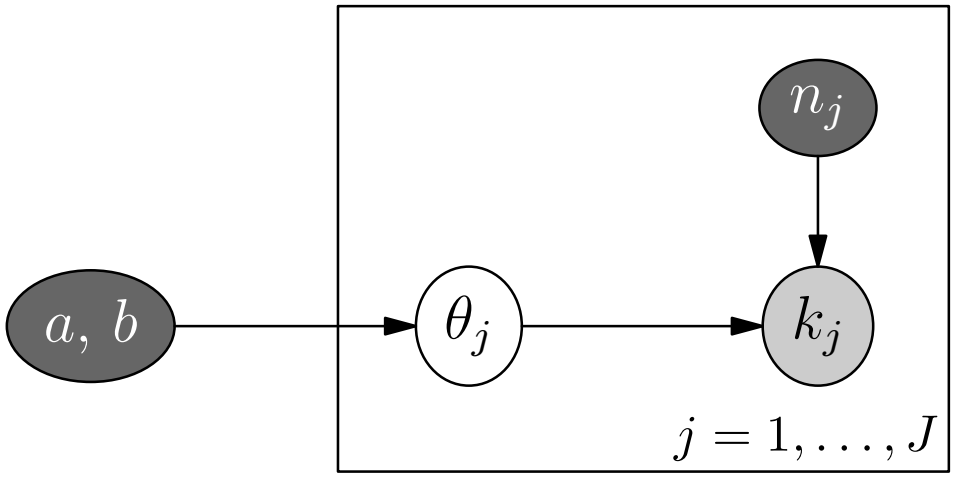
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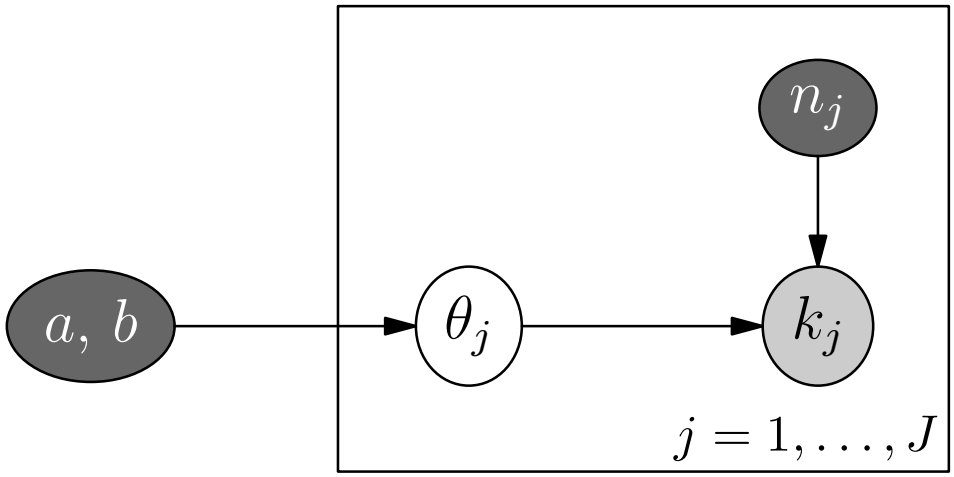
- The model has levels: population $\rightarrow$ product $\rightarrow$ reviews (a **hierarchical model**)

Graphical Models



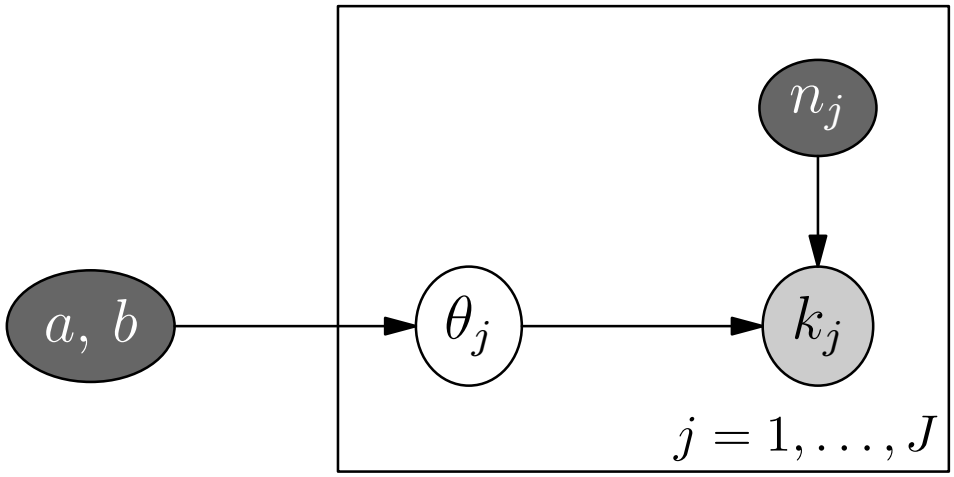
- Nodes are variables (dark: fixed; shaded: observed; white: latent); arrows point from the variables each one is drawn from
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- The joint distribution is the product over nodes of each node given its parents
- Diagrams like this are a good way to design and explain models

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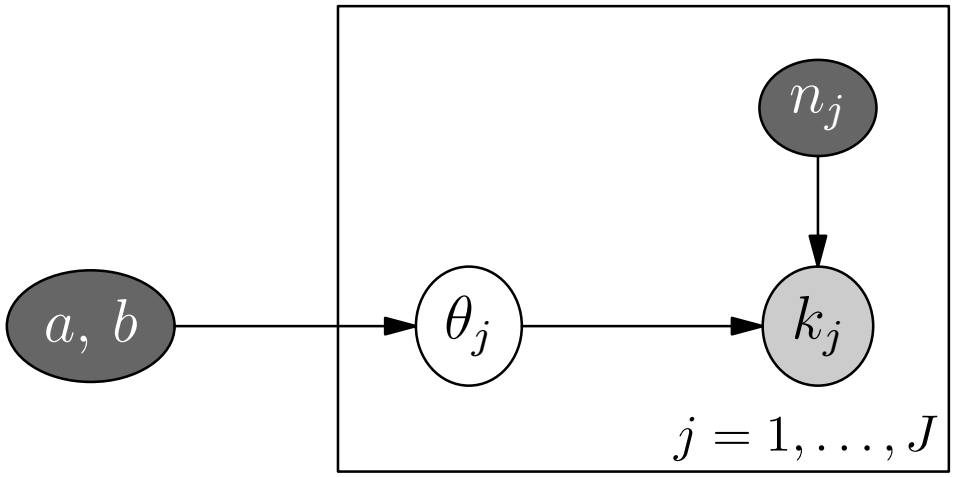
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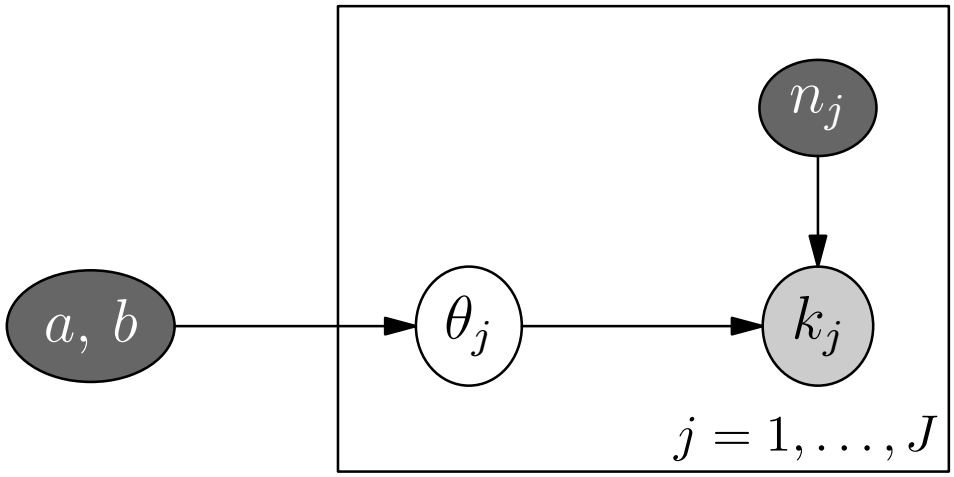
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One Product at a Time

- If we knew a and b, each product is a beta-binomial problem from the Bayes lecture

$$f(\theta_j|k_j) = \mathrm{Beta}(\theta_j|a+k_j, b+n_j-k_j)$$

- The posterior mean is a weighted average: the prior counts as $a+b$ extra reviews

$$\mathbb{E}[\theta_j|k_j] = \frac{a+k_j}{a+b+n_j} = \frac{a+b}{a+b+n_j}\frac{a}{a+b} + \frac{n_j}{a+b+n_j}\frac{k_j}{n_j}$$

- With $a=20$, $b=5$ (typical rate 0.8, worth 25 reviews): A gets $23/28 = 0.82$

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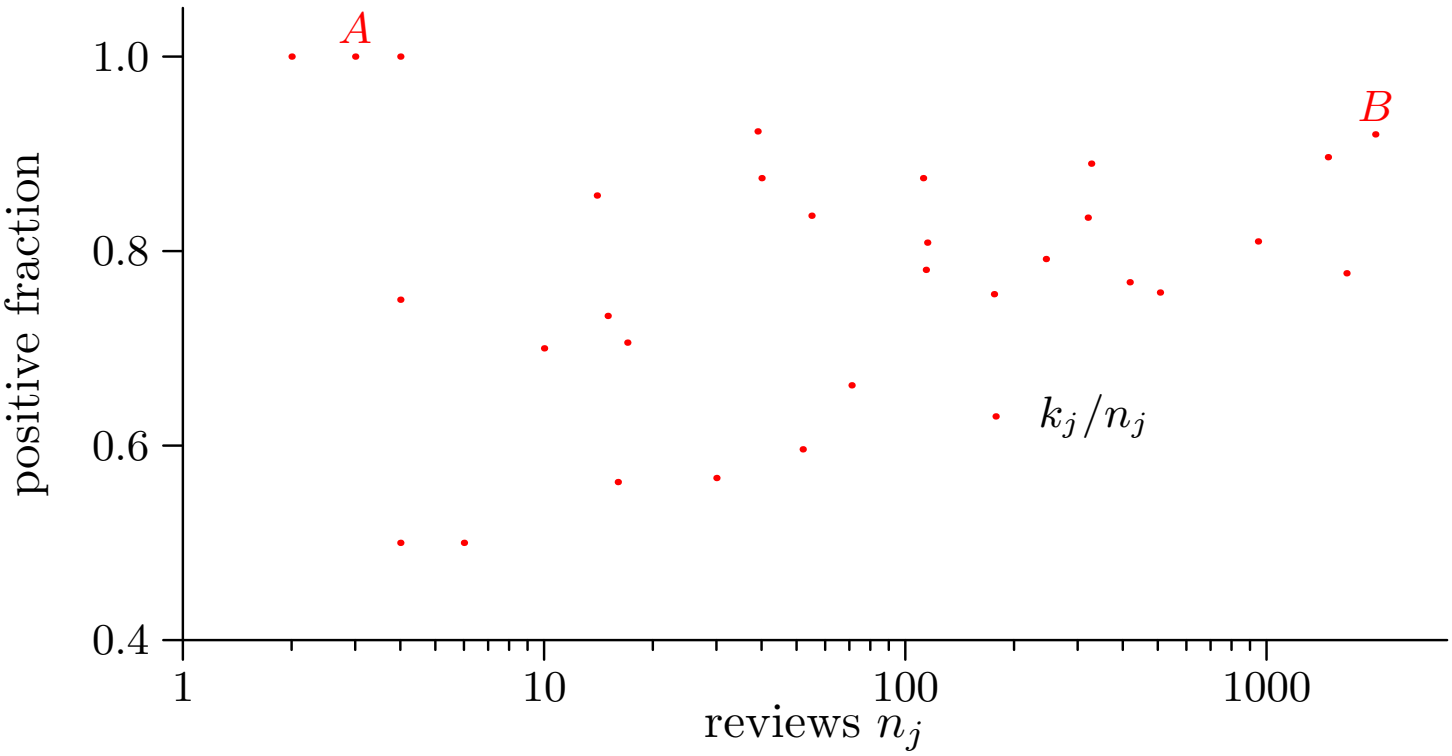
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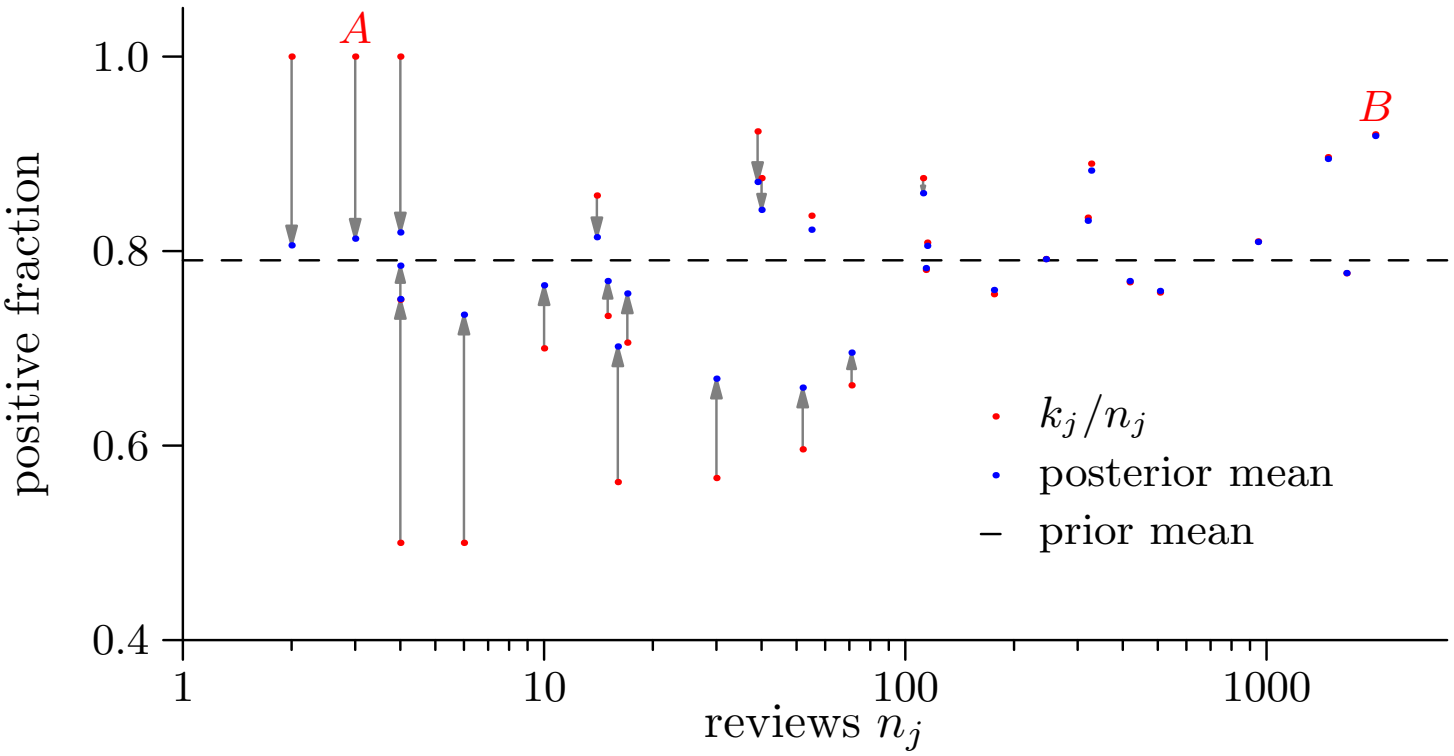
- With $a=20$, $b=5$ (typical rate 0.8, worth 25 reviews): A gets $23/28 = 0.82$ and B gets $1860/2025 = 0.92$: B is better

Shrinkage



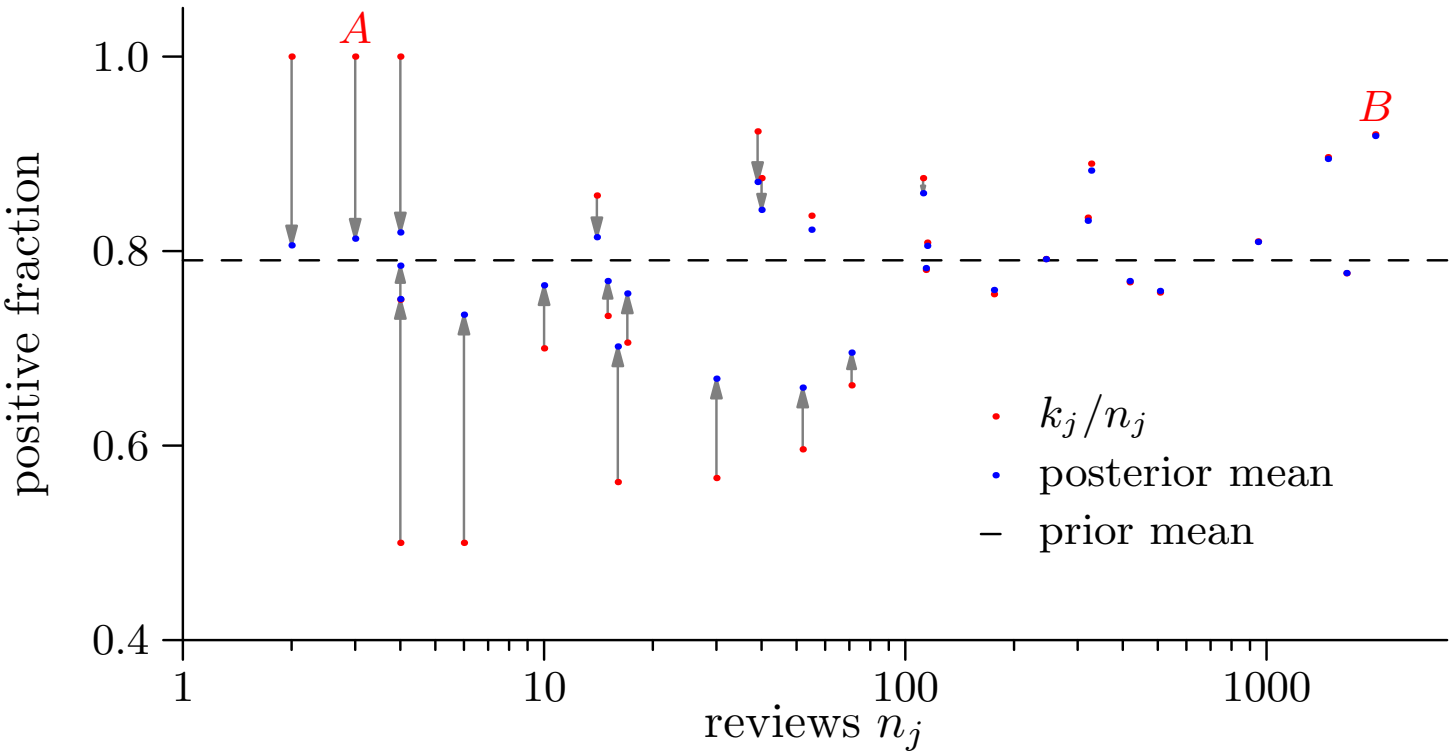
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Partial Pooling

- Two extremes
  - ⋆ no pooling: estimate each product alone (k_j/n_j)
  - ⋆ complete pooling: assume all products are the same
- The hierarchical model sits in between, and the data decide where (through $a + b$)
- The same idea appears everywhere: schools, hospitals, adverts, players, users of a recommender
- But we don't know a and b, and with them unknown the posterior $f(a,b,\boldsymbol{\theta}|\boldsymbol{k})$ has no closed form

Partial Pooling

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- The same idea appears everywhere: schools, hospitals, adverts, players, users of a recommender
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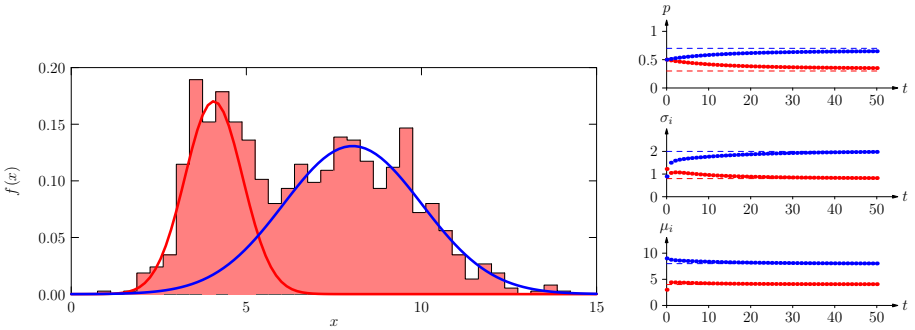
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Outline

1. Building Probabilistic Models
2. Hierarchical Models
3. **Solution Strategies**
4. Mixtures and EM



Full Bayesian Inference

- Bayes' rule gives the posterior over the parameters

$$\mathbb{P}(\boldsymbol{\Theta}|\mathcal{D}) = \frac{\mathbb{P}(\mathcal{D}|\boldsymbol{\Theta})\mathbb{P}(\boldsymbol{\Theta})}{\mathbb{P}(\mathcal{D})}$$

- It describes its own uncertainty and is much less prone to over-fitting (we average over parameters rather than choosing the best)

- But the posterior is rarely a nice function, and its normalisation, the *evidence* $\mathbb{P}(\mathcal{D}) = \sum_{\boldsymbol{\Theta}} \mathbb{P}(\mathcal{D}|\boldsymbol{\Theta})\mathbb{P}(\boldsymbol{\Theta})$, is a sum over far too many values

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Maximum A Posteriori (MAP) Solution

- Work around: the mode of the posterior (no need for $f(\mathcal{D})$)

$$\boldsymbol{\Theta}_{\text{MAP}} = \underset{\boldsymbol{\Theta}}{\operatorname{argmax}}\, f(\mathcal{D}|\boldsymbol{\Theta}) f(\boldsymbol{\Theta}) = \underset{\boldsymbol{\Theta}}{\operatorname{argmax}} \log(f(\mathcal{D}|\boldsymbol{\Theta})) + \log(f(\boldsymbol{\Theta}))$$

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- With a uniform prior MAP is **maximum likelihood**

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Empirical Bayes

- A half-way house: integrate out the many θ_j, optimise the few hyperparameters, then use the conjugate posteriors
- For the ratings model the integral is in closed form (the **beta-binomial**)

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{P}(k_j|a,b) &= \int_0^1 \mathrm{Bin}(k_j|n_j,\theta)\mathrm{Beta}(\theta|a,b)\mathrm{d}\theta \\ &= \binom{n_j}{k_j}\frac{B(a+k_j,b+n_j-k_j)}{B(a,b)}\end{aligned}$$

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Strategy	What you get	Cost
ML	a point estimate	optimiser
MAP	a regularised point	optimiser
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EM	ML/MAP with latents	iterate
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- Choose the cheapest that answers your question
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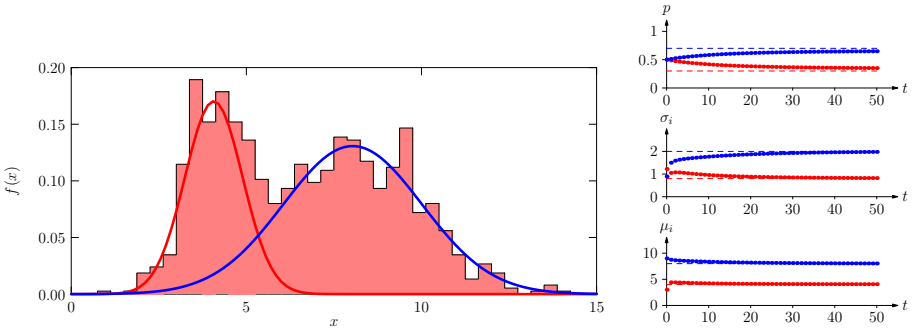
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You Already Know EM

- k-means clustering

  1. assign each point to its nearest centre
  2. move each centre to the mean of its points
  3. repeat

- Step 1 guesses the hidden cluster labels; step 2 fits the parameters as if those guesses were right

- The EM algorithm does the same with **probabilities** of belonging to each cluster

- It comes from a probabilistic model: a mixture

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Mixture of Gaussians

- Suppose we detect two types of short-lived particle, A or B, and measure each particle's mass, X_i, with a noisy detector, but not its type
- Let $Z_i \in \{0,1\}$ indicate that particle i is of type A, with $\mathbb{P}(Z_i = 1) = p$
- X_i is normal with unknown means and variances, so the parameters are $\mathbf{\Theta} = (\mu_A, \sigma_A^2, \mu_B, \sigma_B^2, p)$
- The probability of X_i is given by

$$f(X_i|Z_i, \mathbf{\Theta}) = Z_i \mathcal{N}\left(X_i \middle| \mu_A, \sigma_A^2\right) + (1 - Z_i)\mathcal{N}\left(X_i \middle| \mu_B, \sigma_B^2\right)$$

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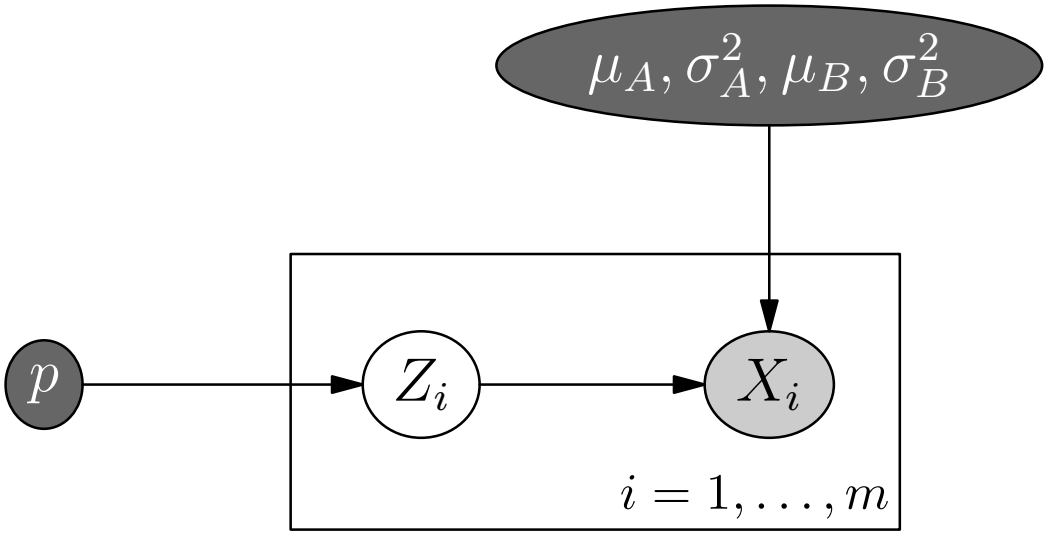
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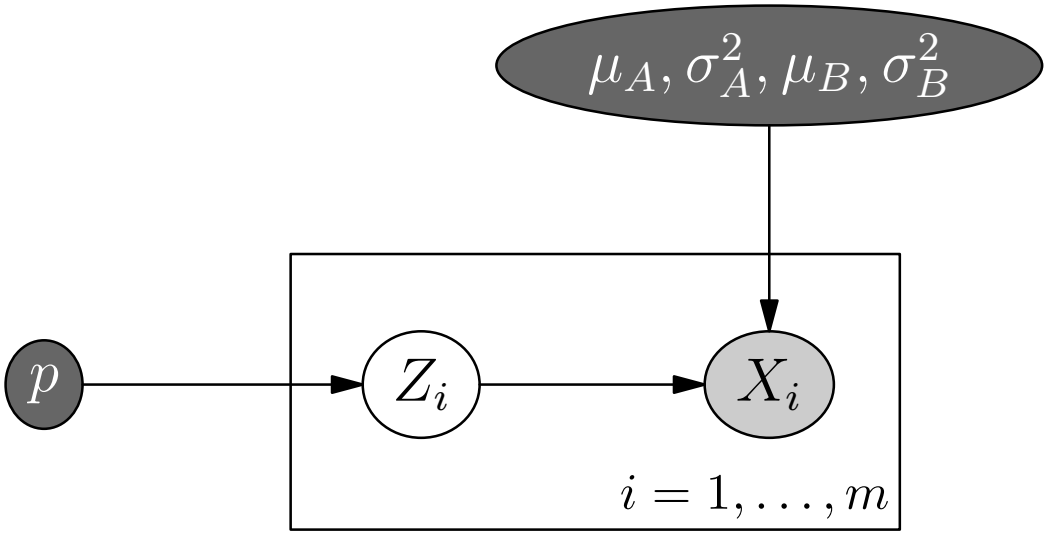
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Mixture as a Graphical Model



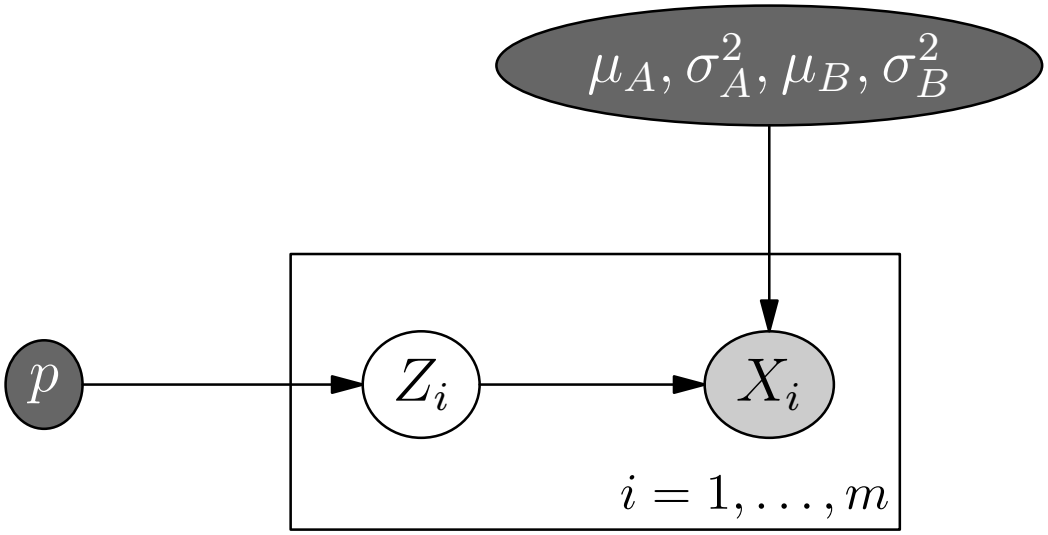
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- The parameters (dark) are shared by all data points, so they sit outside the plate

Mixture as a Graphical Model



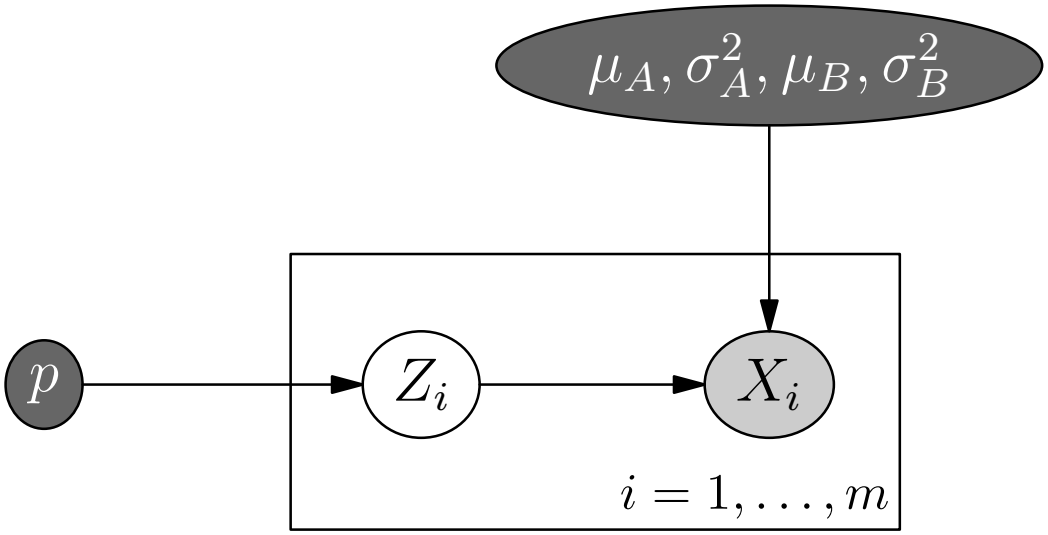
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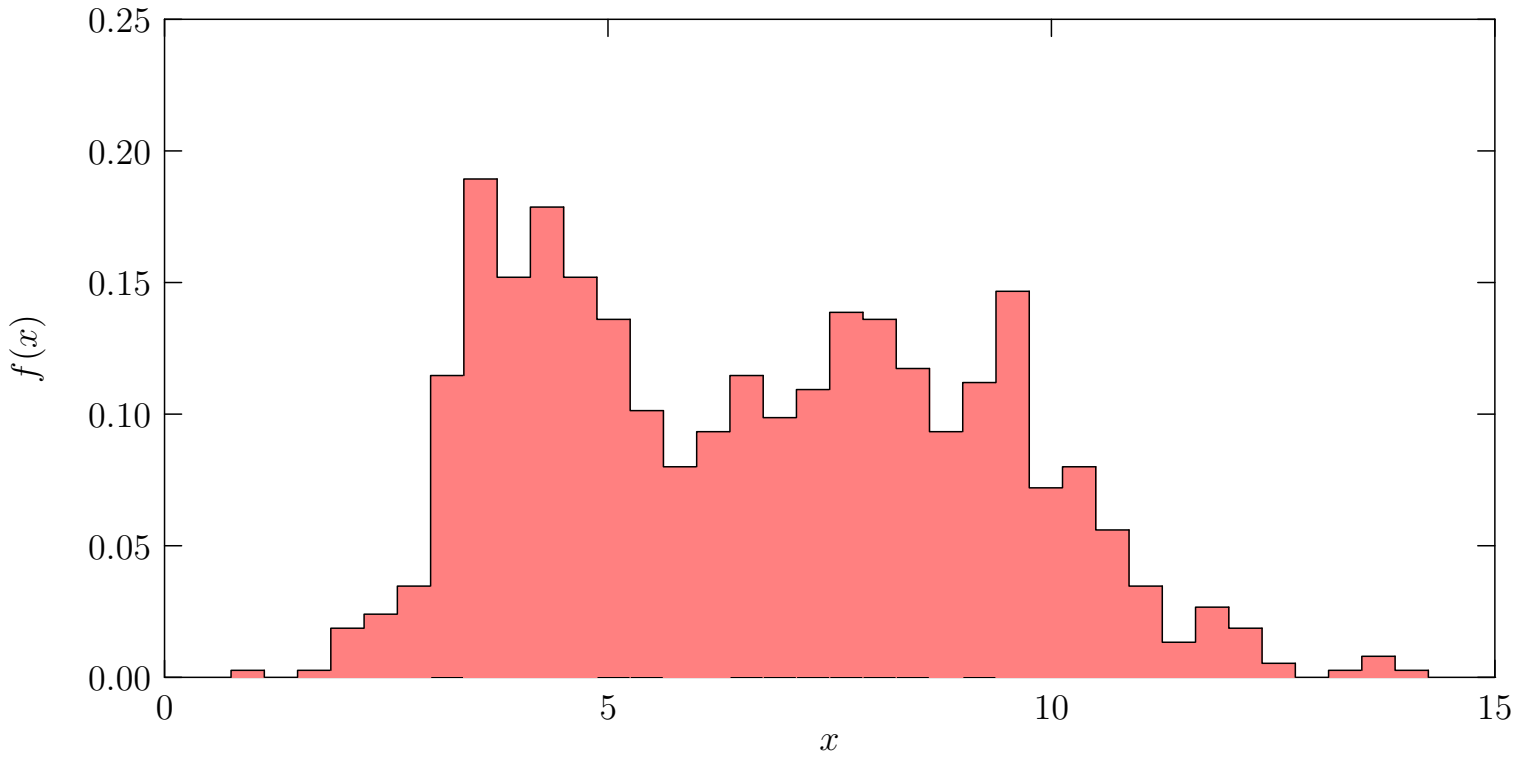
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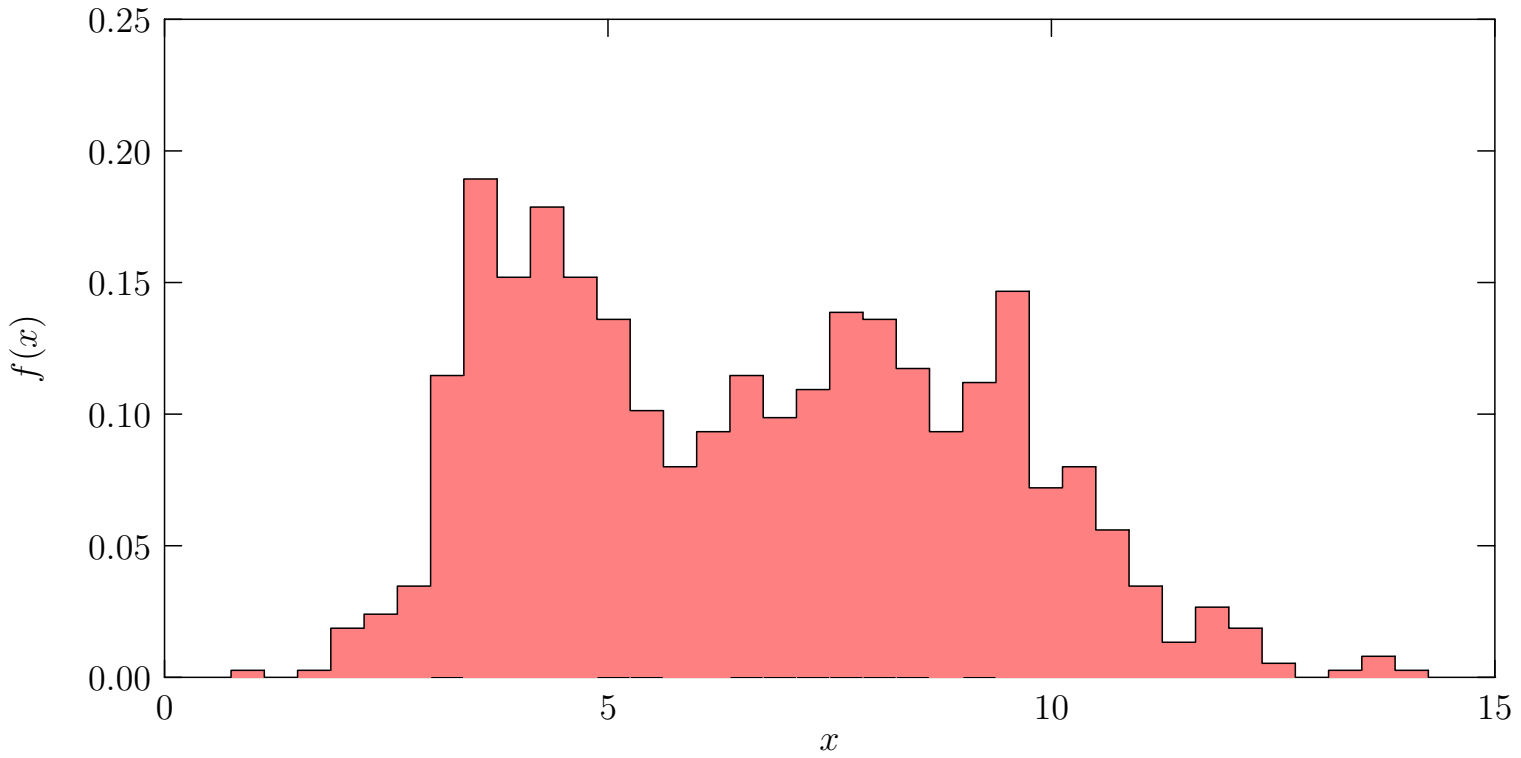


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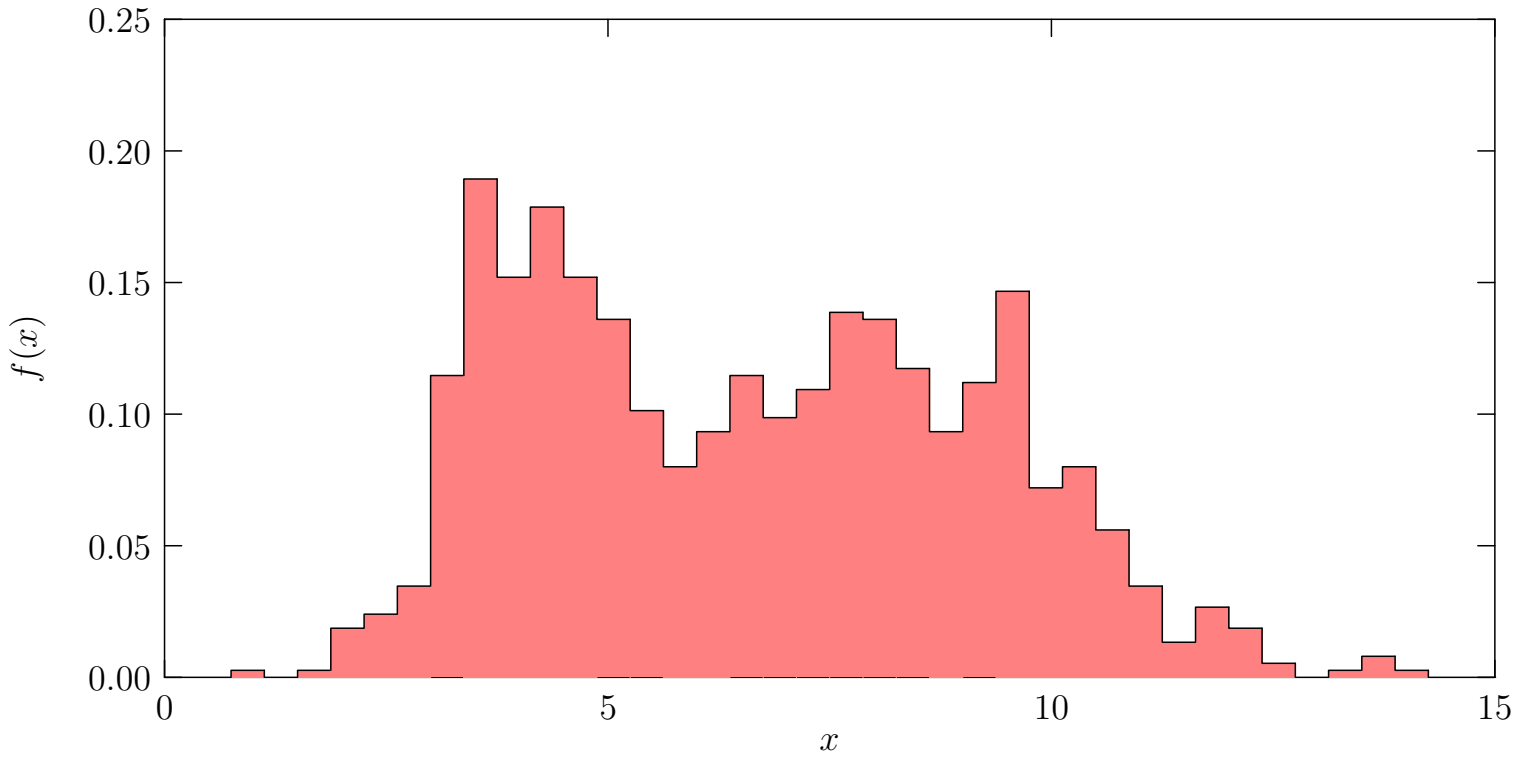


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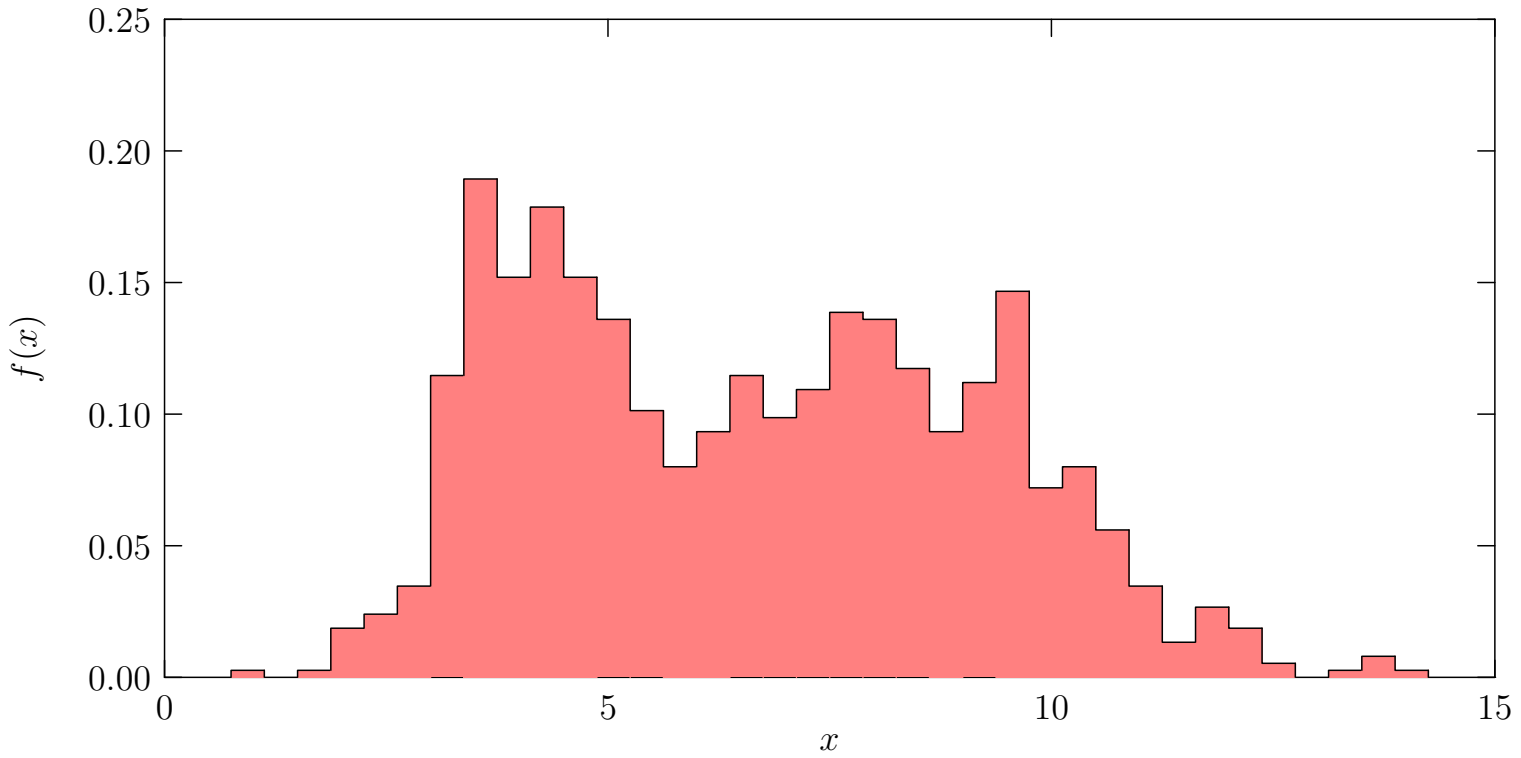


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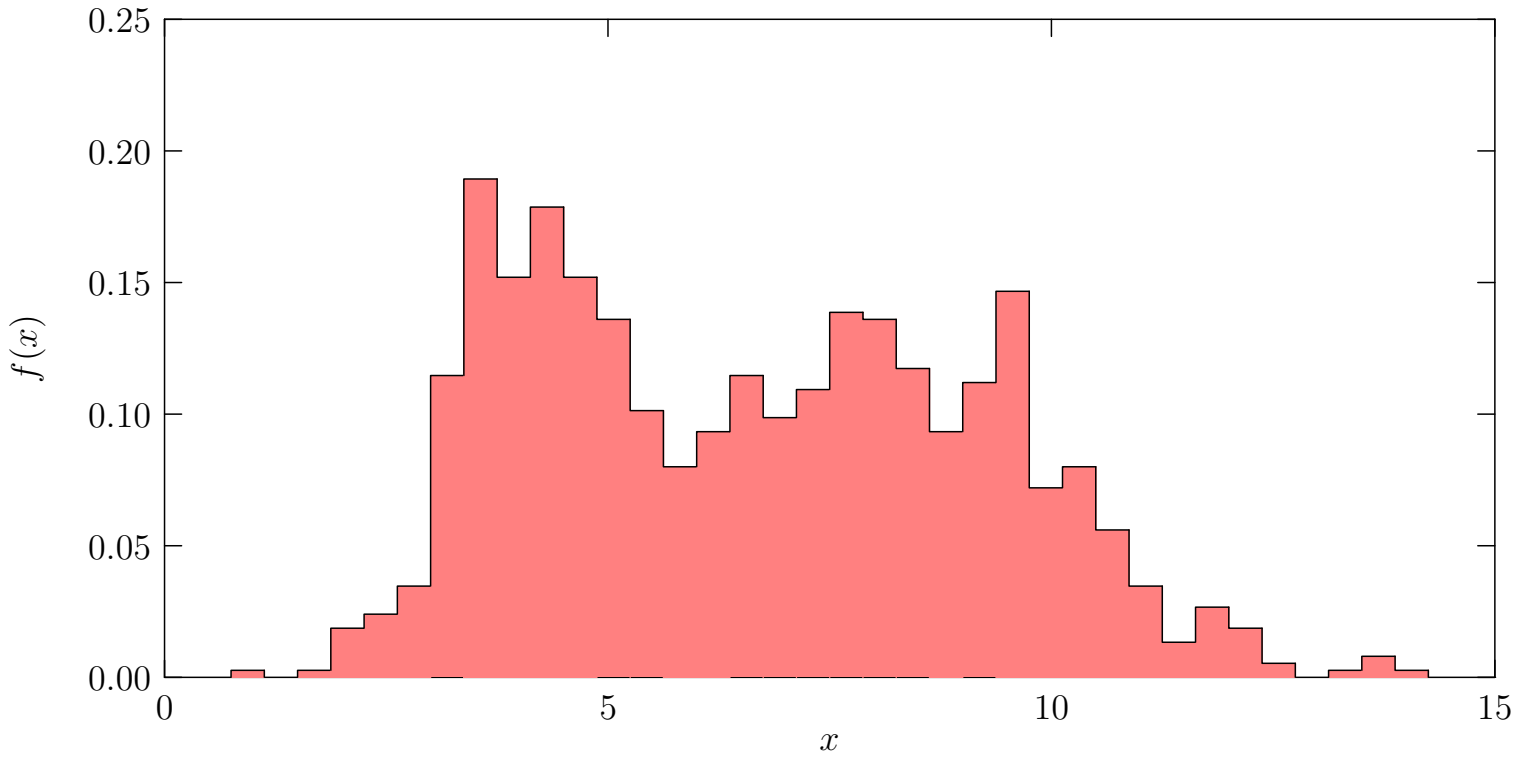


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Maximum Likelihood

- A full Bayesian treatment needs priors on $\boldsymbol{\Theta}$ and would give a distribution over parameters
- Often we only want a reasonable estimate for some of our parameters (e.g. the masses μ_A and μ_B)
- A reasonable approach is to seek those parameters that maximise the likelihood of our observed data (assumed independent)

$$f(\mathcal{D}|\boldsymbol{\Theta}) = \prod_{X \in \mathcal{D}} f(X|\boldsymbol{\Theta})$$

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- If we knew each particle's type, Z_i, maximising the likelihood would be easy
- The **expectation-maximisation** (EM) algorithm iterates: maximise the log-likelihood of the data **and** latent variables, averaged over the latent variables using the current parameters

$$\boldsymbol{\Theta}^{(t+1)} = \operatorname*{argmax}_{\boldsymbol{\Theta}} \sum_{\boldsymbol{Z}} \mathbb{P}\left(\boldsymbol{Z} \middle| \mathcal{D}, \boldsymbol{\Theta}^{(t)}\right) \log(f(\mathcal{D}, \boldsymbol{Z}|\boldsymbol{\Theta}))$$

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E-Step: Responsibilities

- We need the distribution of the latent variables conditioned on the data and current estimated parameters

- For our problem

$$\mathbb{P}\Big(\boldsymbol{Z}\Big|\mathcal{D},\boldsymbol{\Theta}^{(t)}\Big)=\prod_{i=1}^{m}\mathbb{P}\Big(Z_i\Big|X_i,\boldsymbol{\Theta}^{(t)}\Big)$$

where, by Bayes' rule, the **responsibility** of type A for point i is

$$\gamma_i^{(t)}=\mathbb{P}\Big(Z_i=1\Big|X_i,\boldsymbol{\Theta}^{(t)}\Big)=\frac{p^{(t)}\mathcal{N}\Big(X_i\Big|\mu_A^{(t)},\sigma_A^{2(t)}\Big)}{p^{(t)}\mathcal{N}\Big(X_i\Big|\mu_A^{(t)},\sigma_A^{2(t)}\Big)+(1-p^{(t)})\mathcal{N}\Big(X_i\Big|\mu_B^{(t)},\sigma_B^{2(t)}\Big)}$$

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Update Equations

- Fraction of type A: the average responsibility

$$p^{(t+1)} = \frac{1}{m}\sum_{i=1}^{m}\gamma_i^{(t)}$$

- Means: weighted averages of the data

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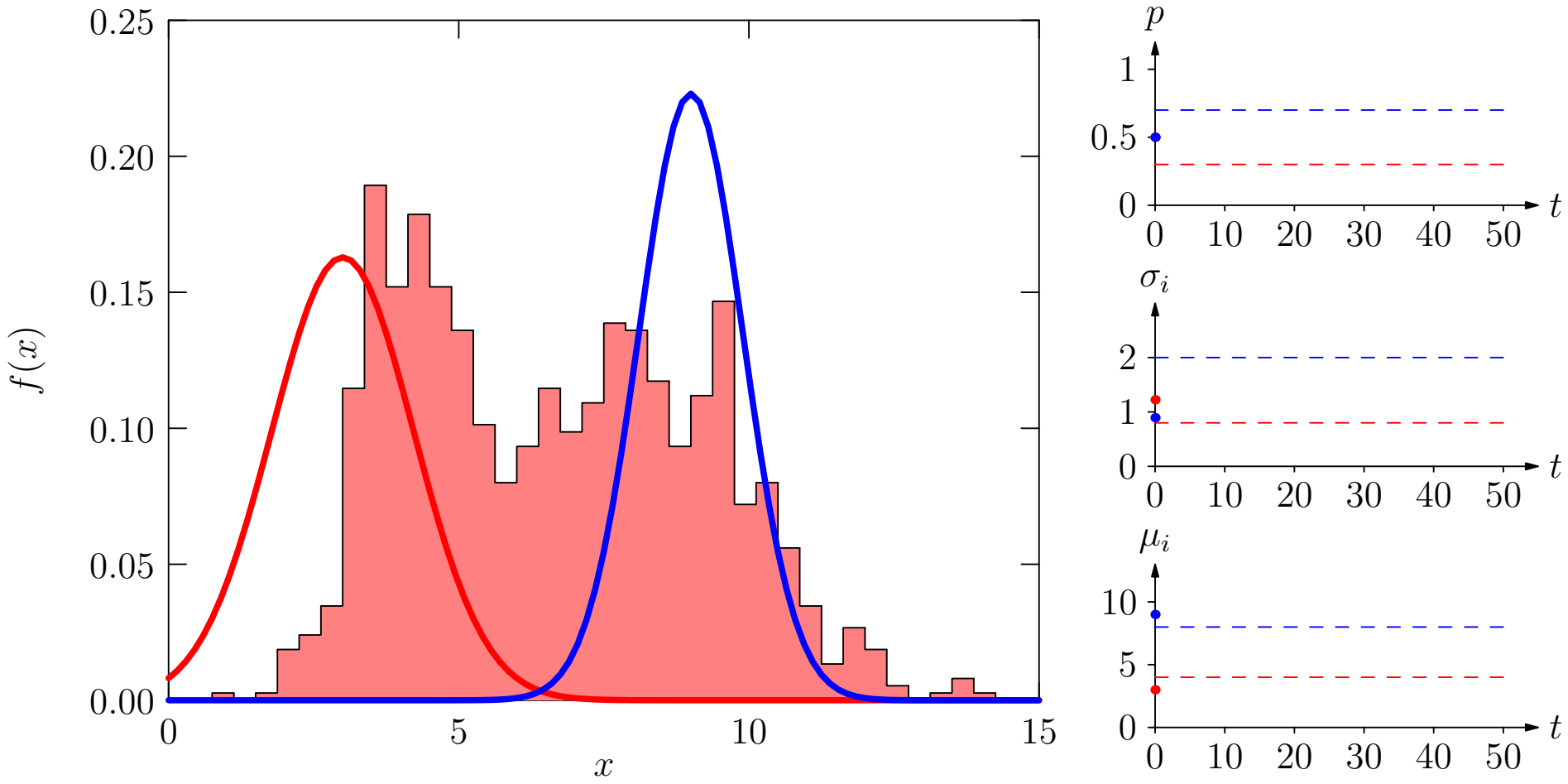
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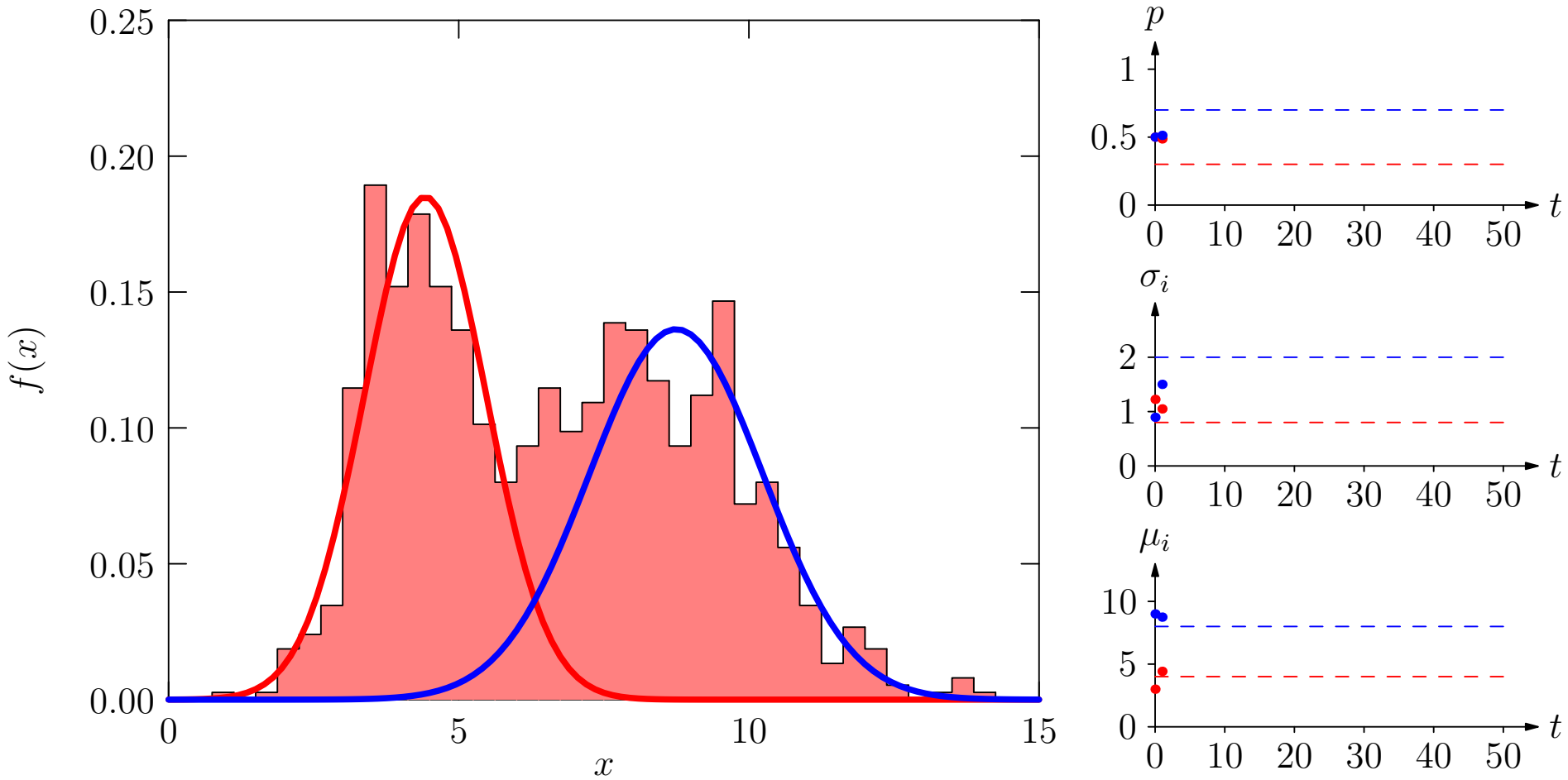
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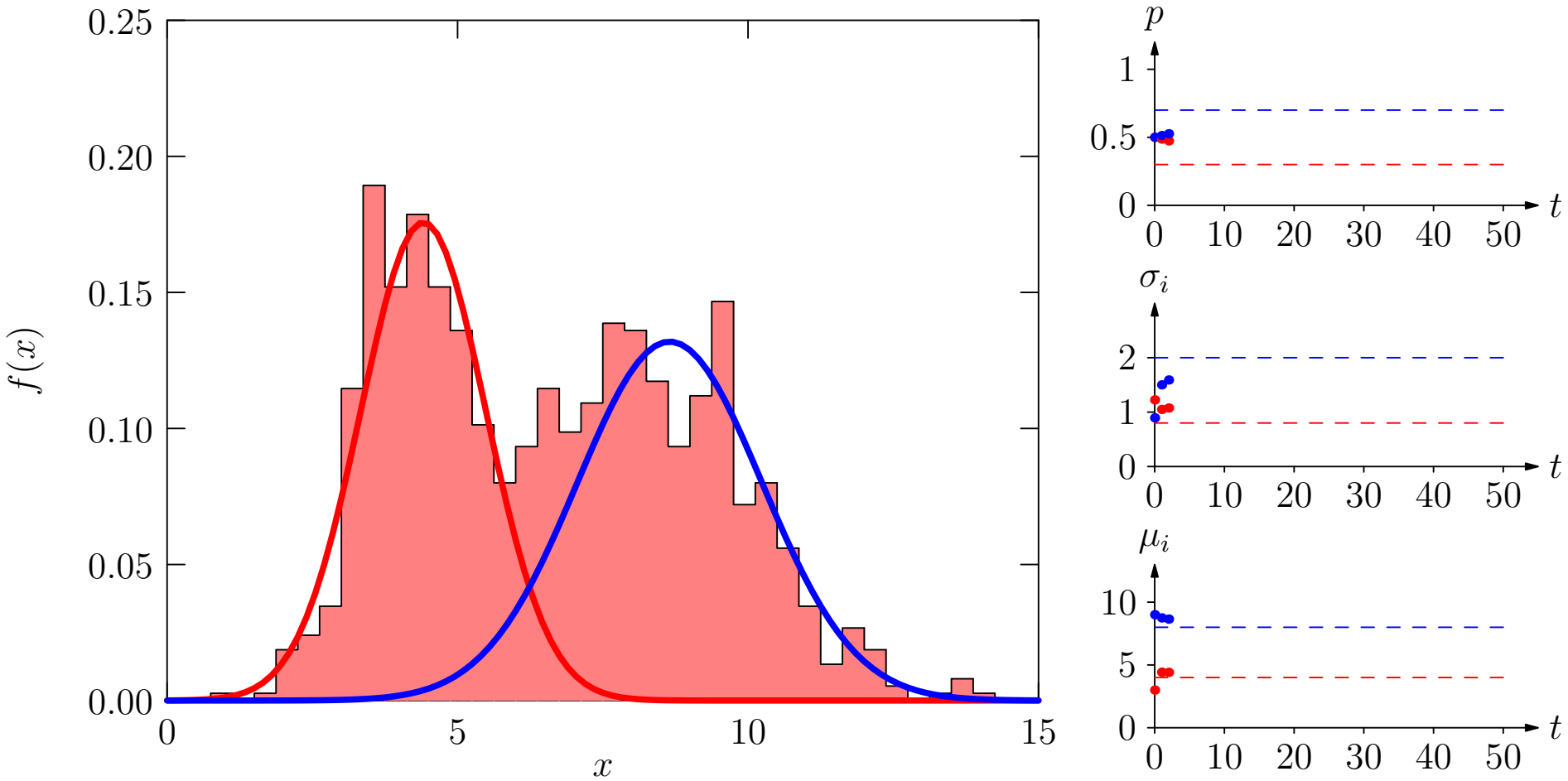
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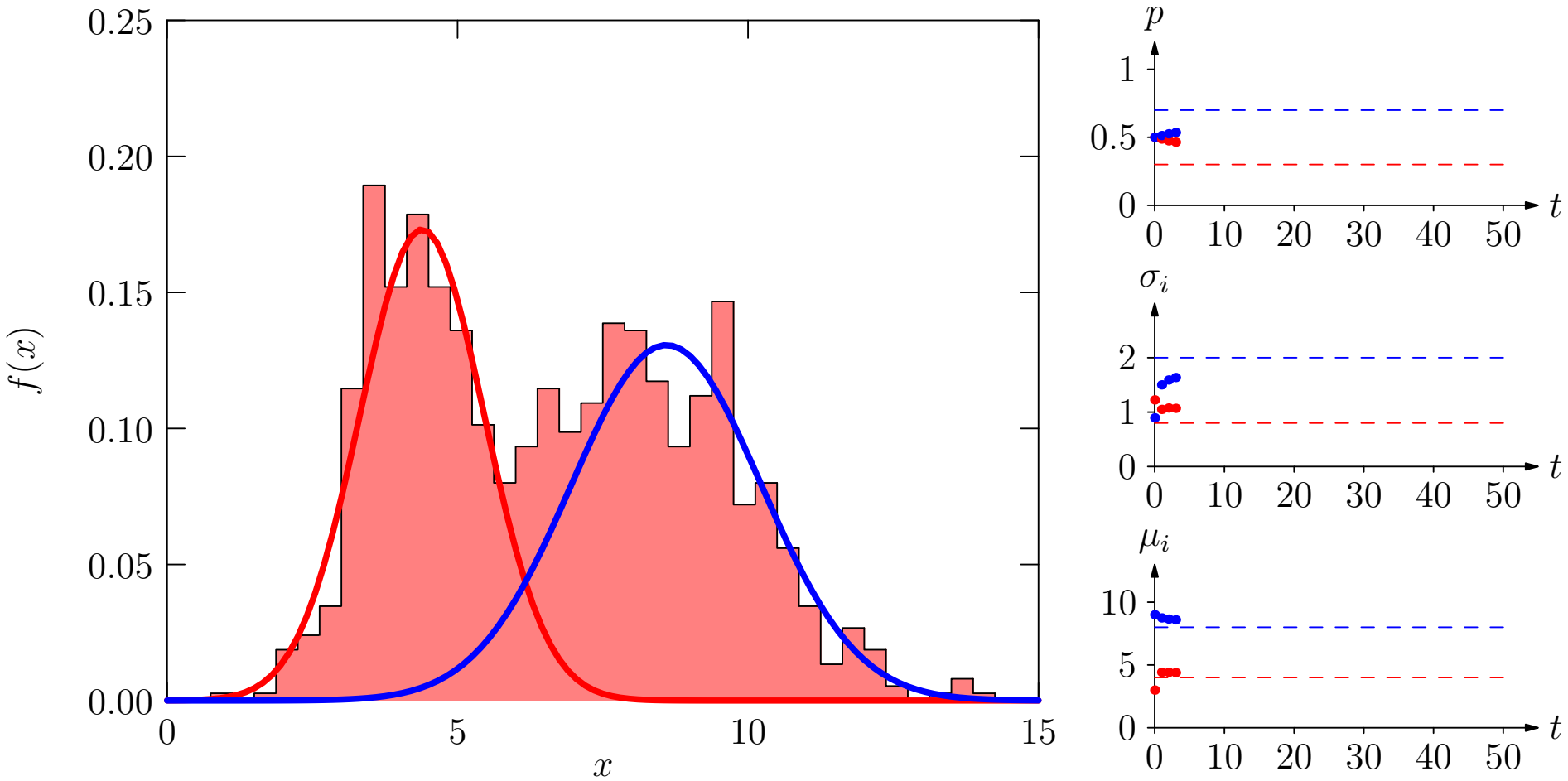
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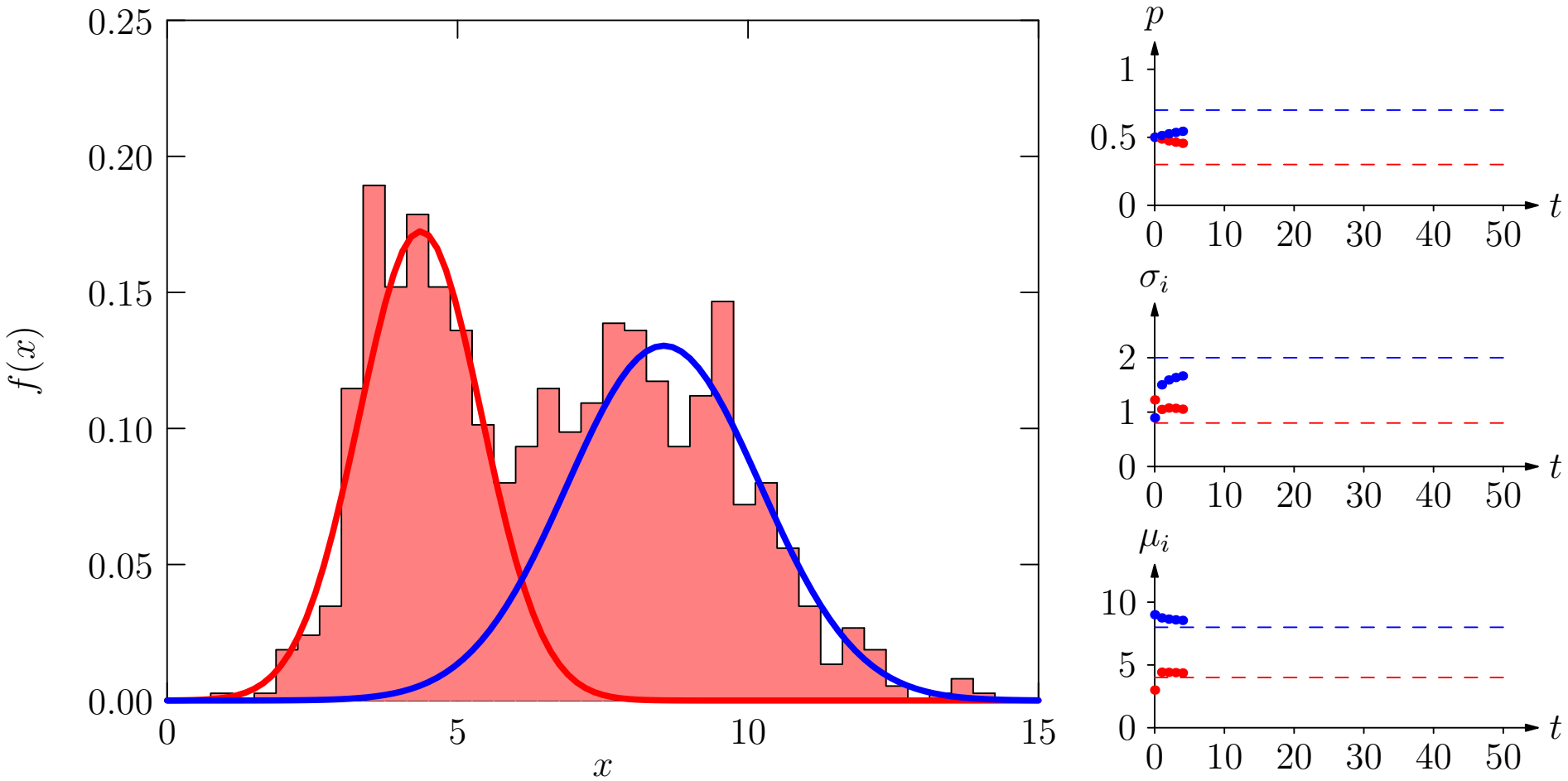
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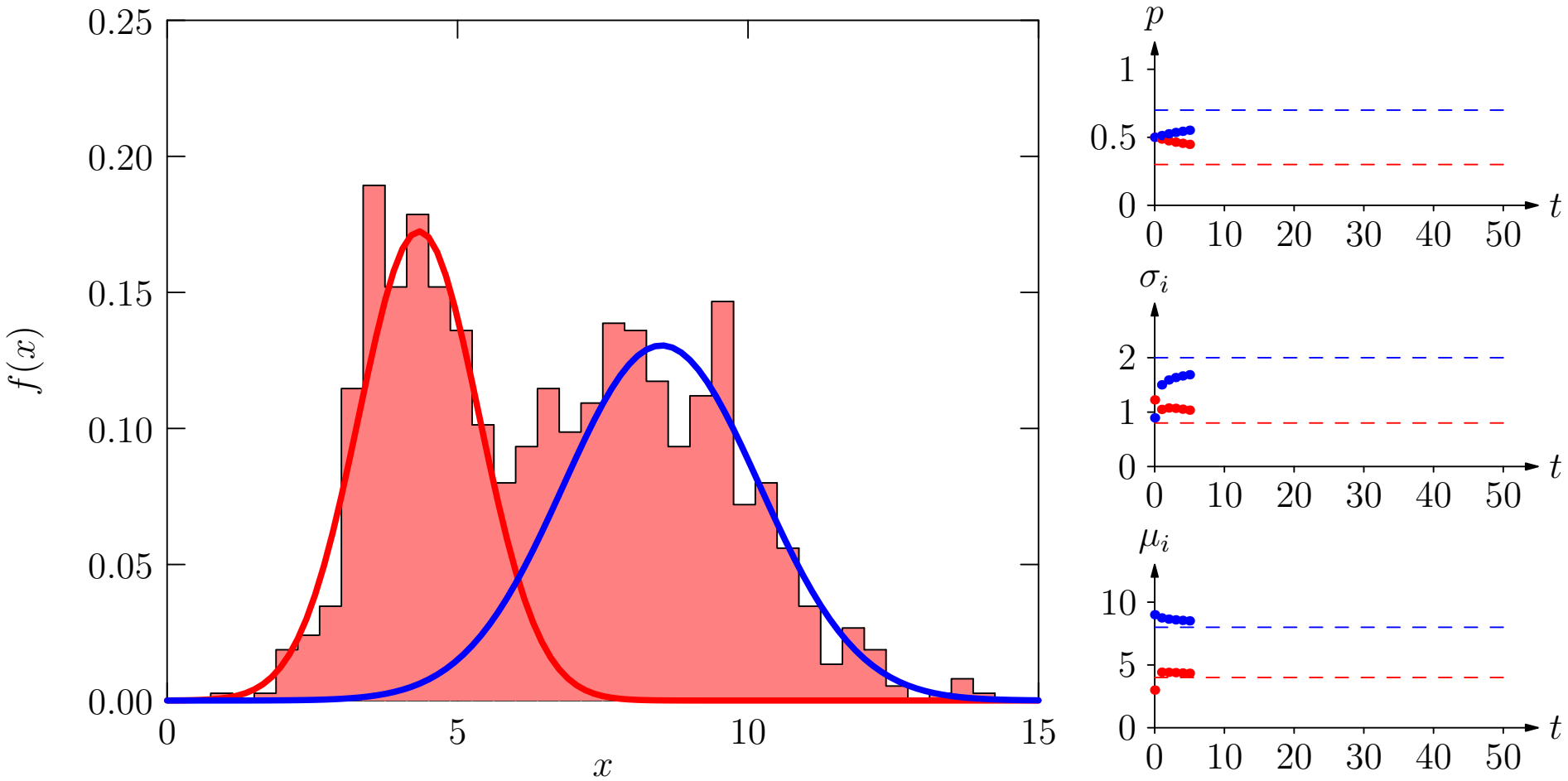
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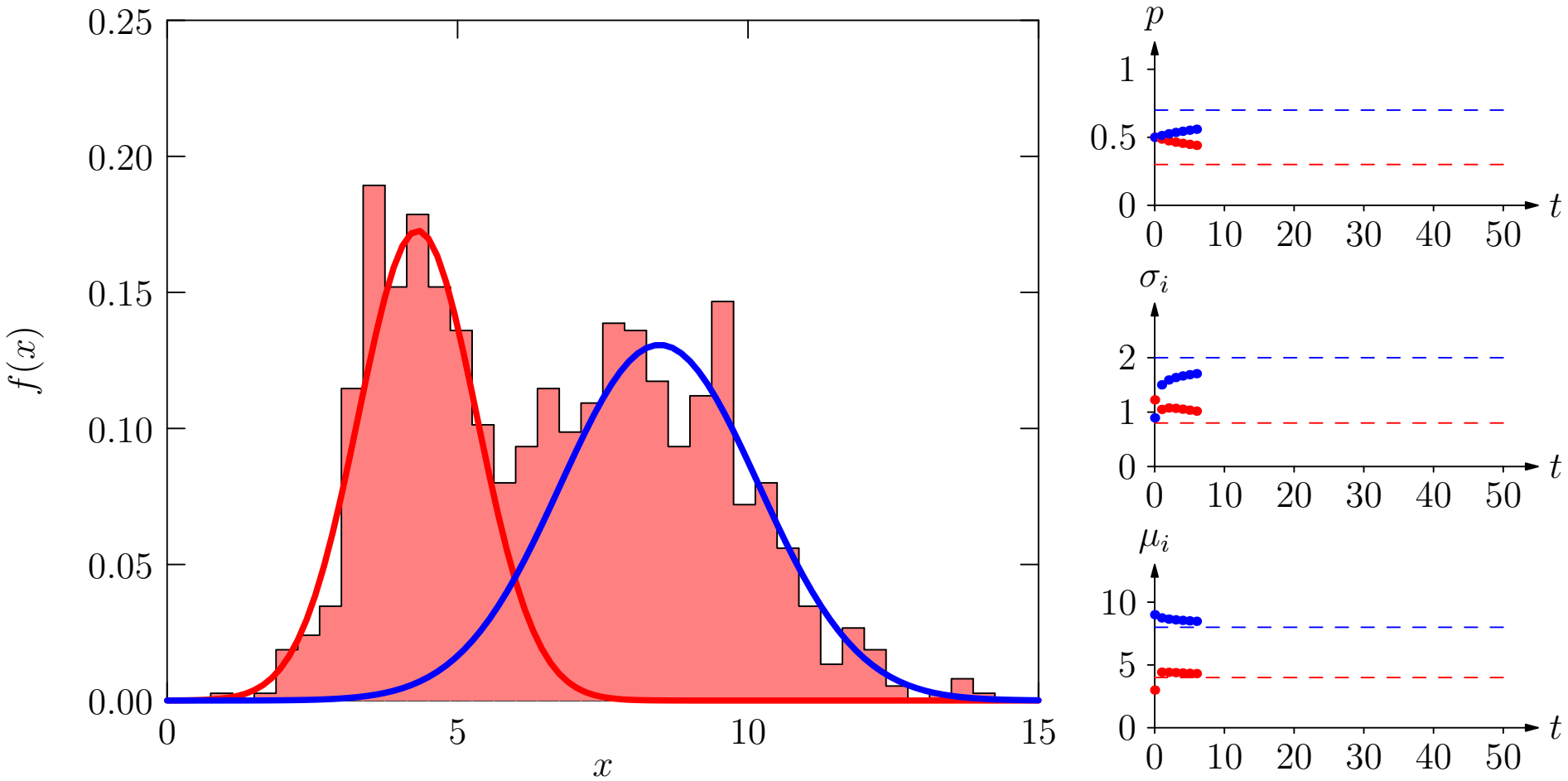
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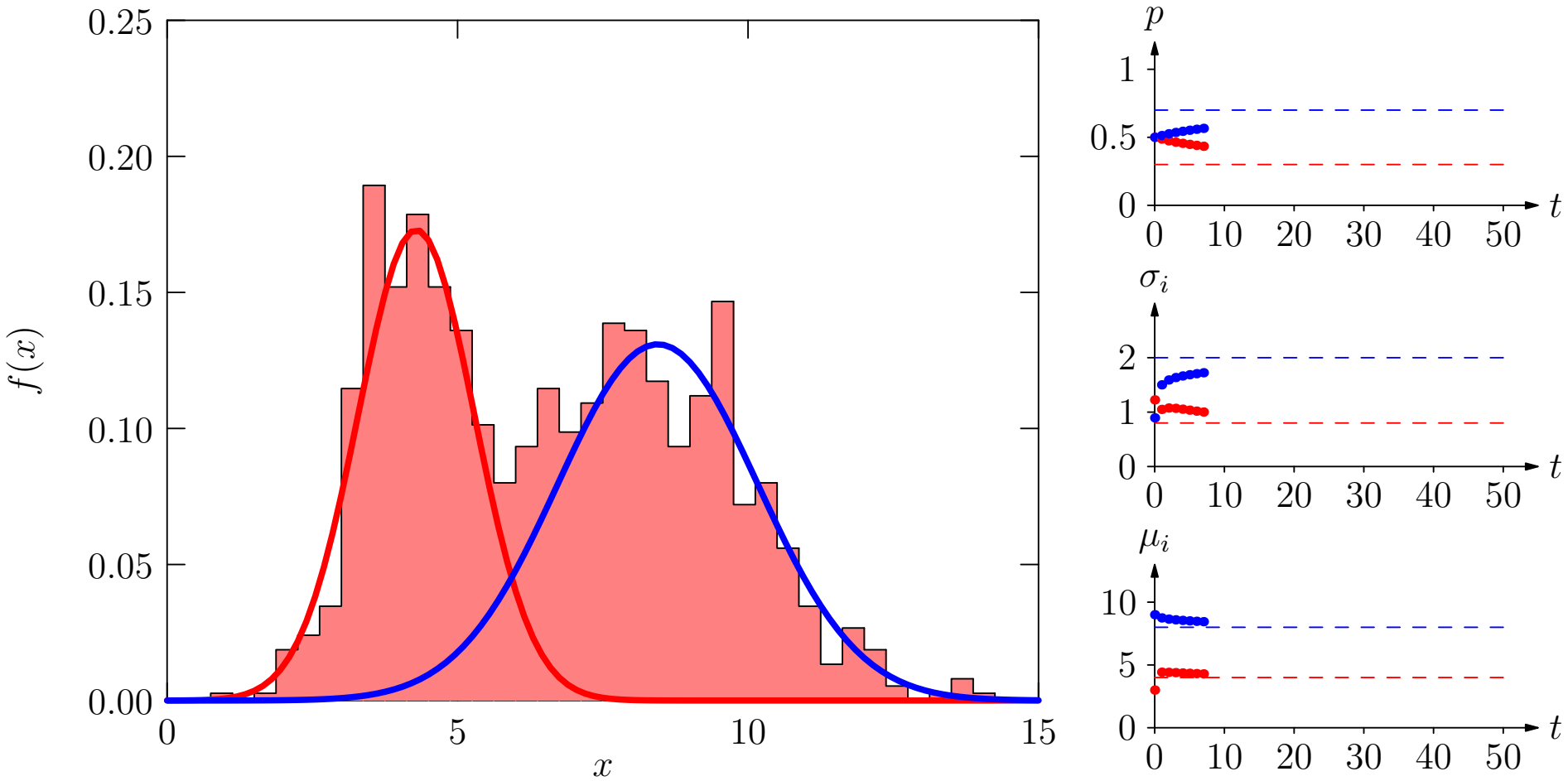
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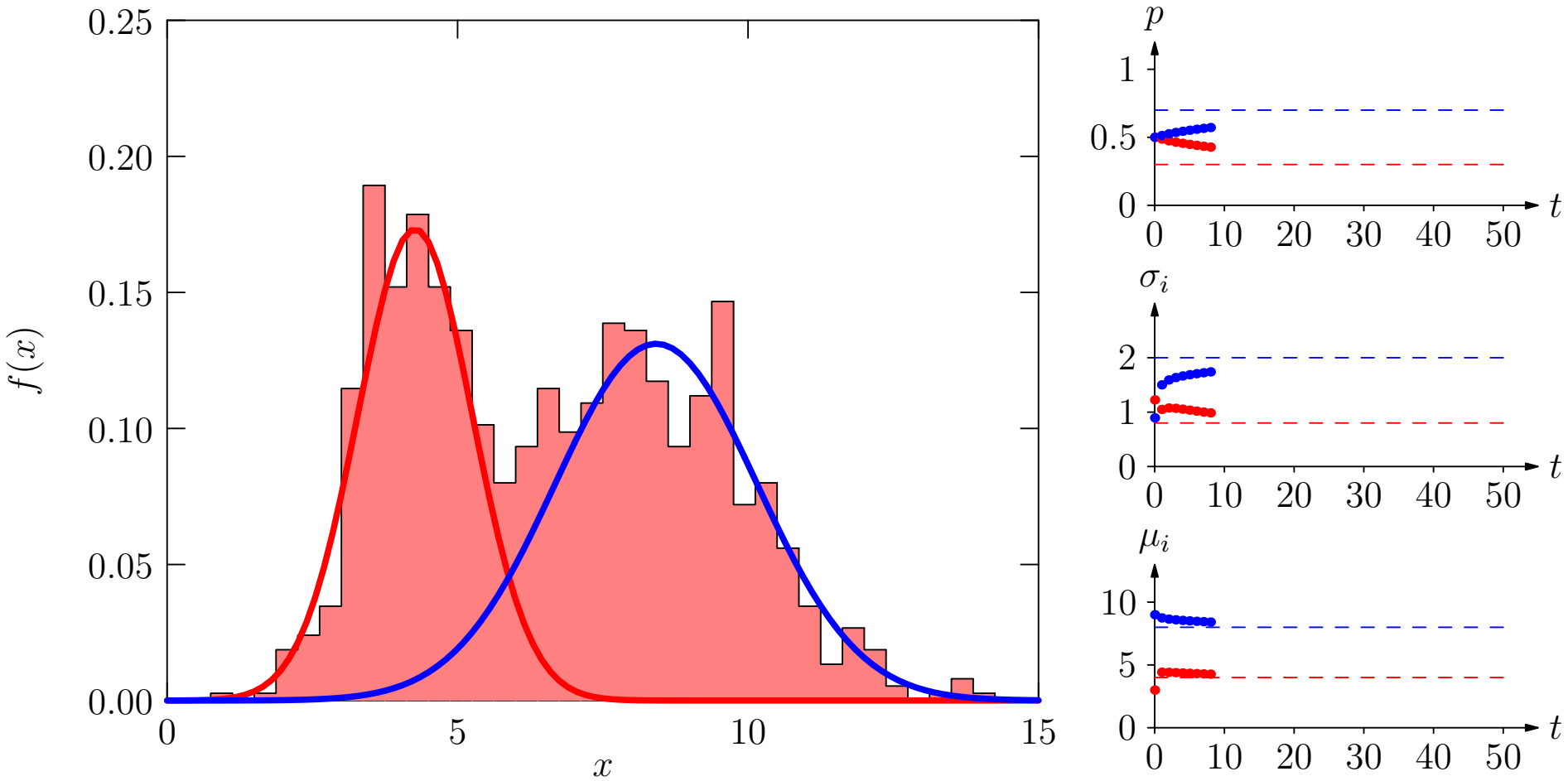
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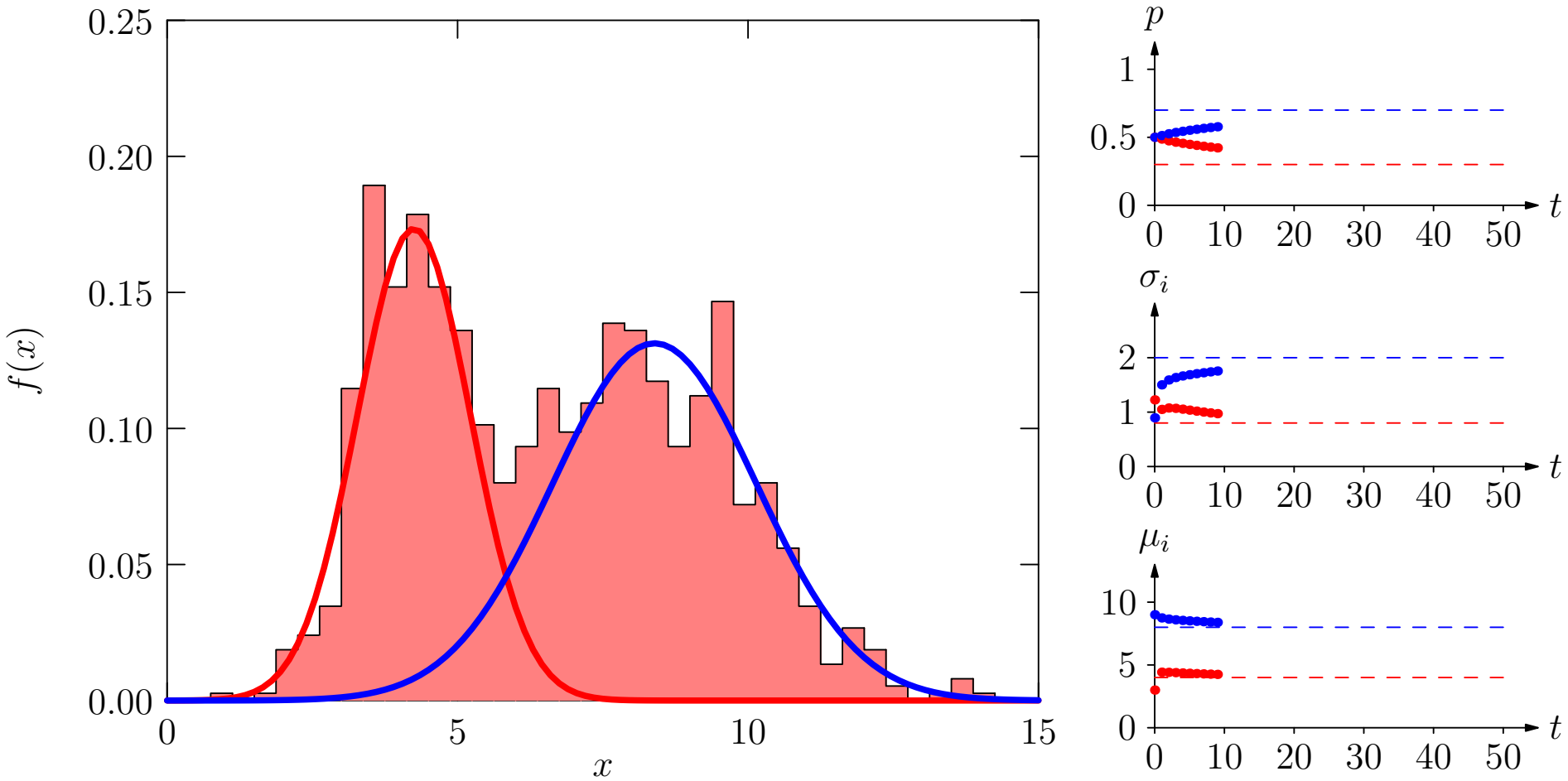
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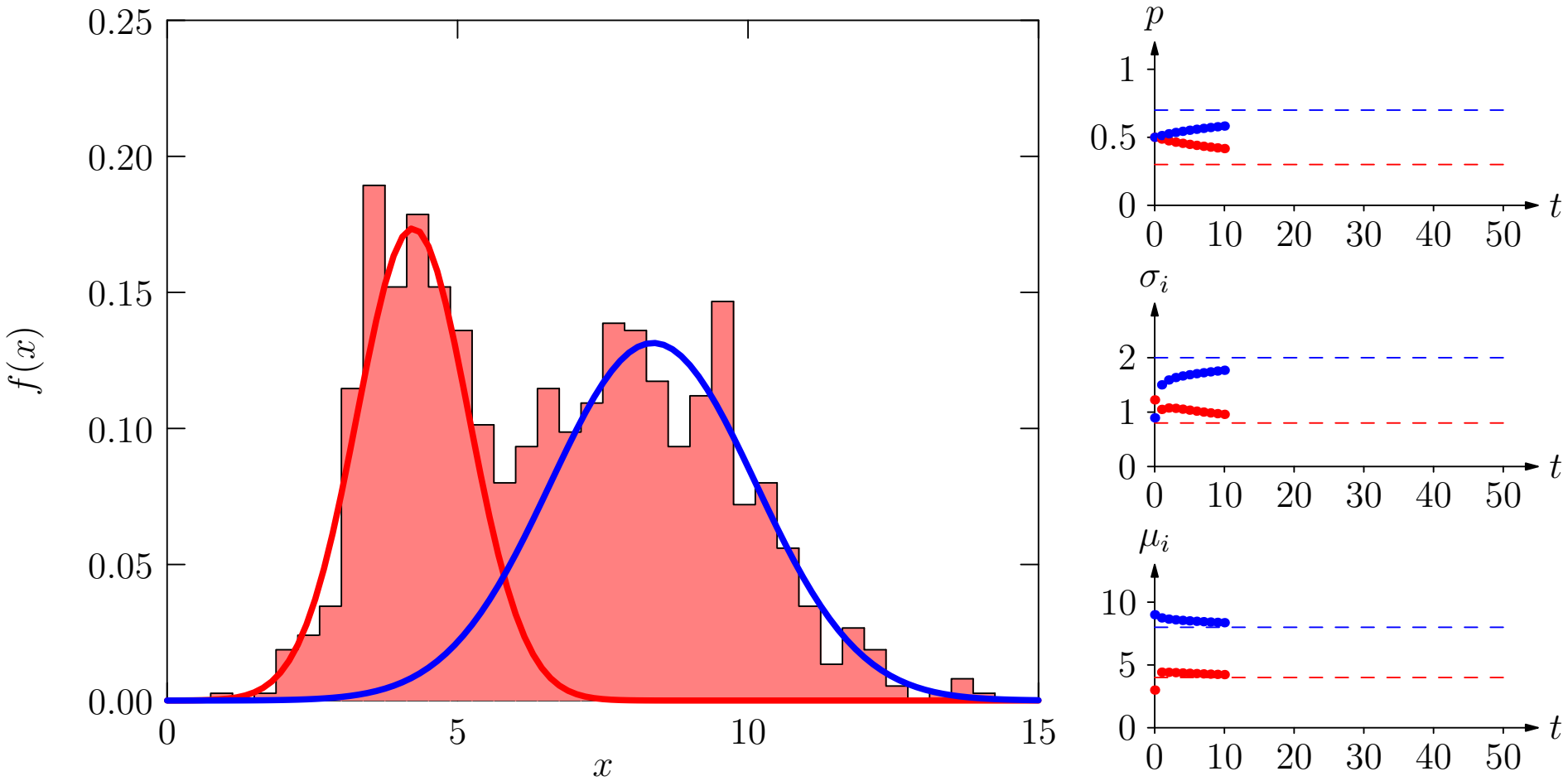
Example


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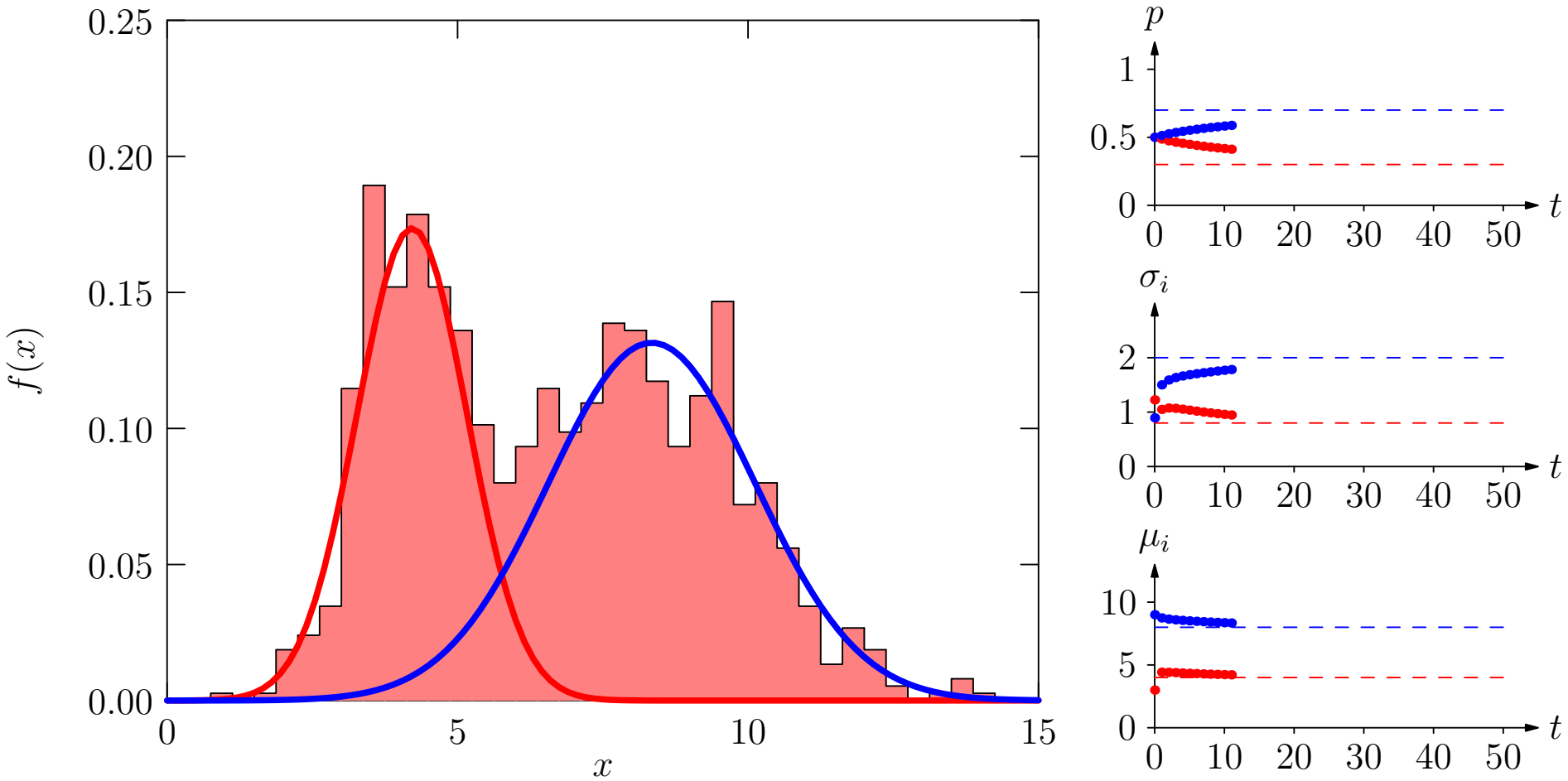
Example


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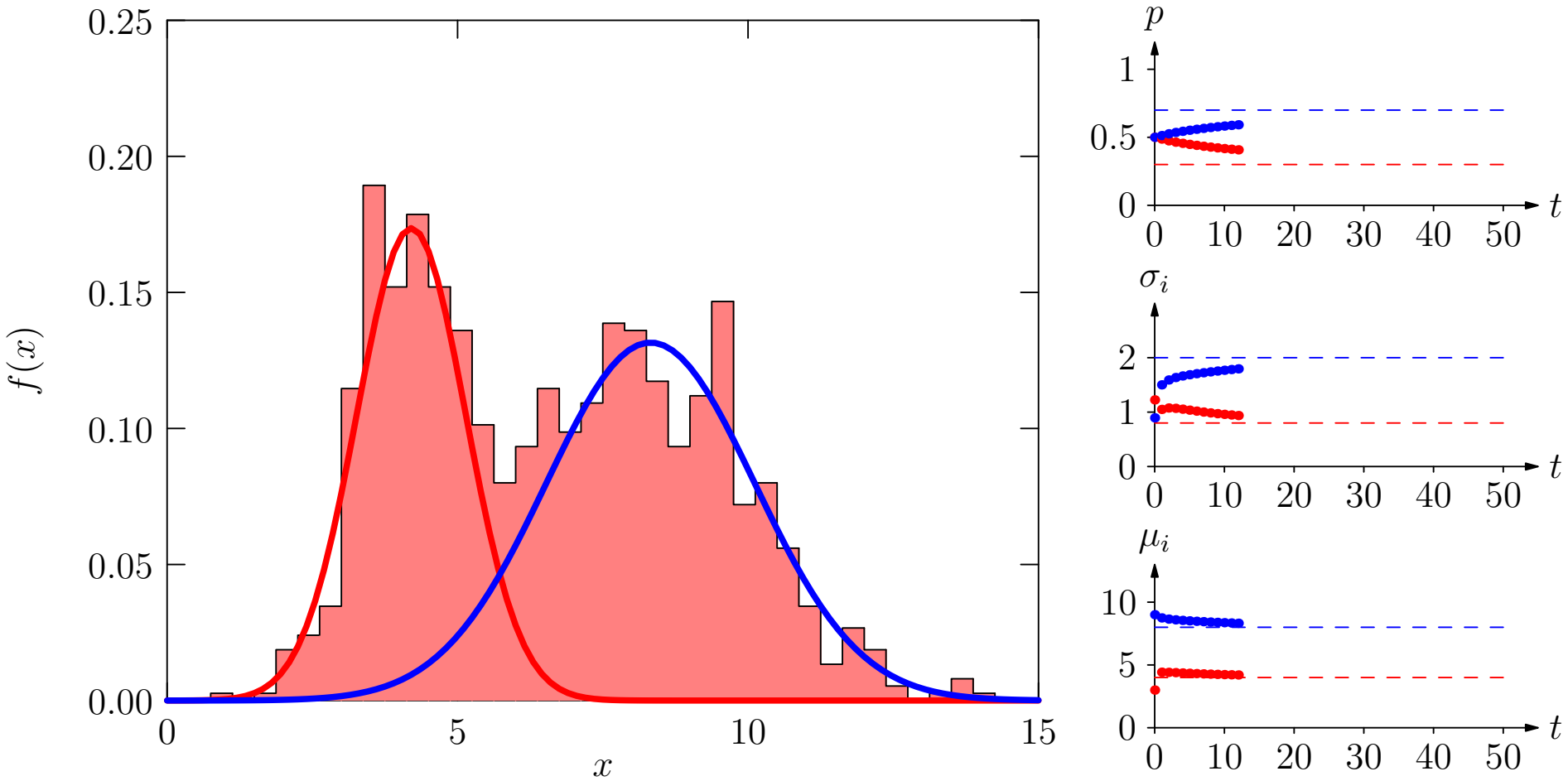
Example


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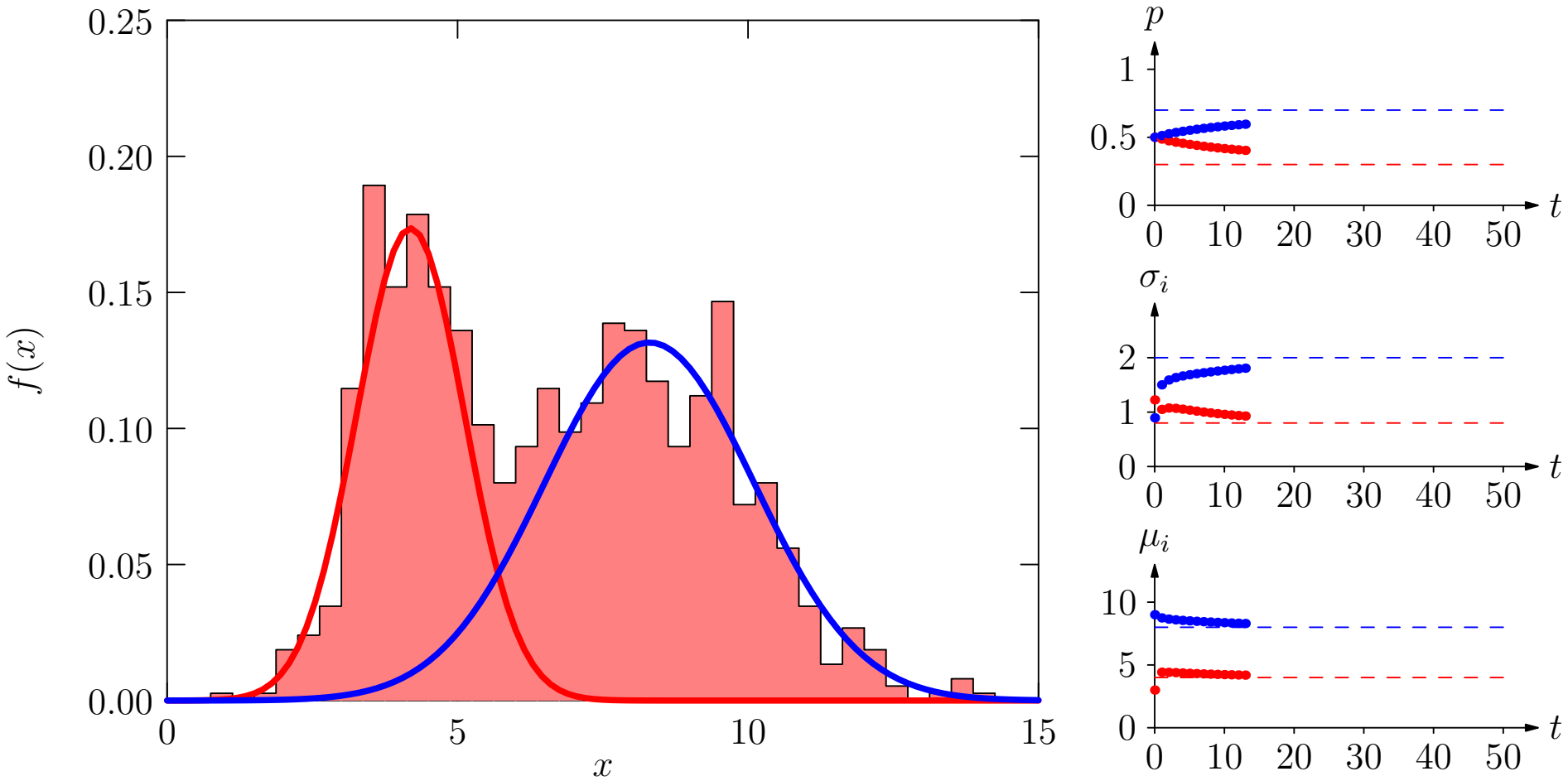
Example


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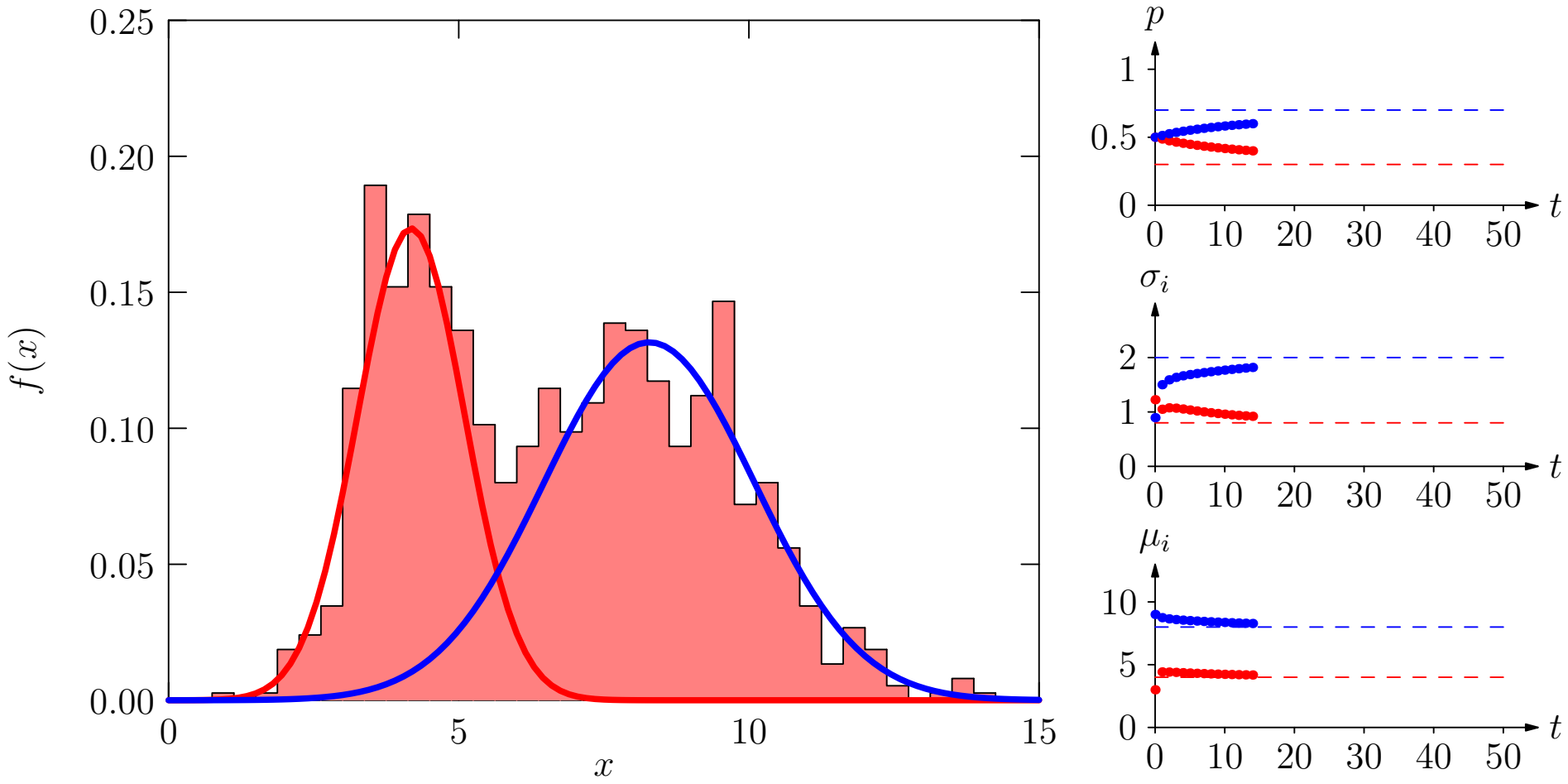
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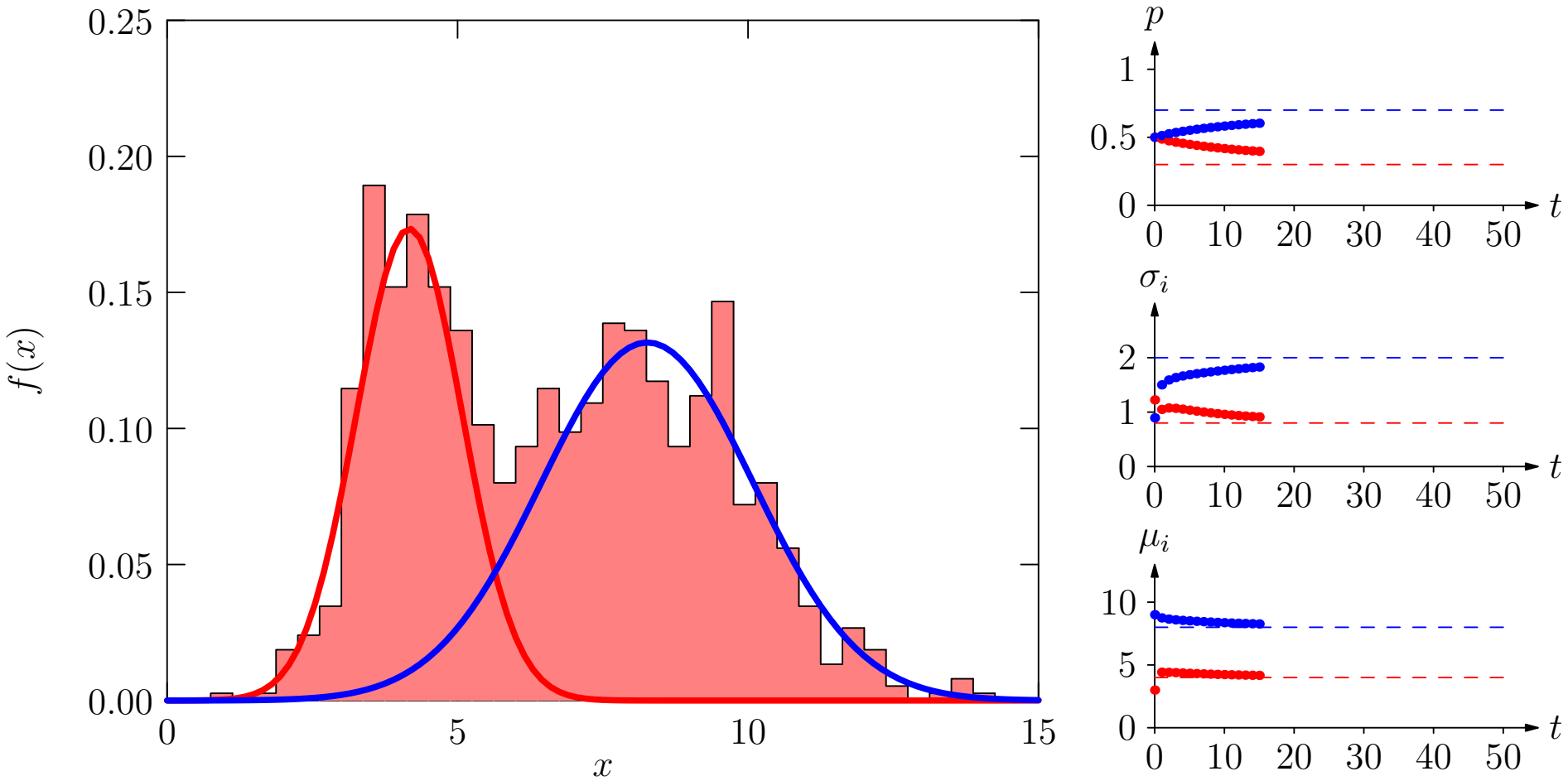
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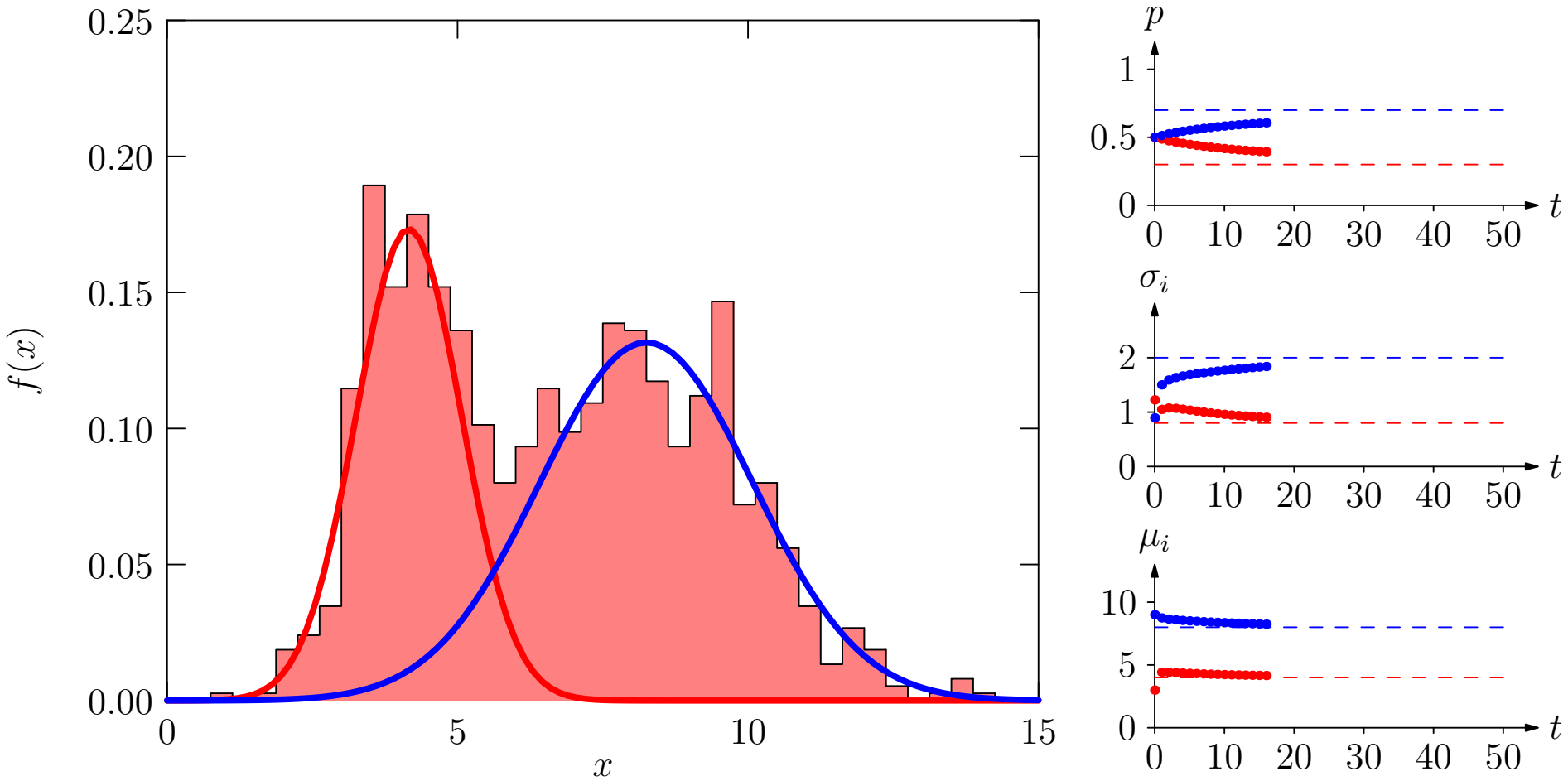
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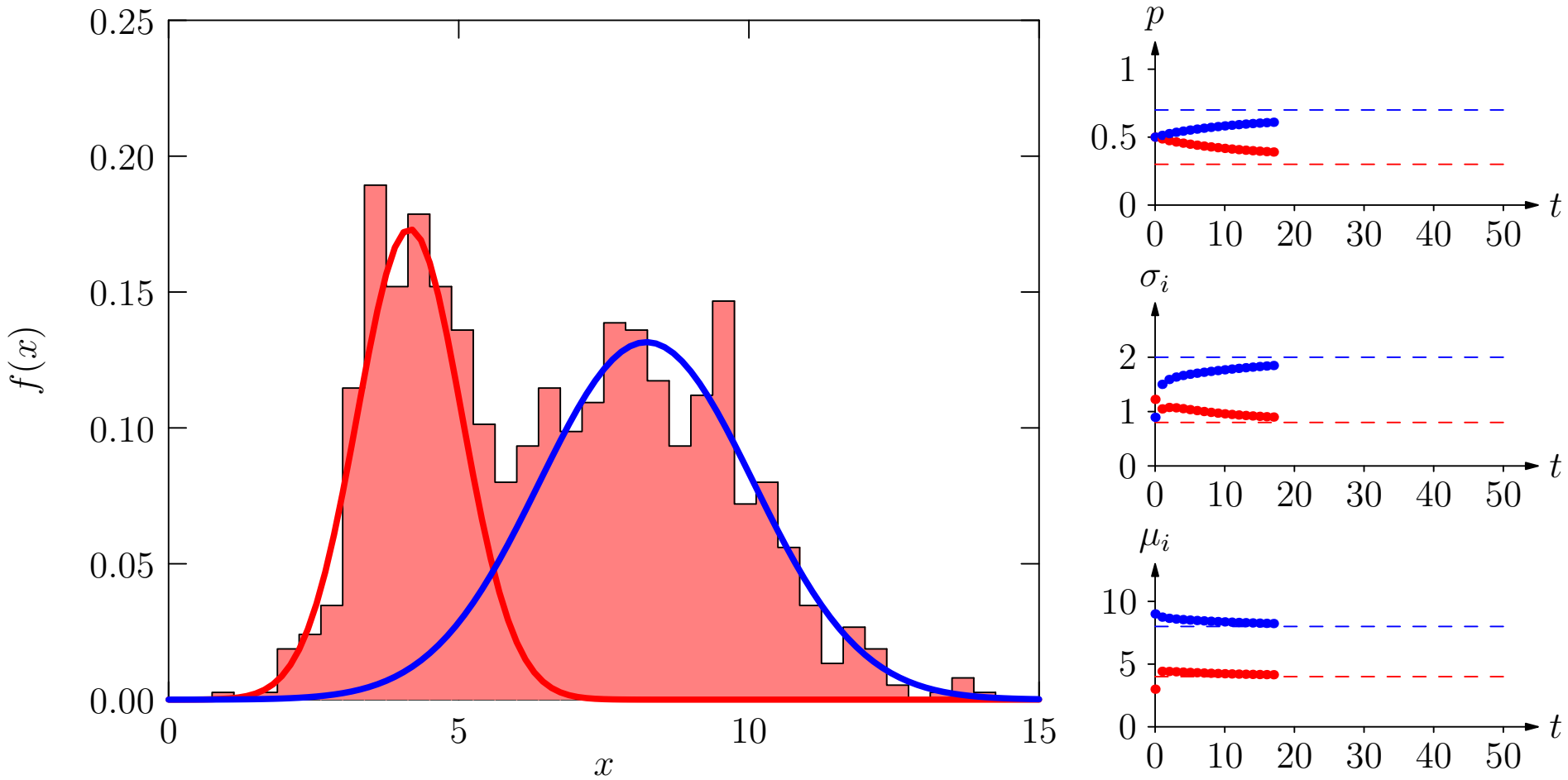
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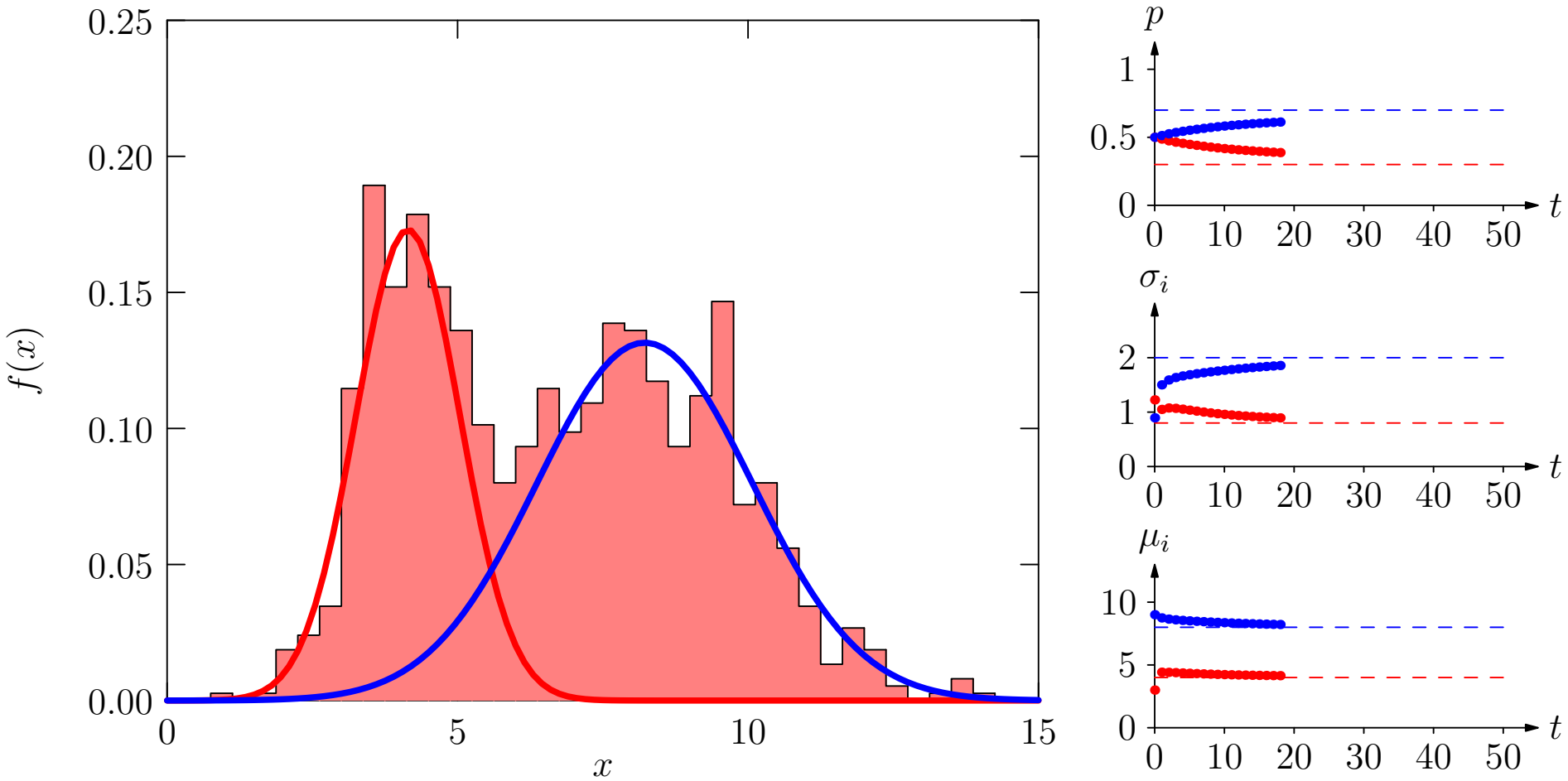
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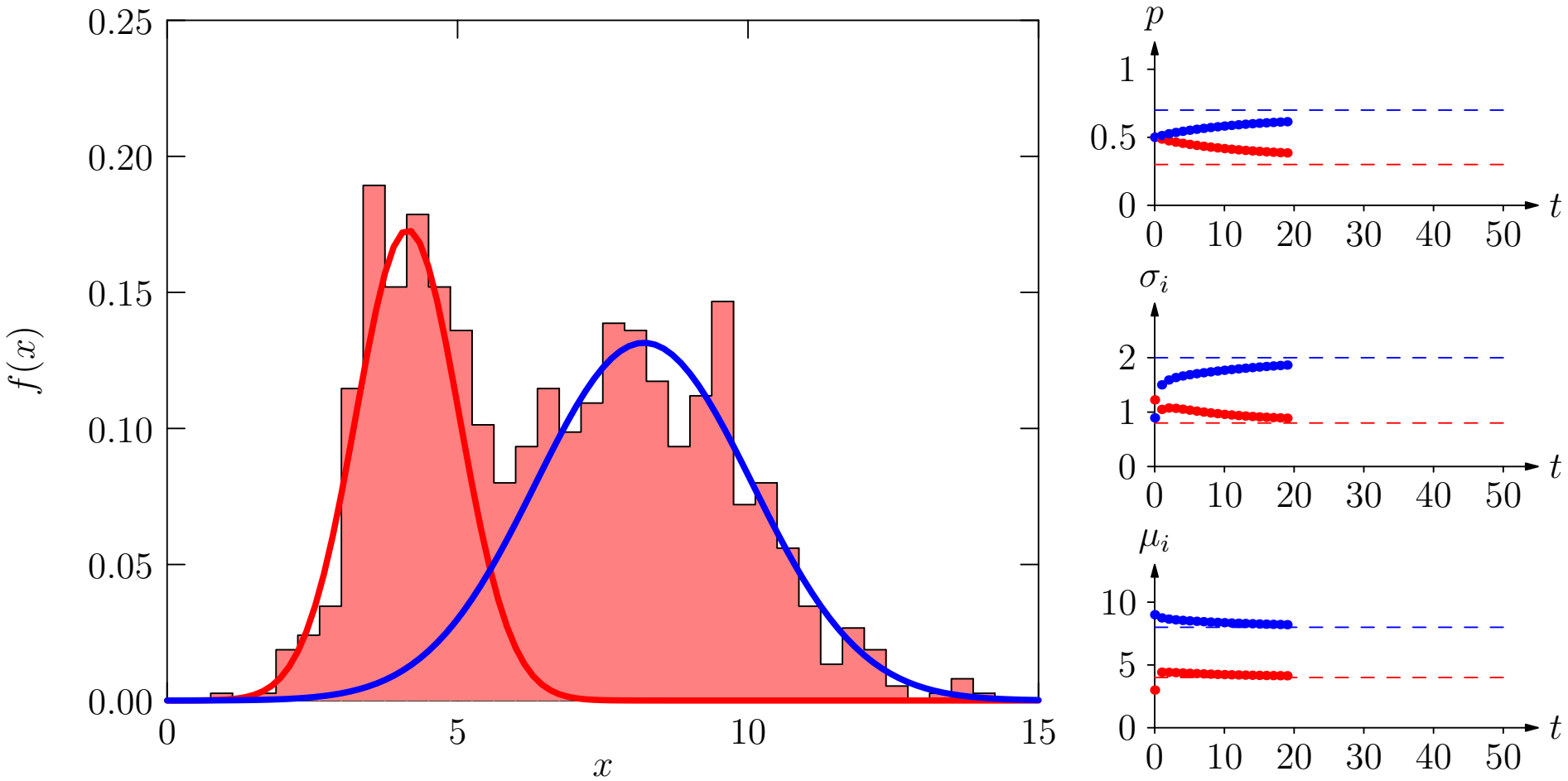
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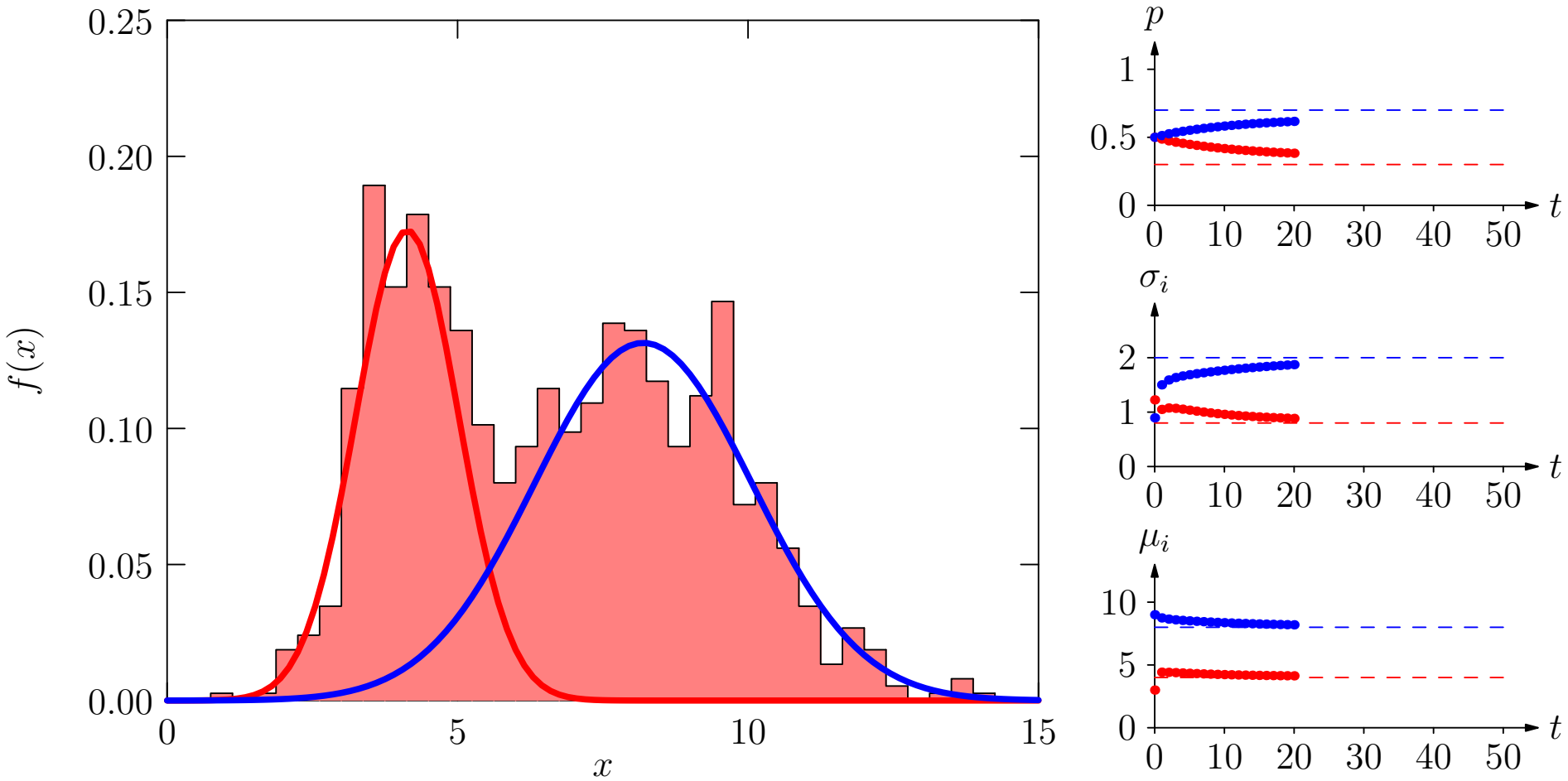
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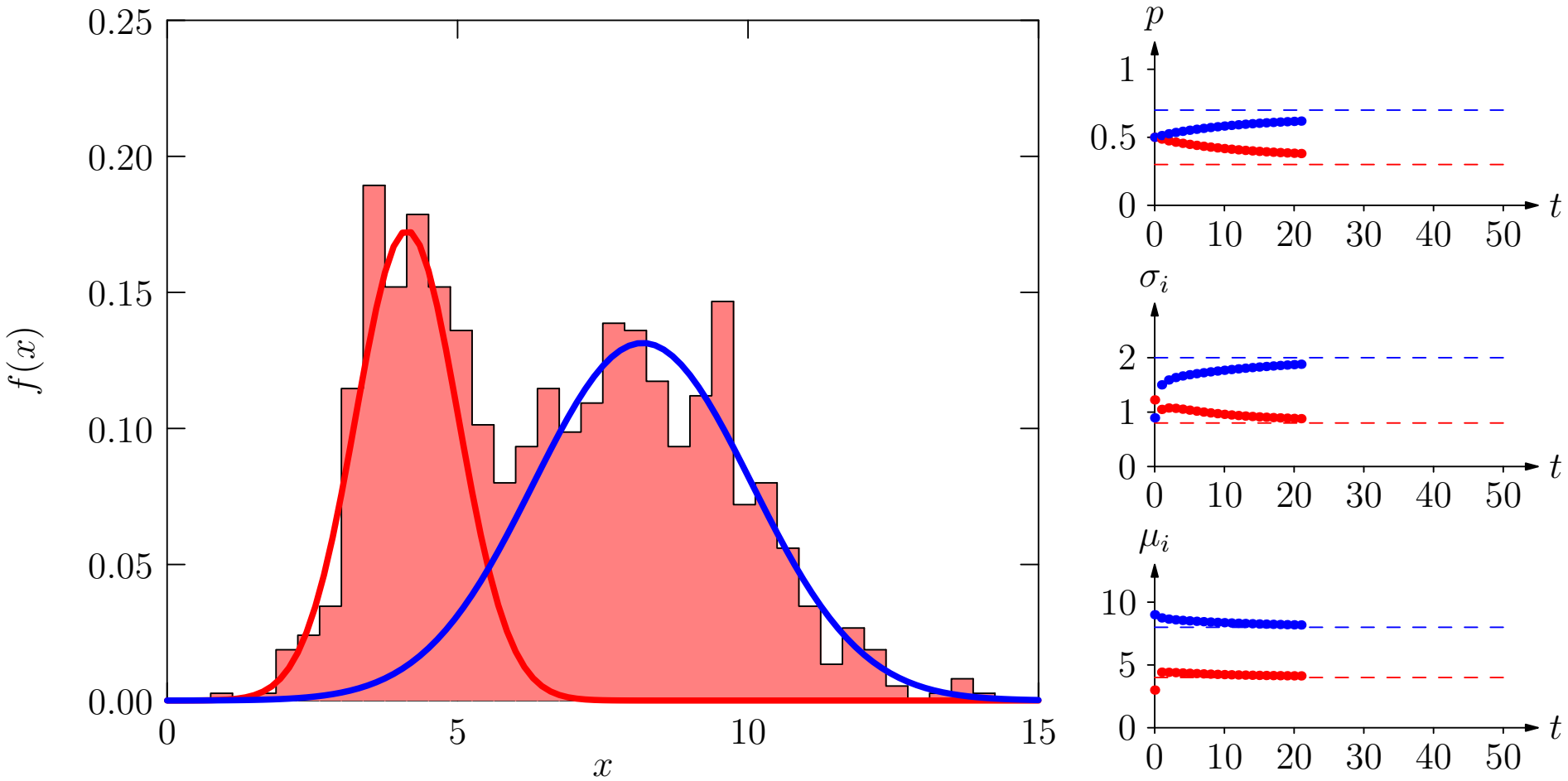
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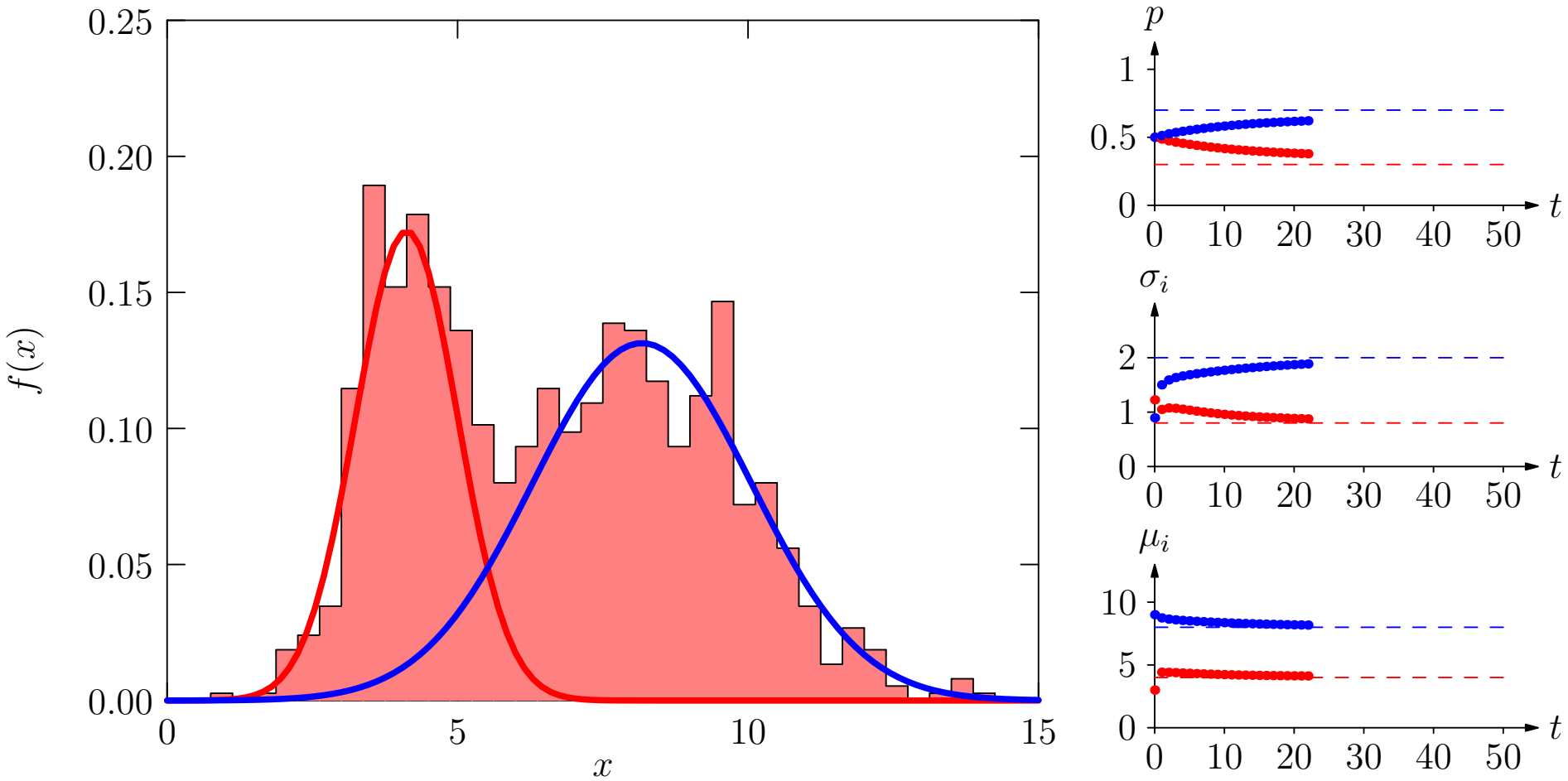
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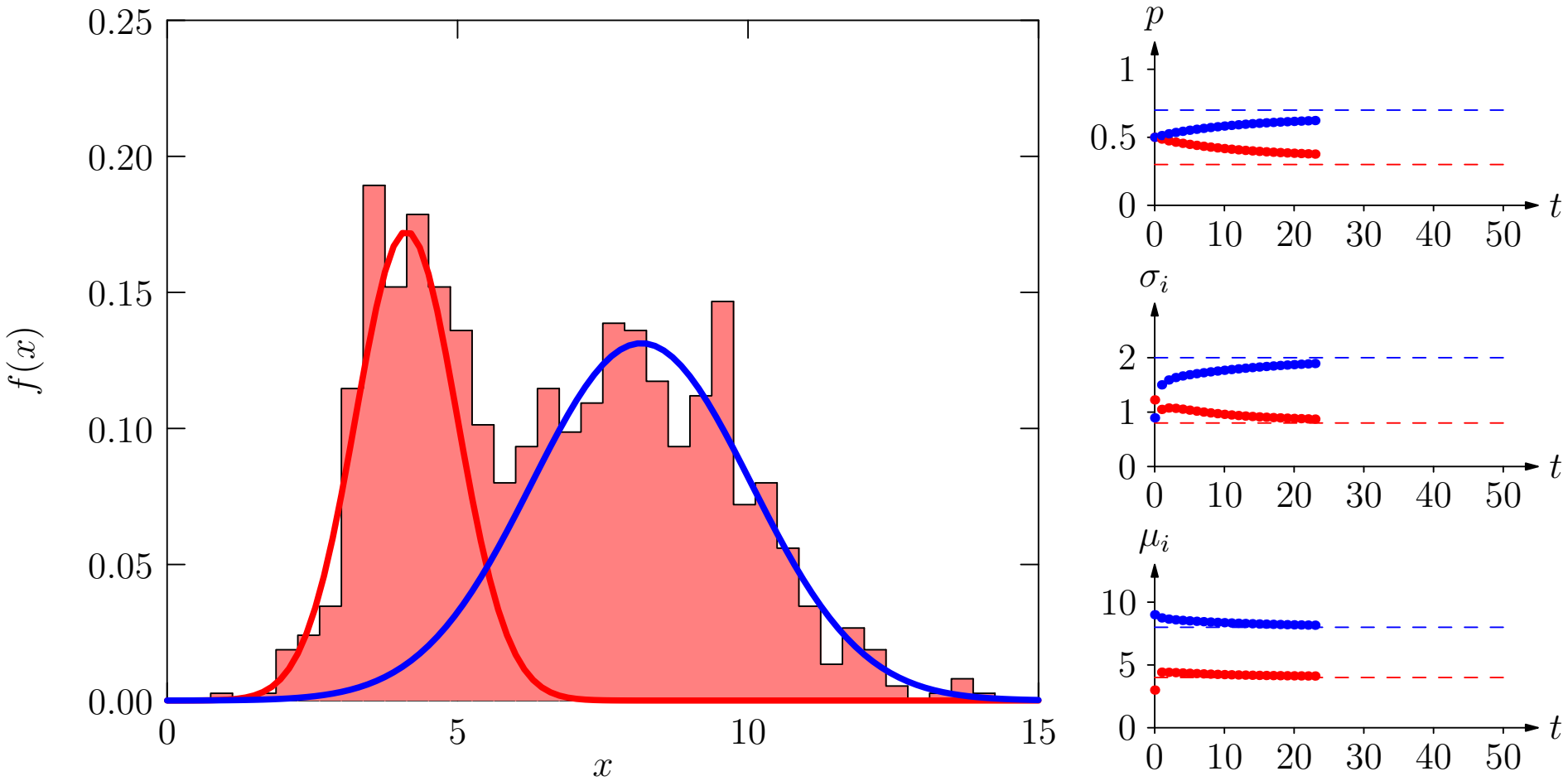
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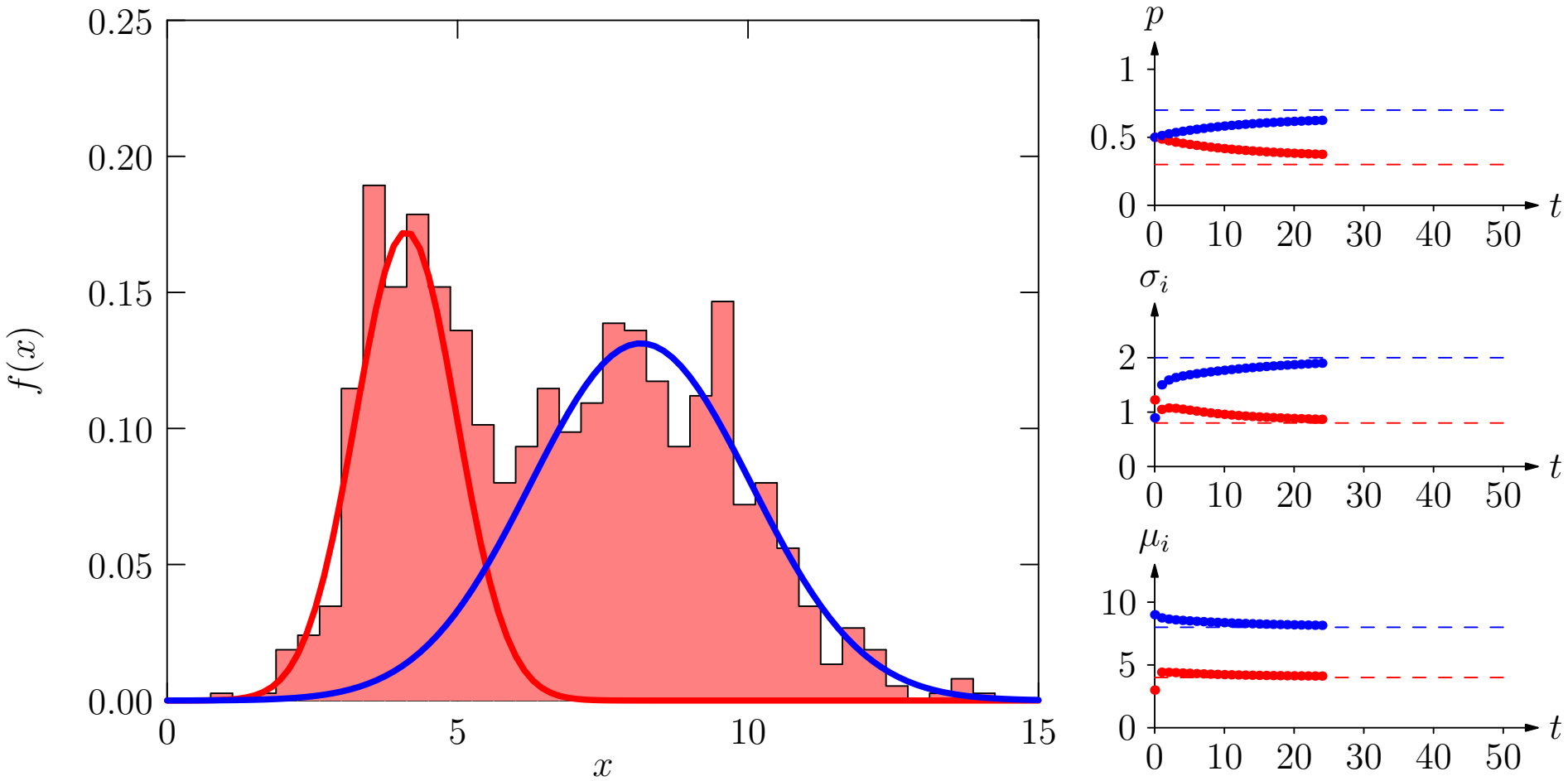
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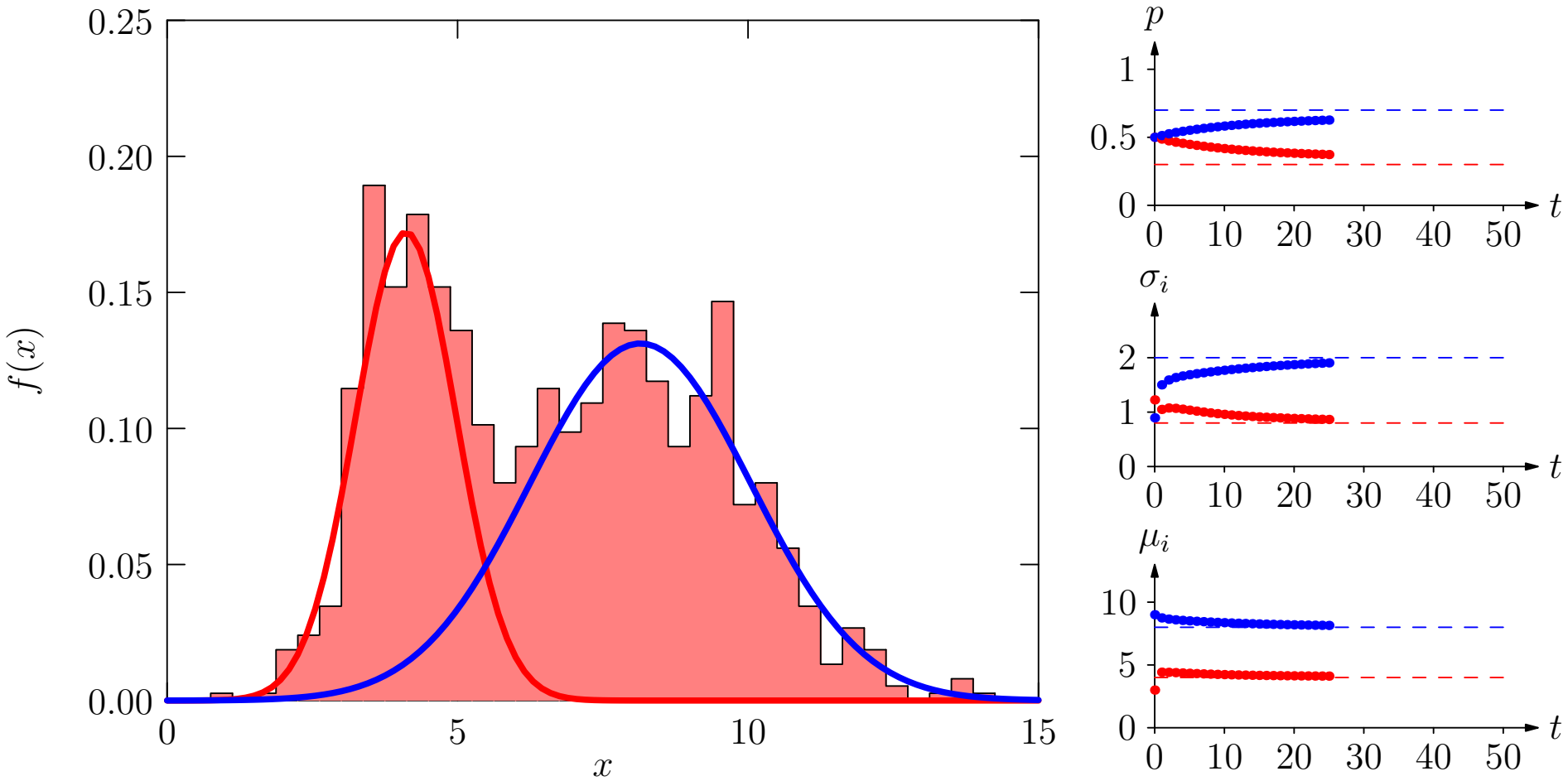
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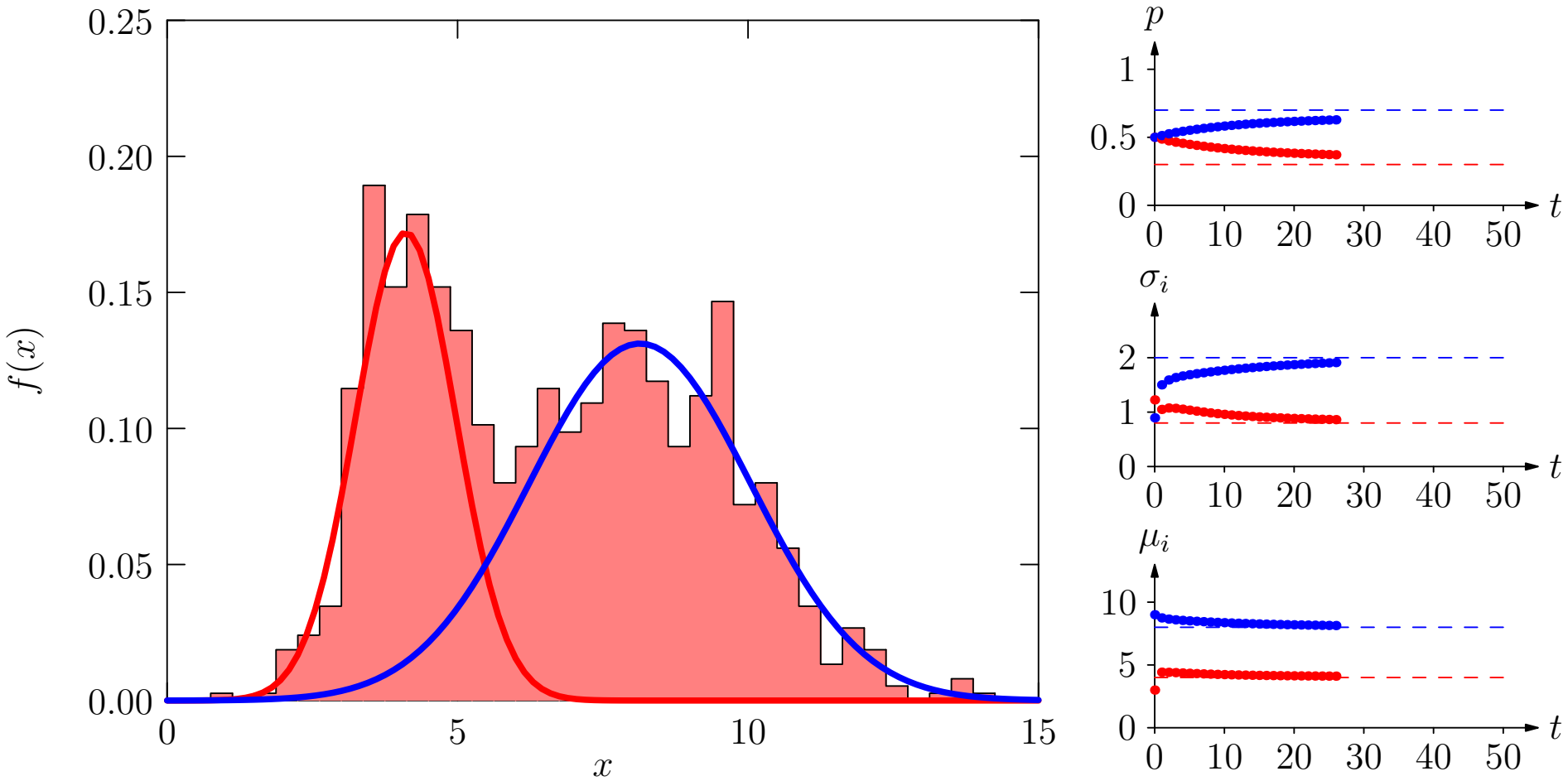
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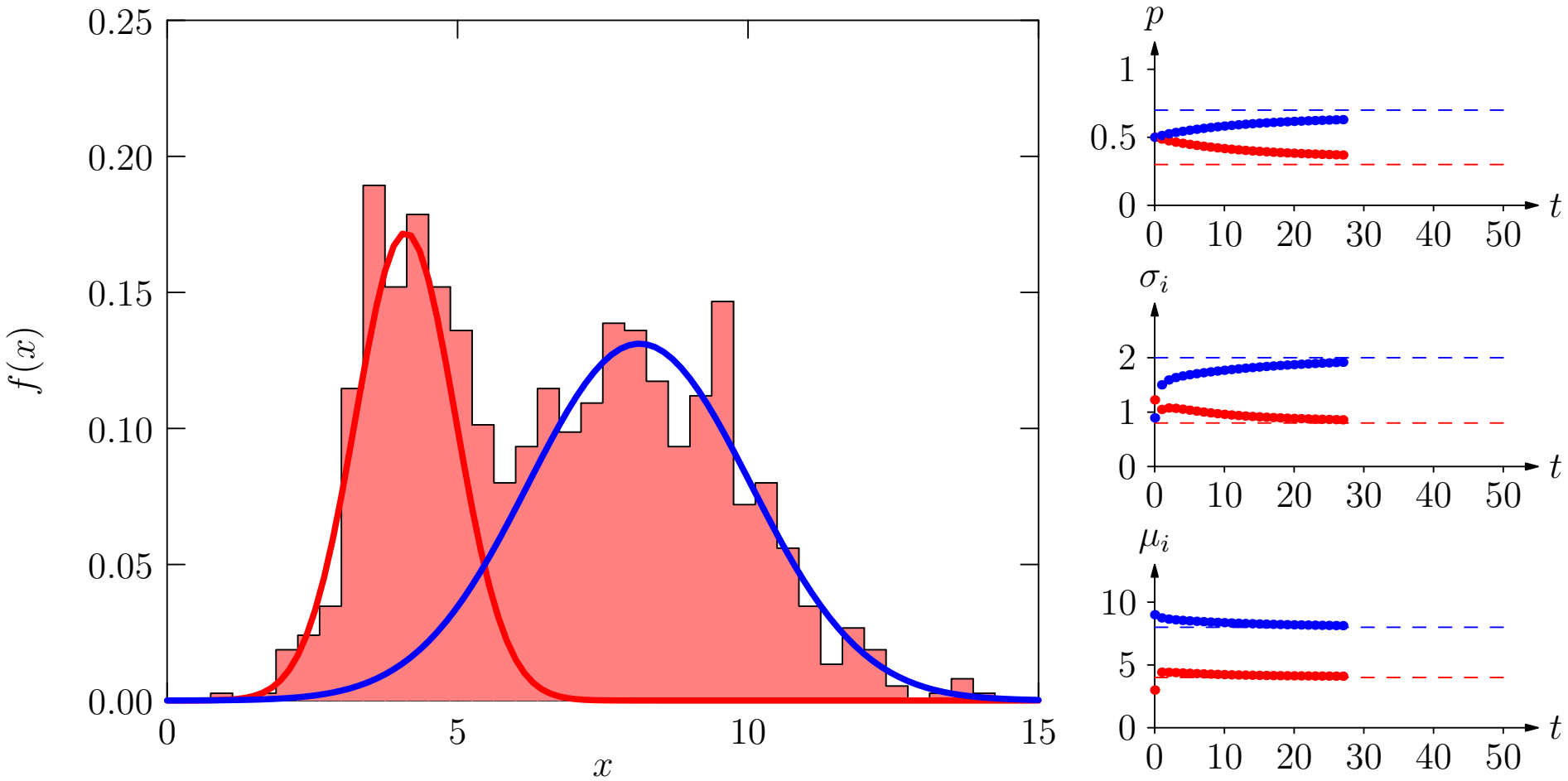
Example


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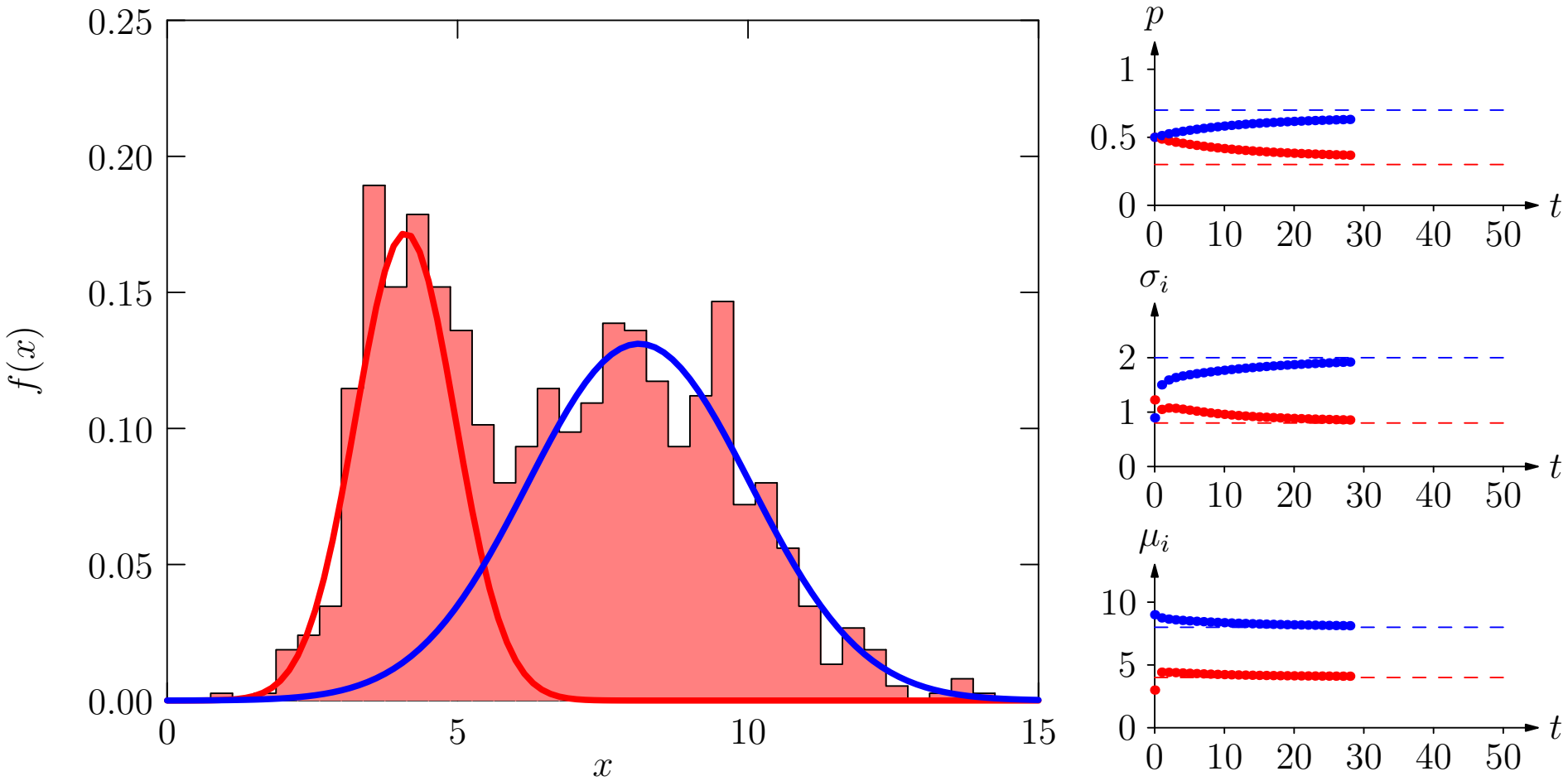
Example


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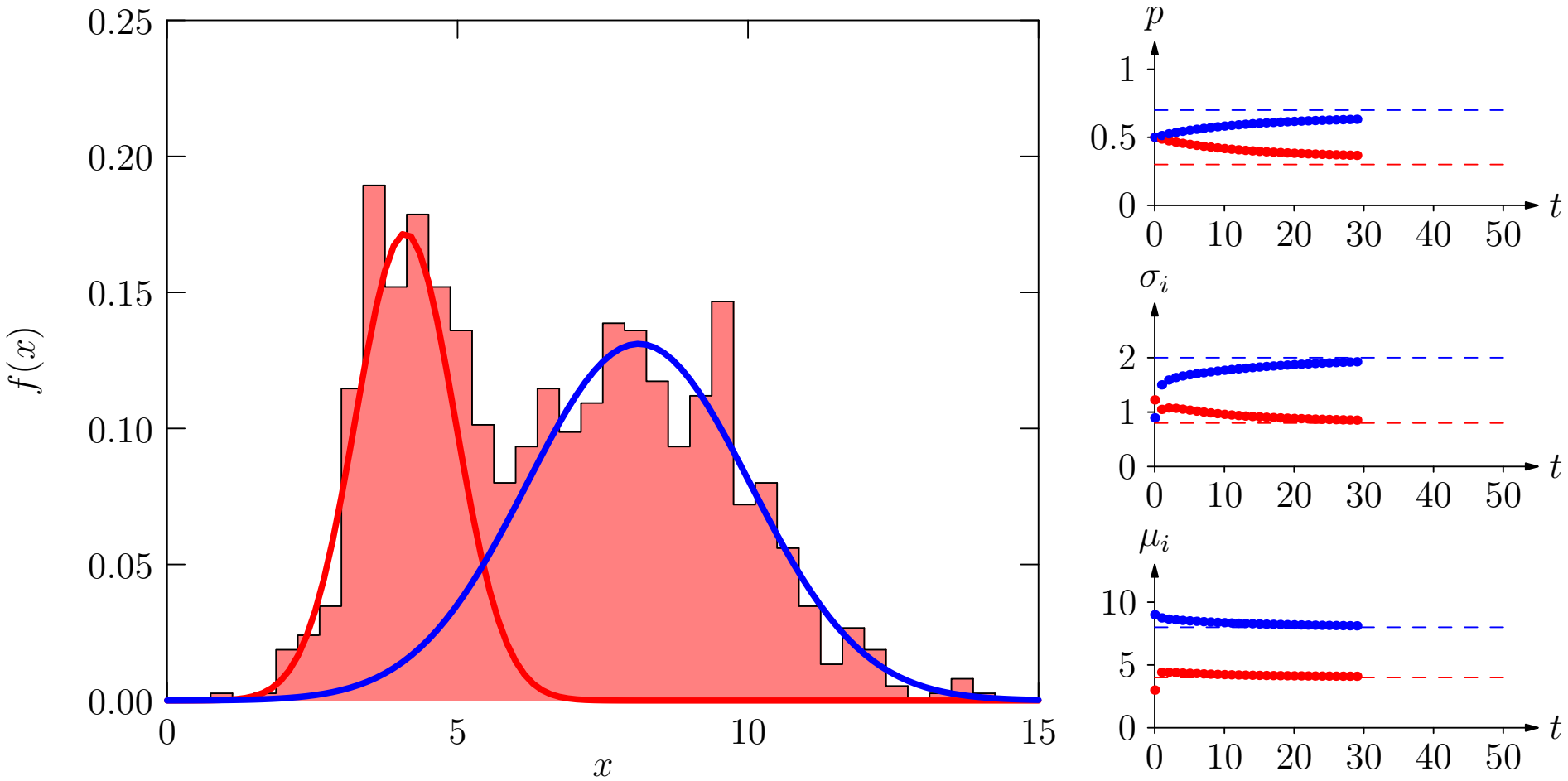
Example


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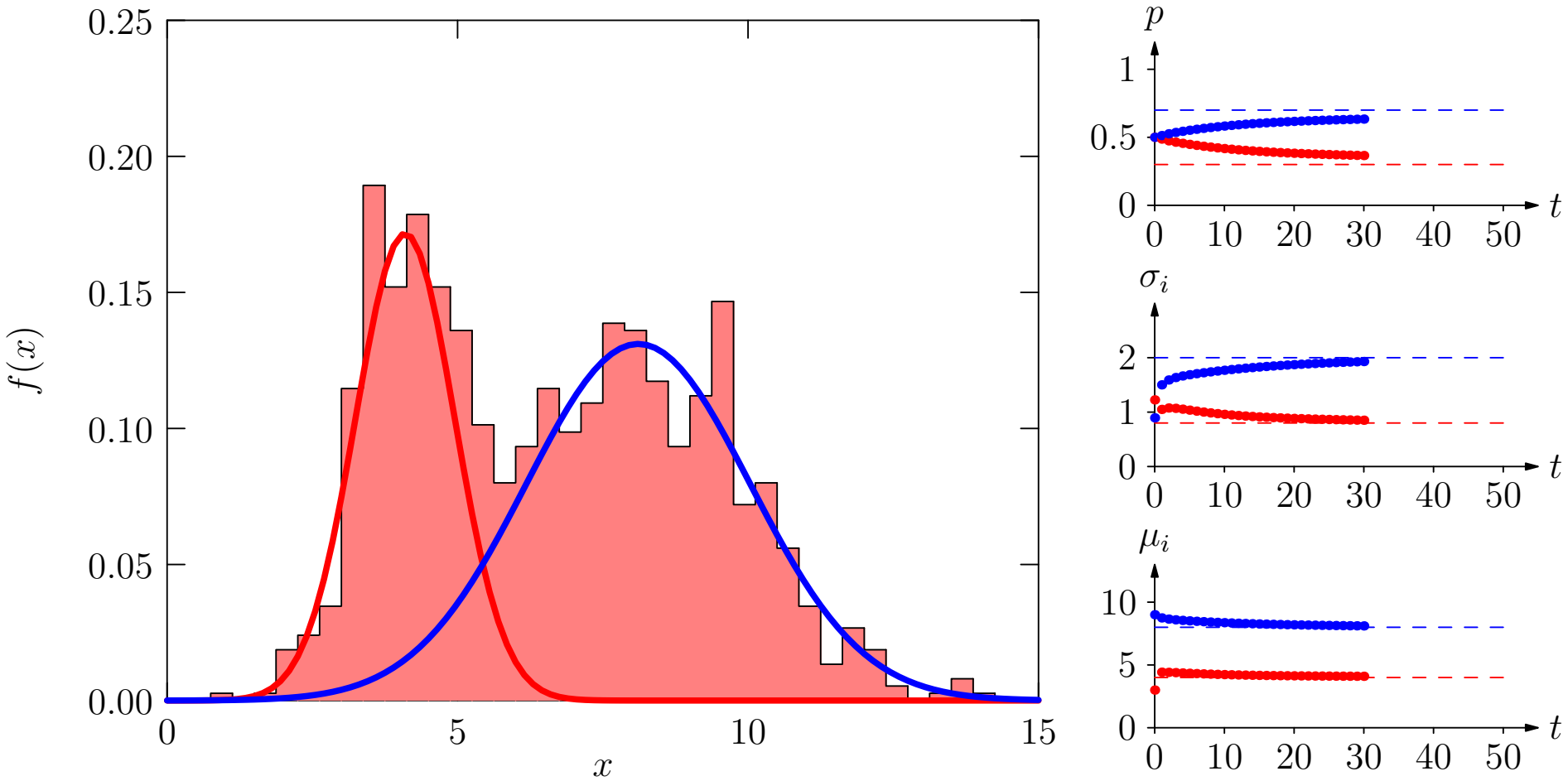
Example


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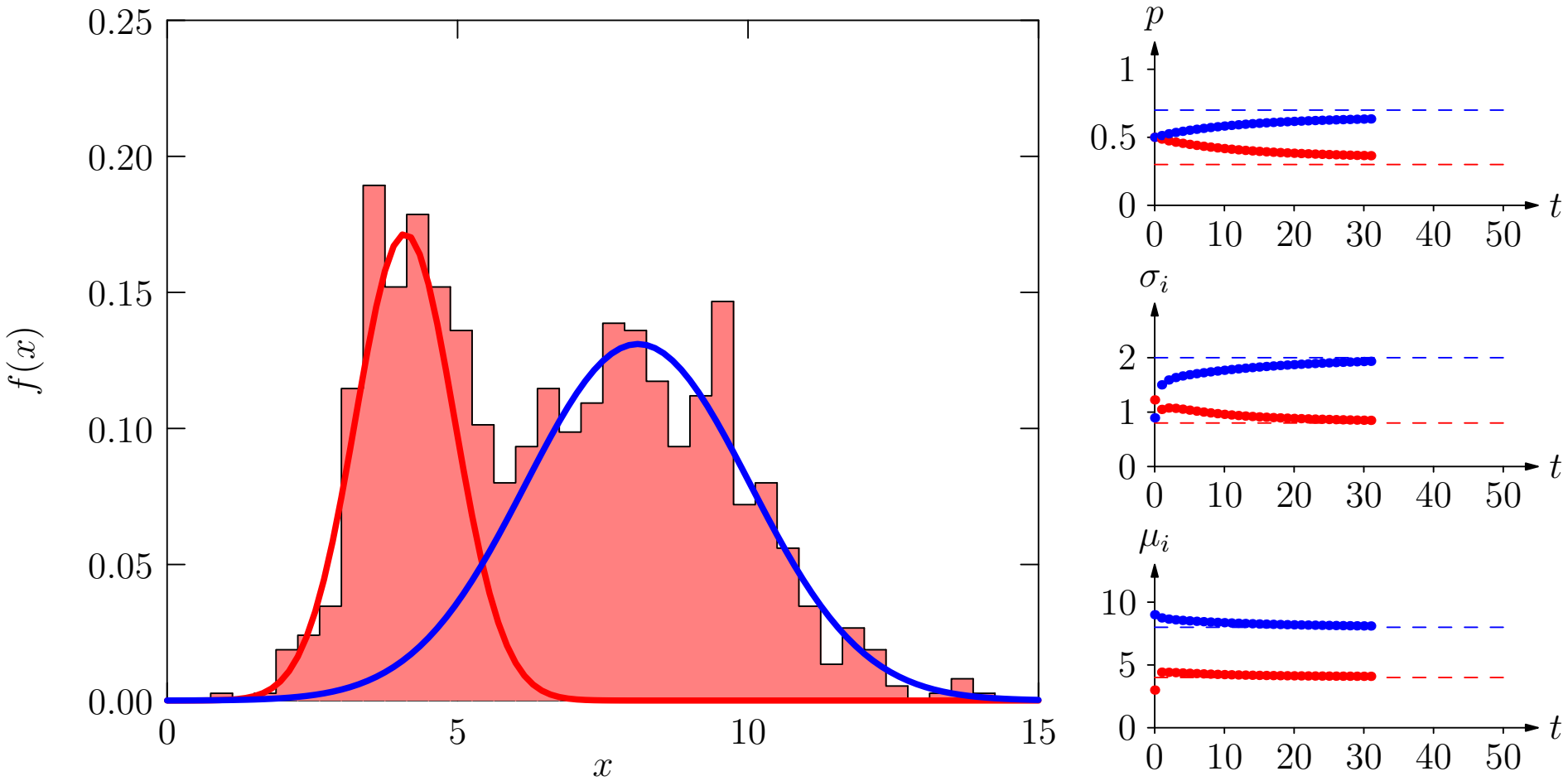
Example


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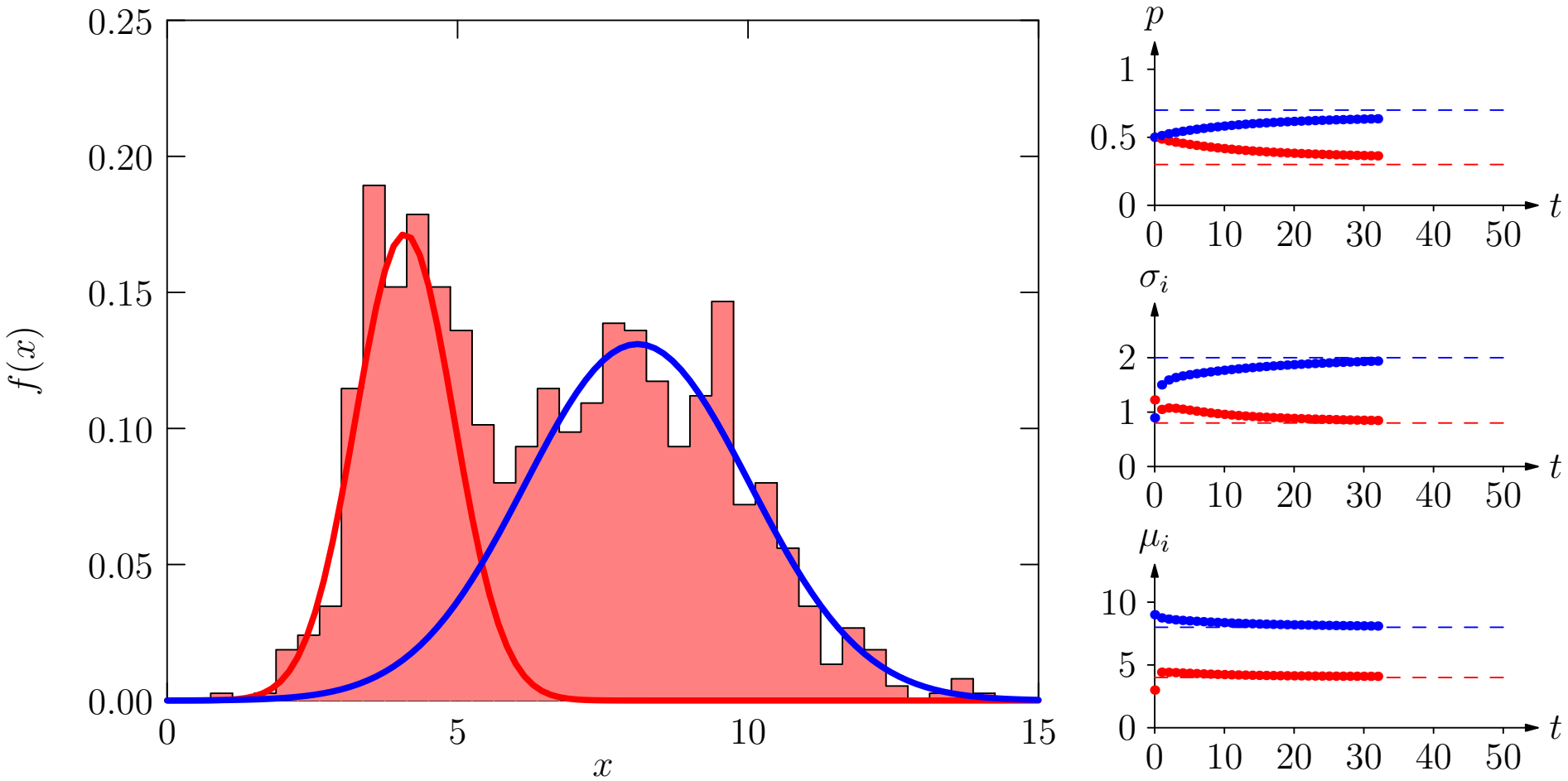
Example


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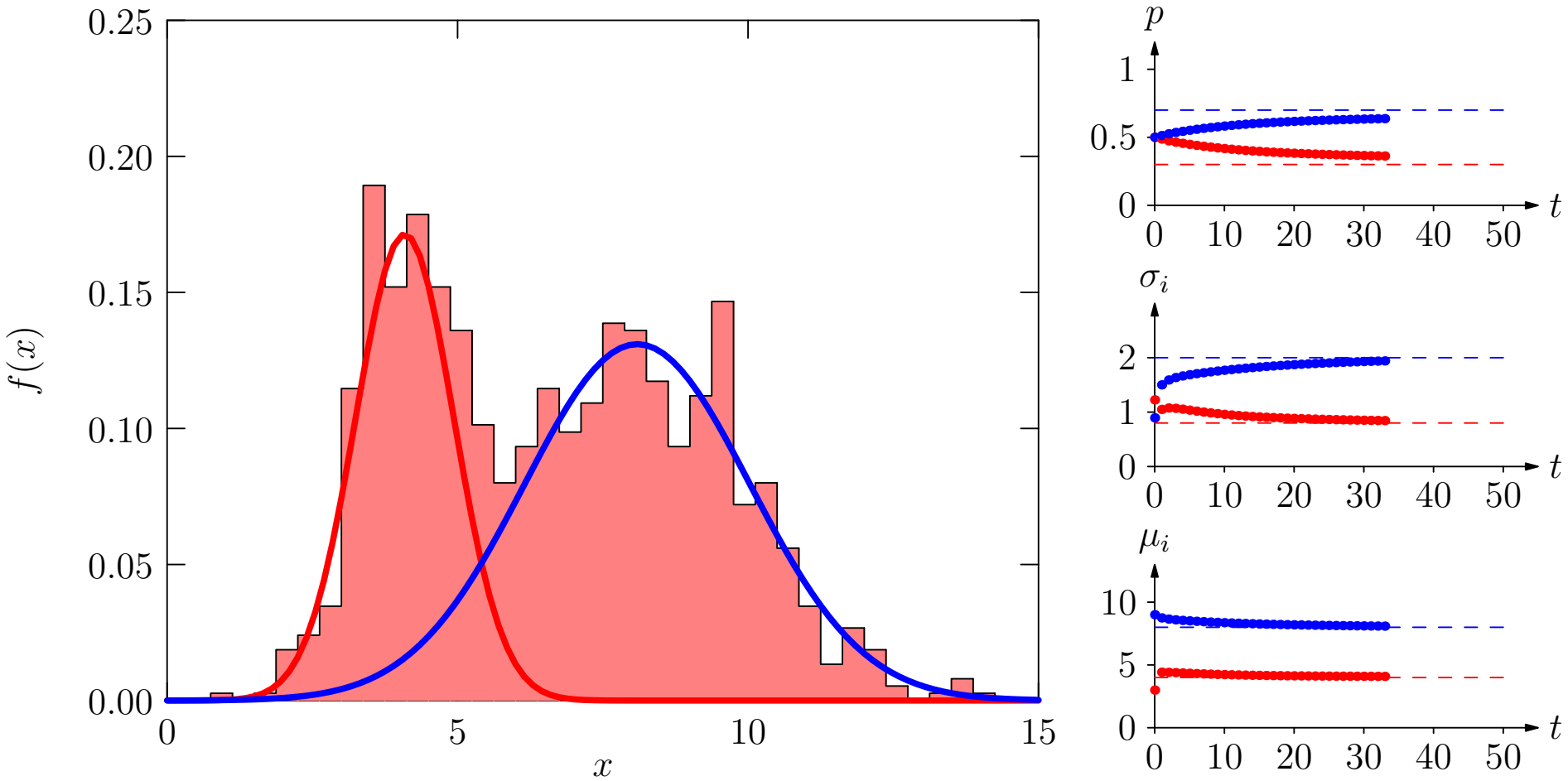
Example


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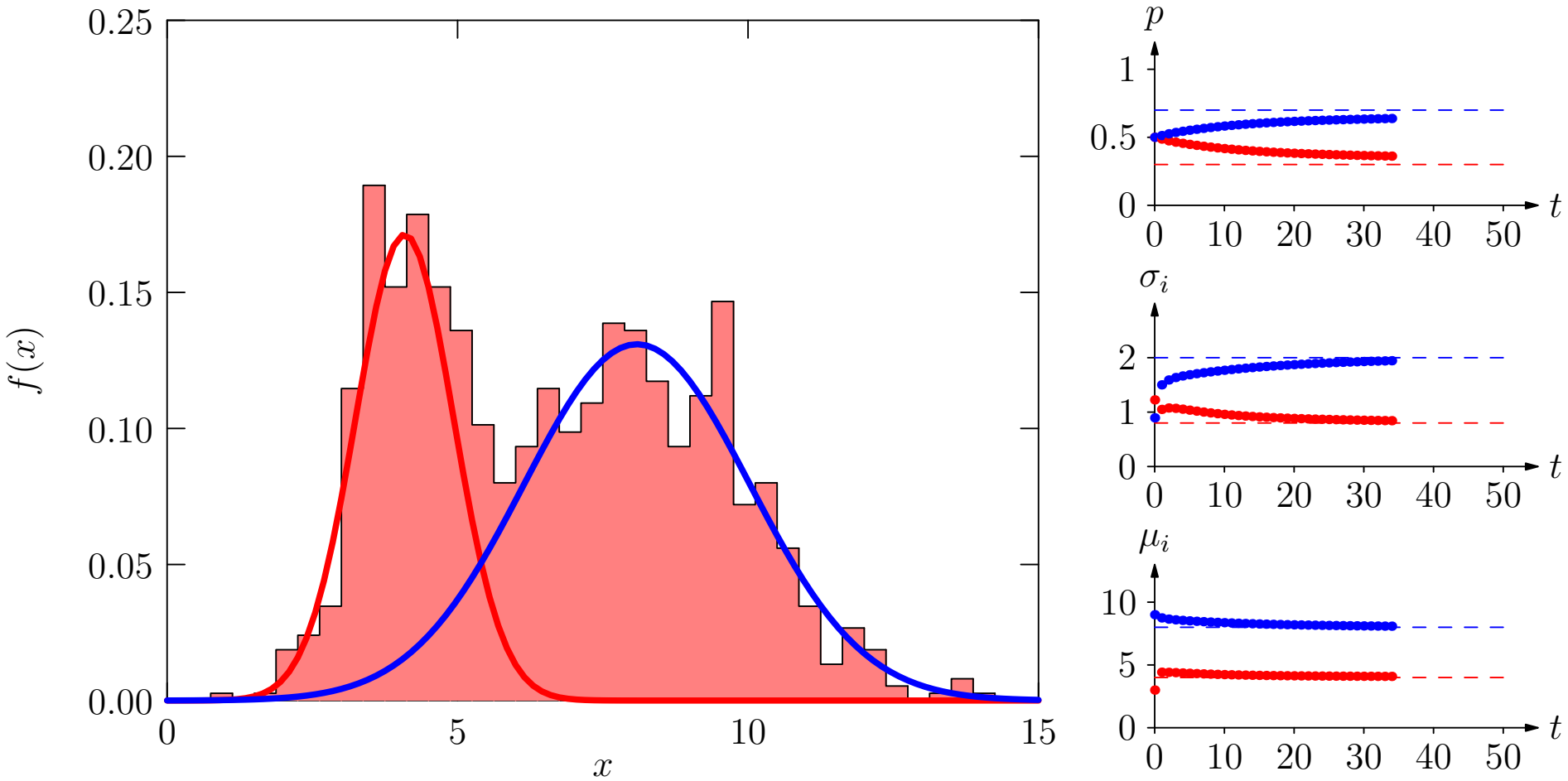
Example


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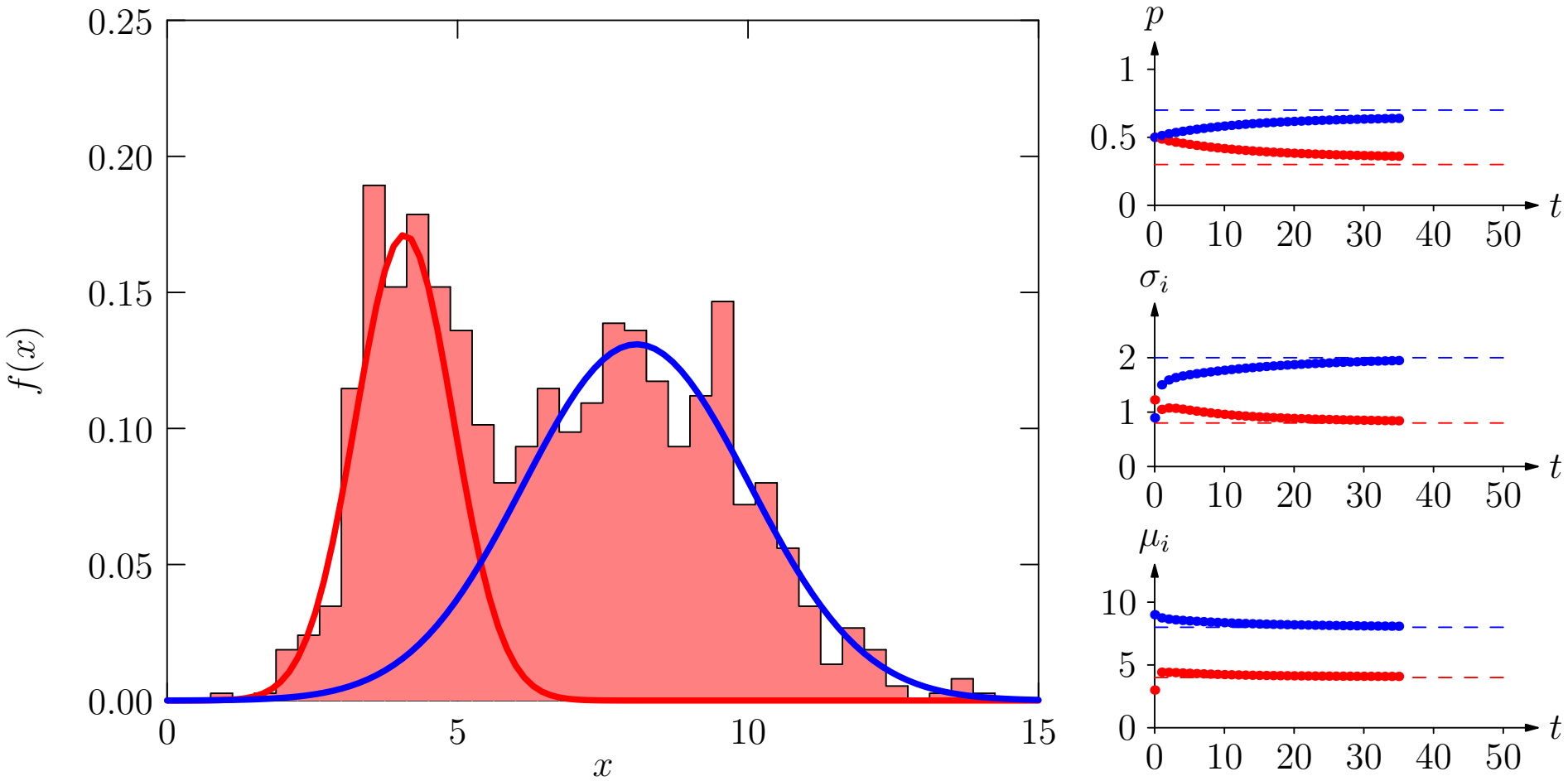
Example


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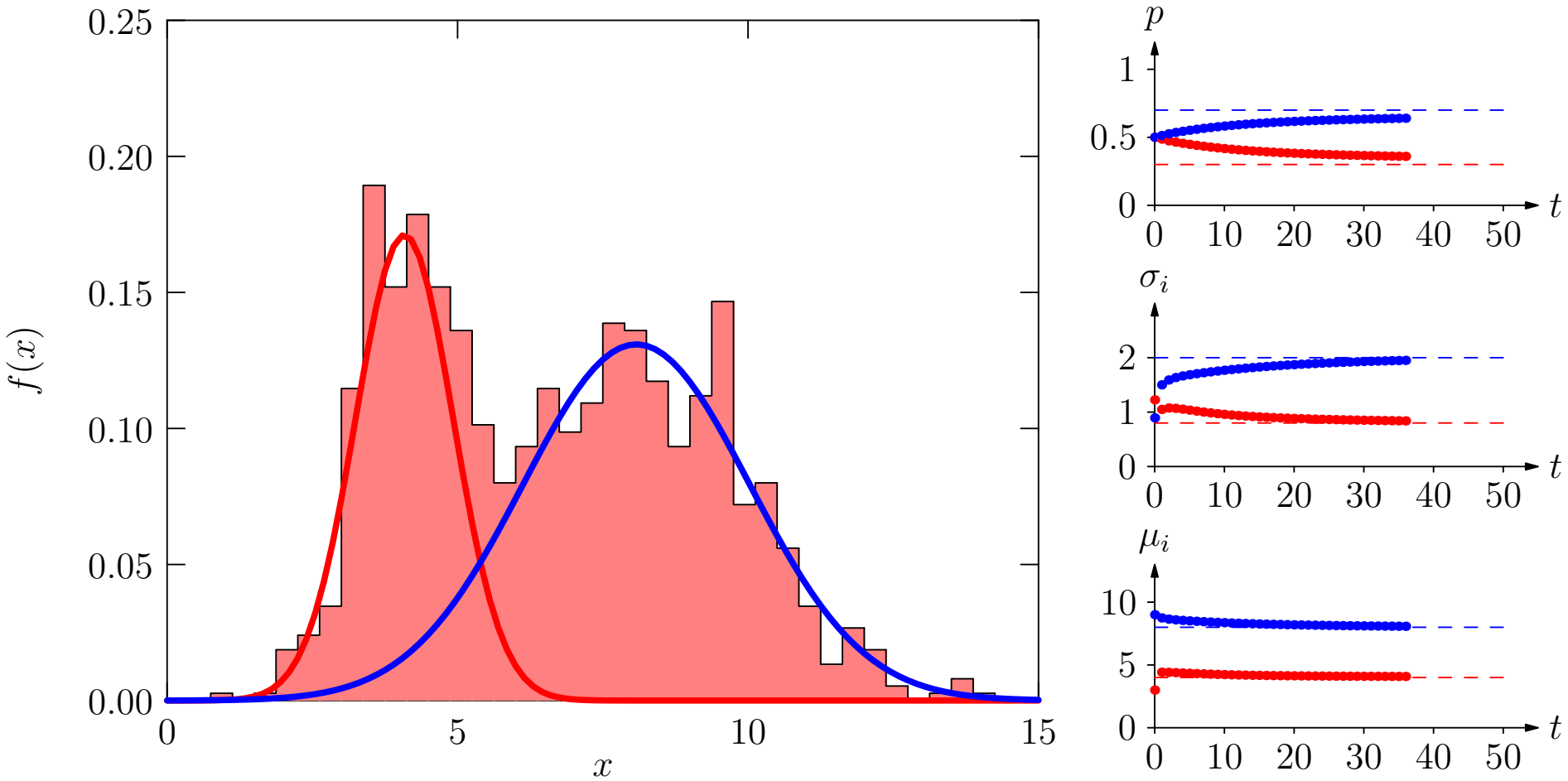
Example


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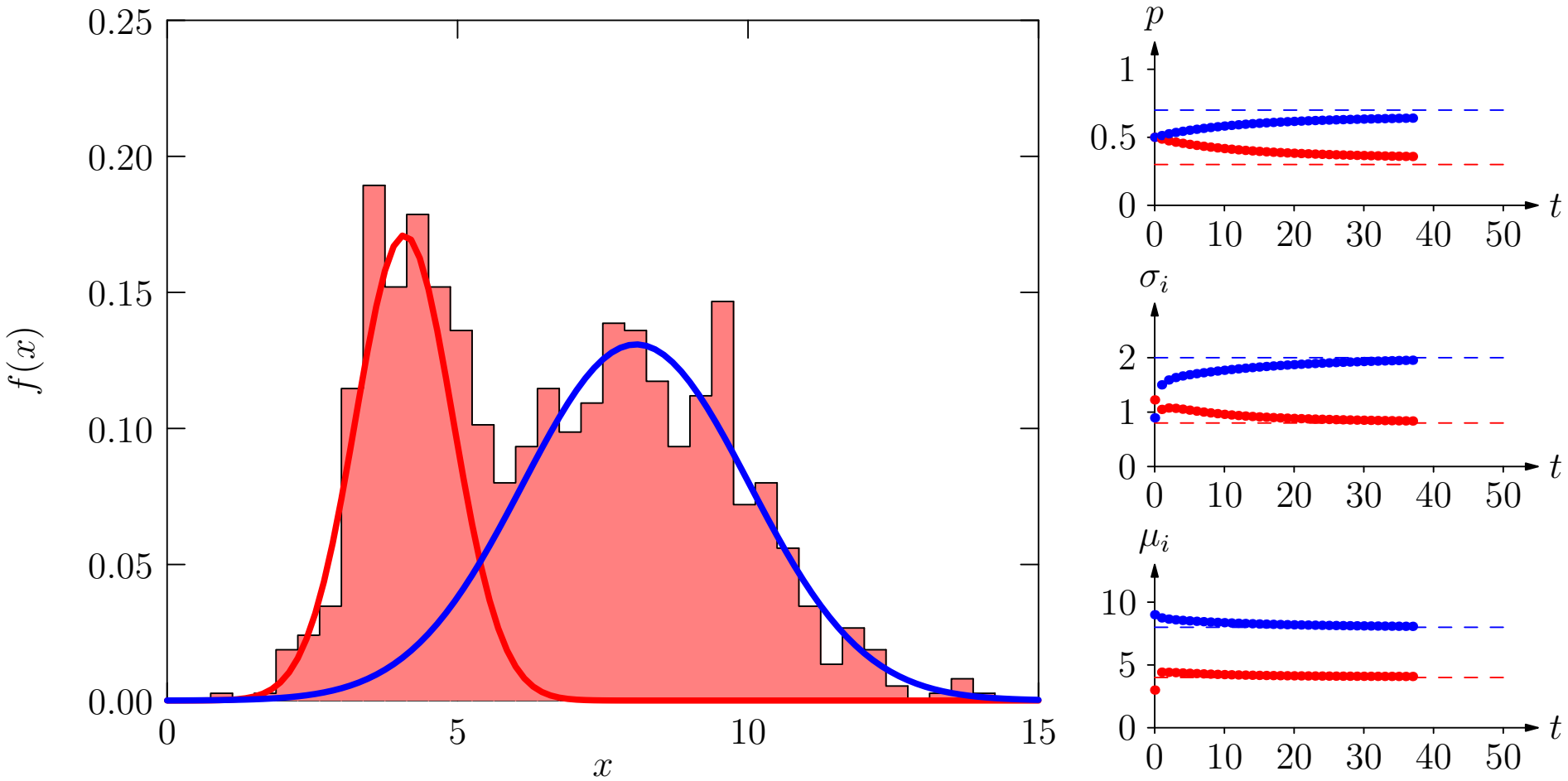
Example


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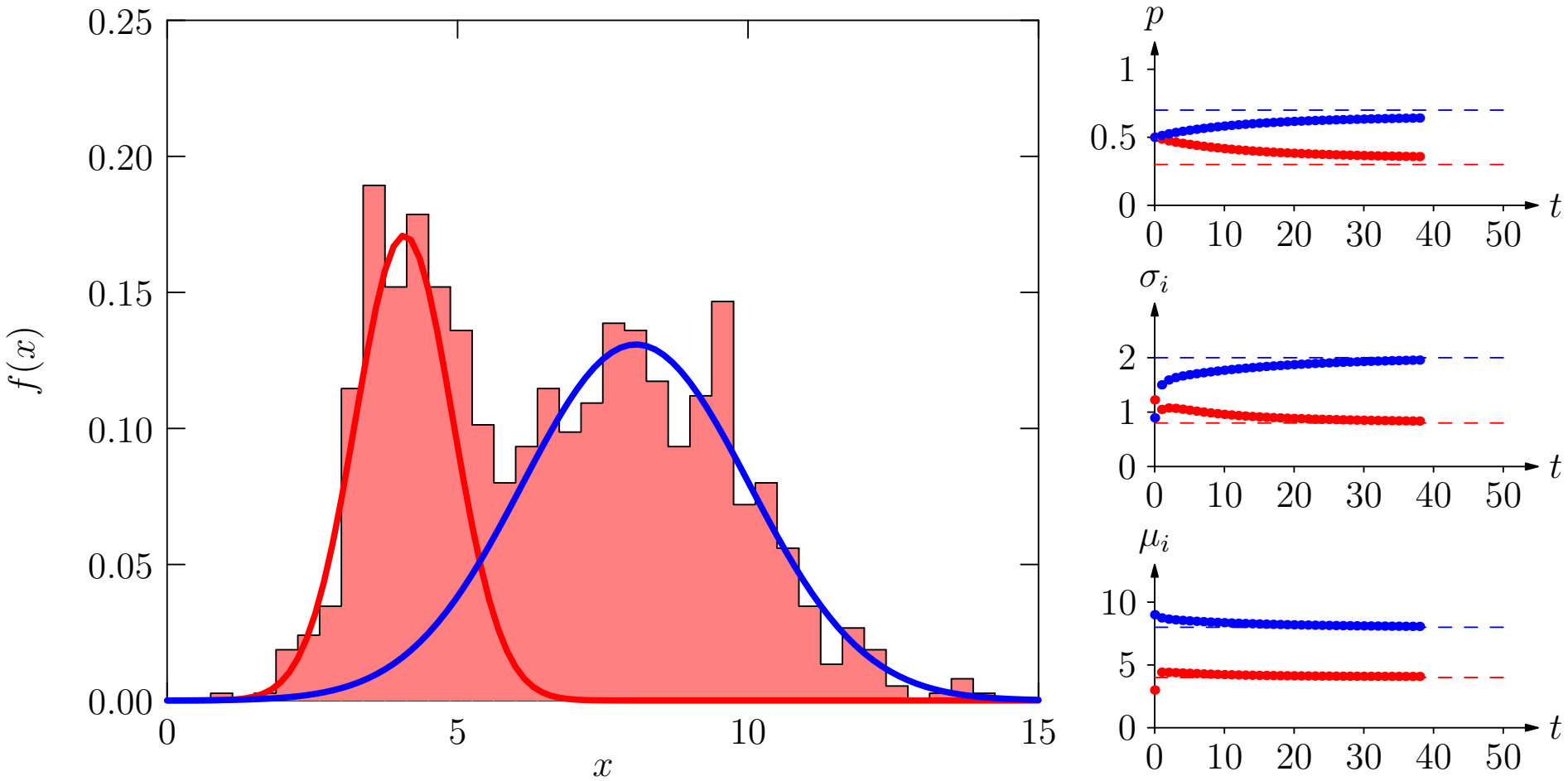
Example


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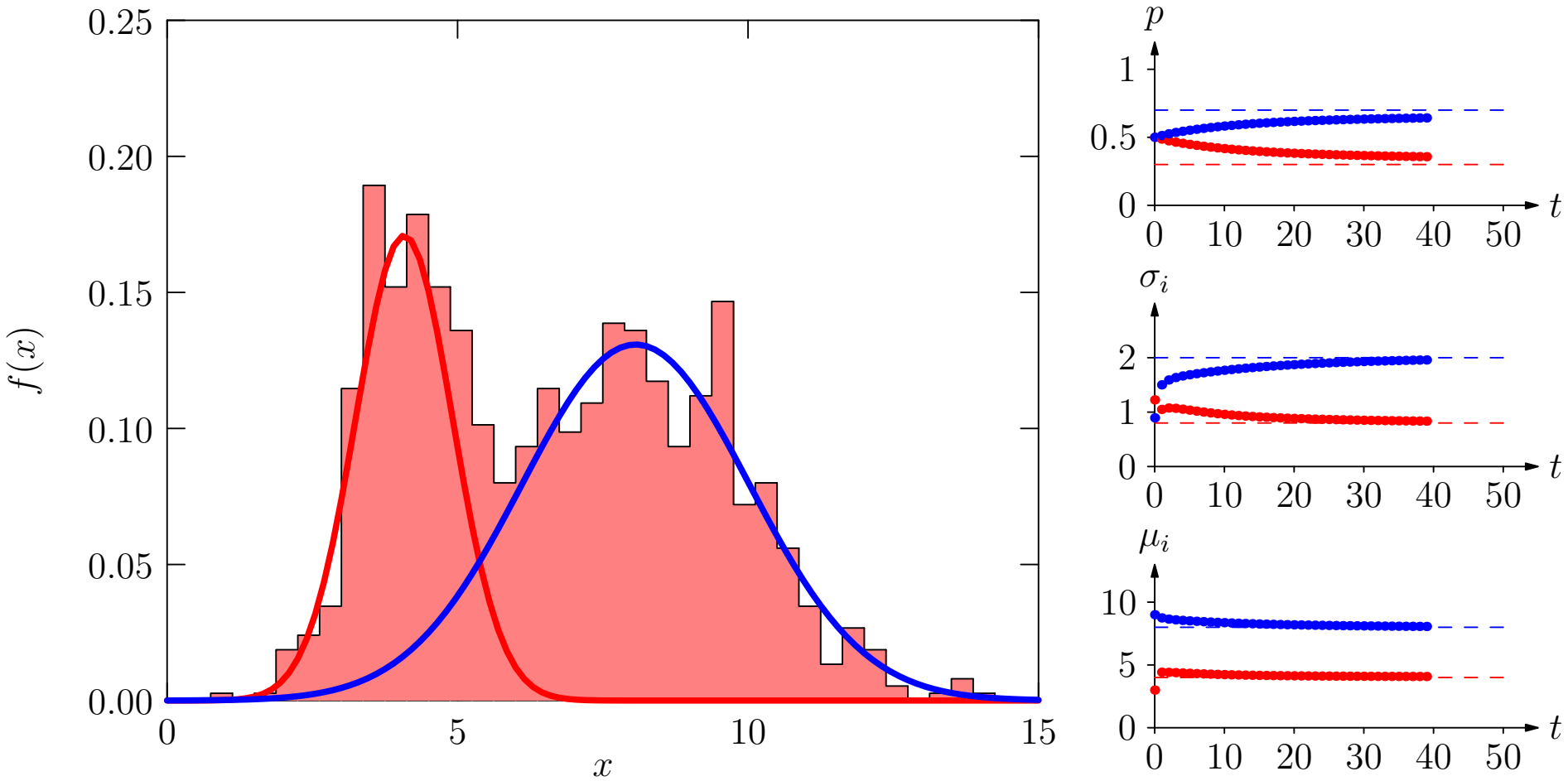
Example


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$f(x)$
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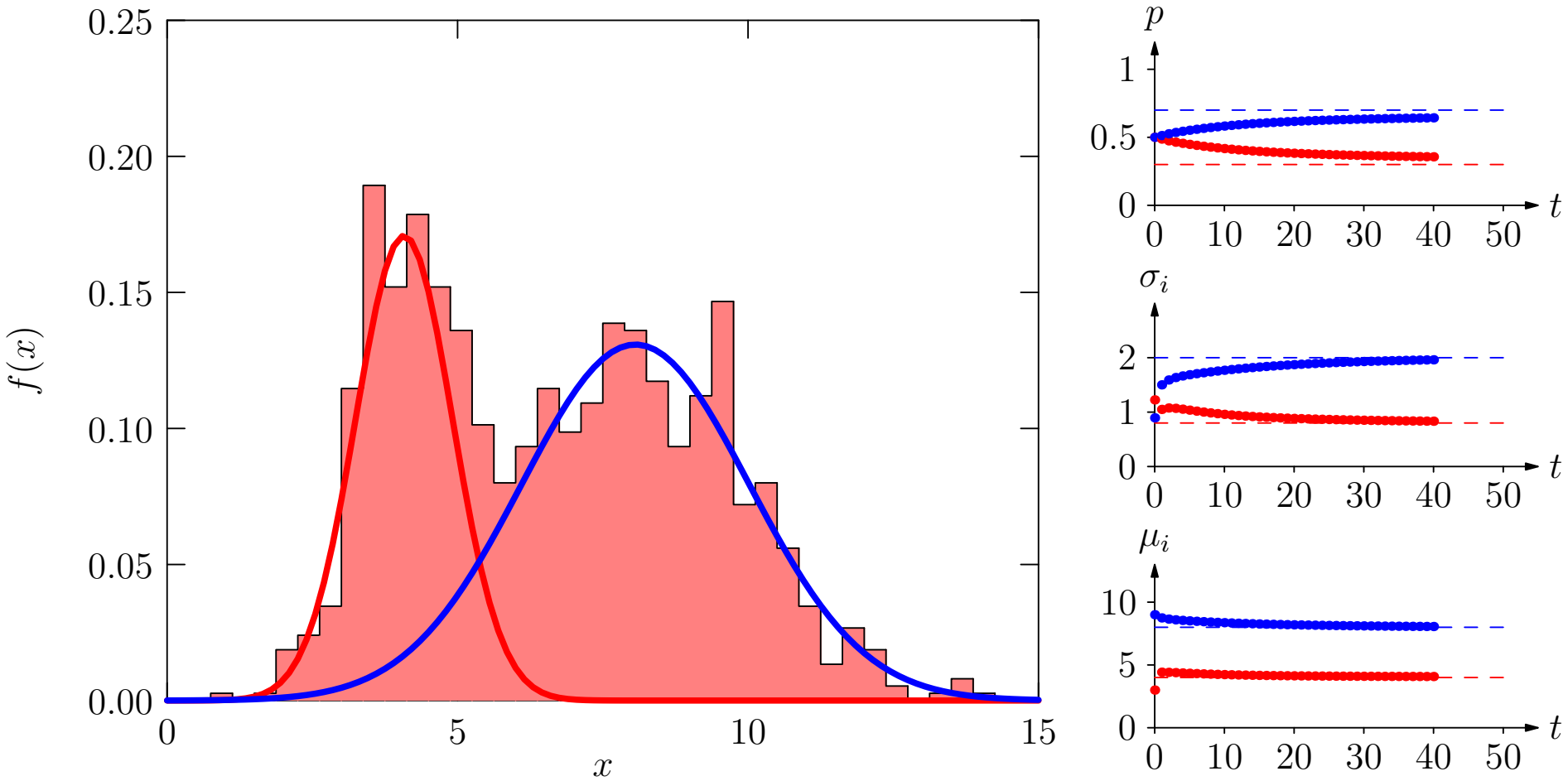
Example


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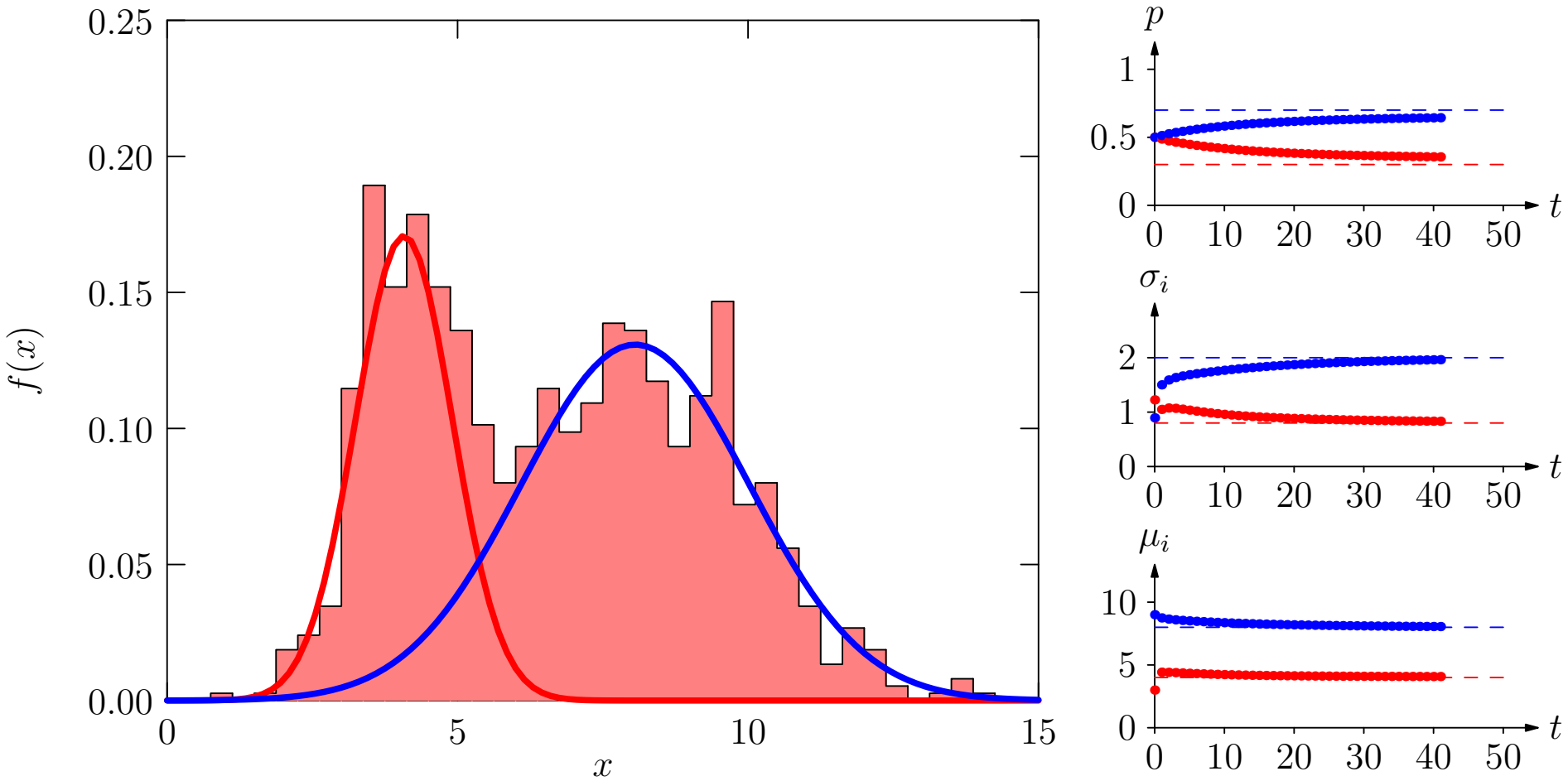
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$f(x)$
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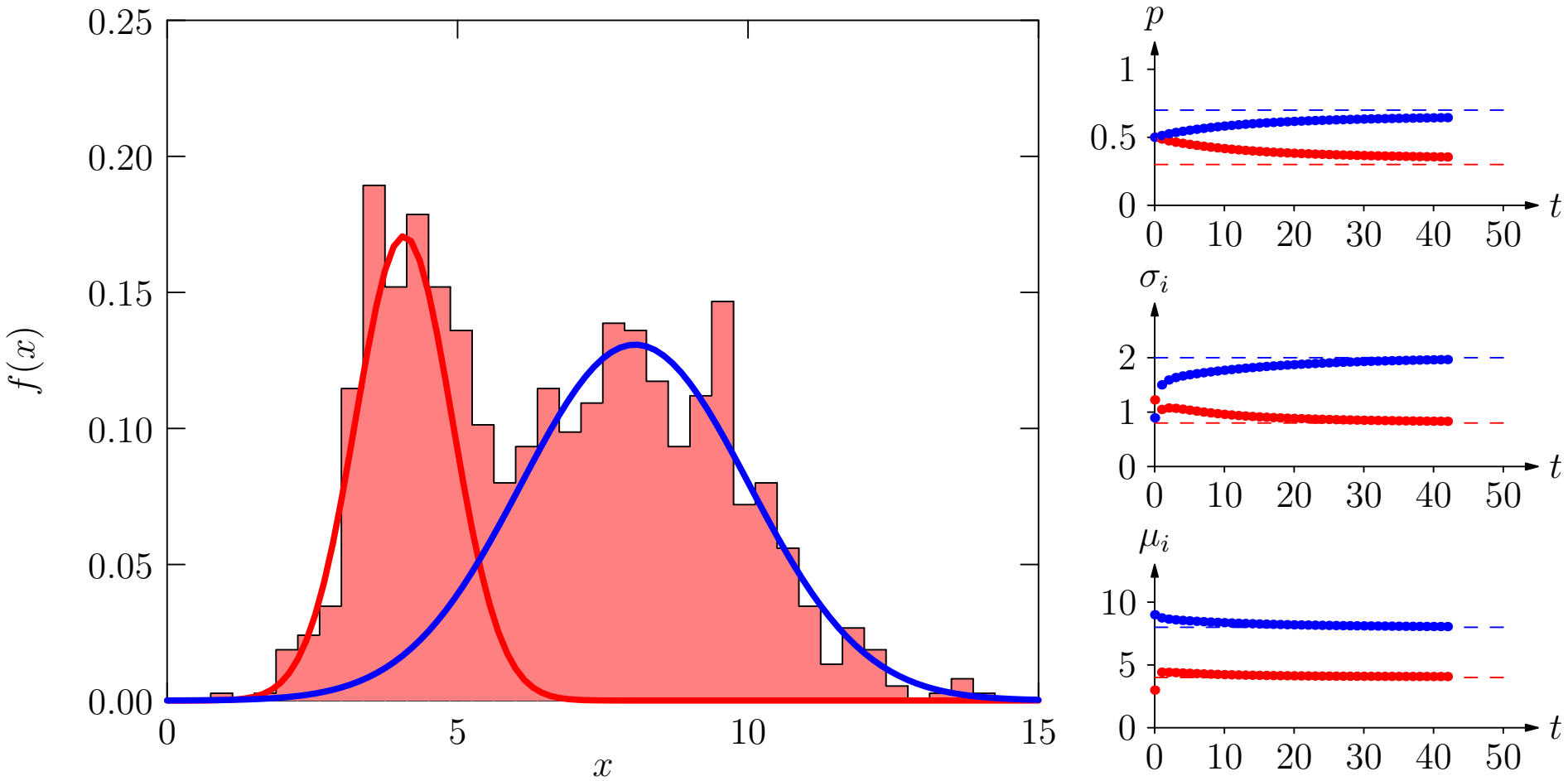
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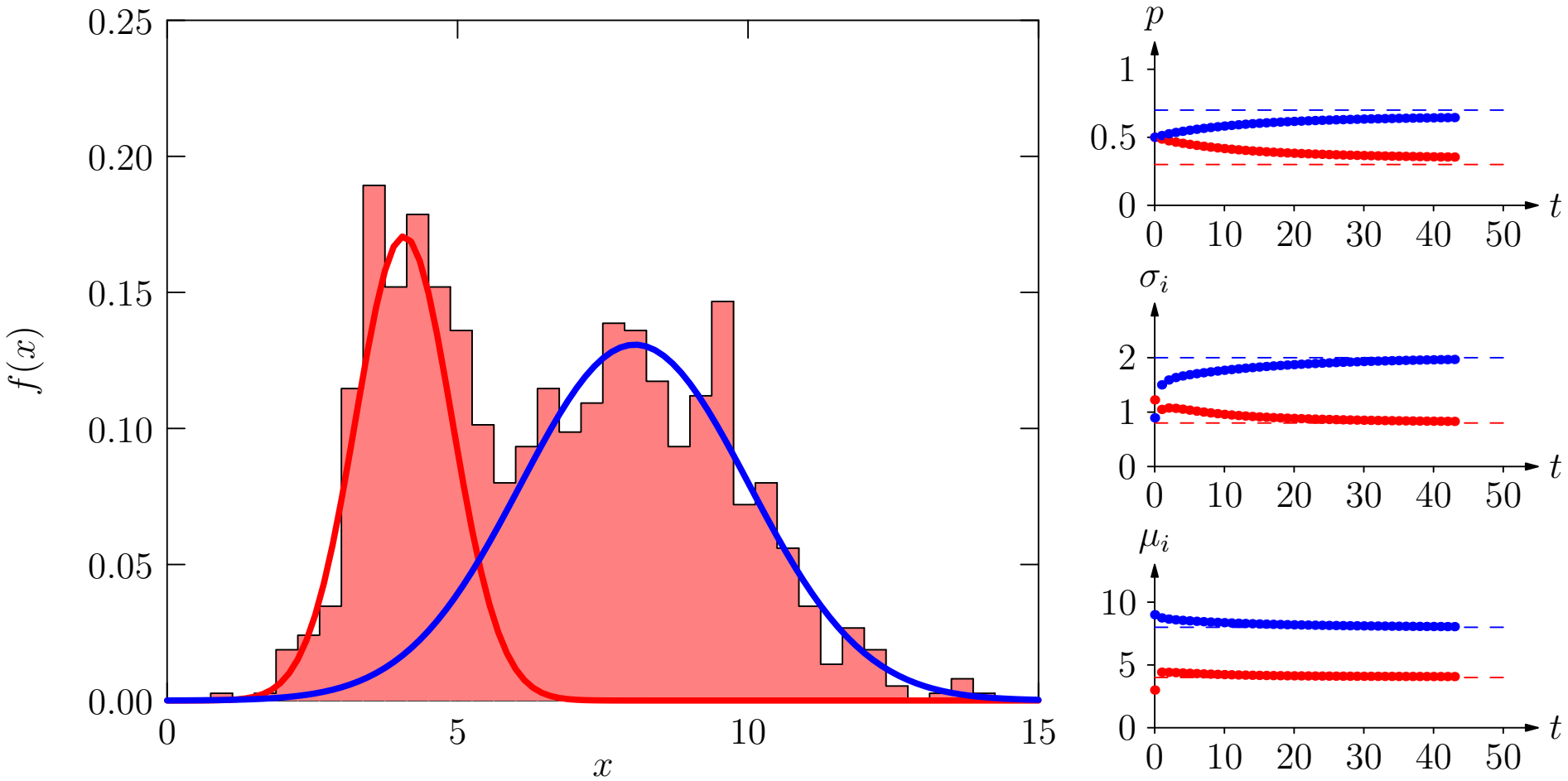
Example


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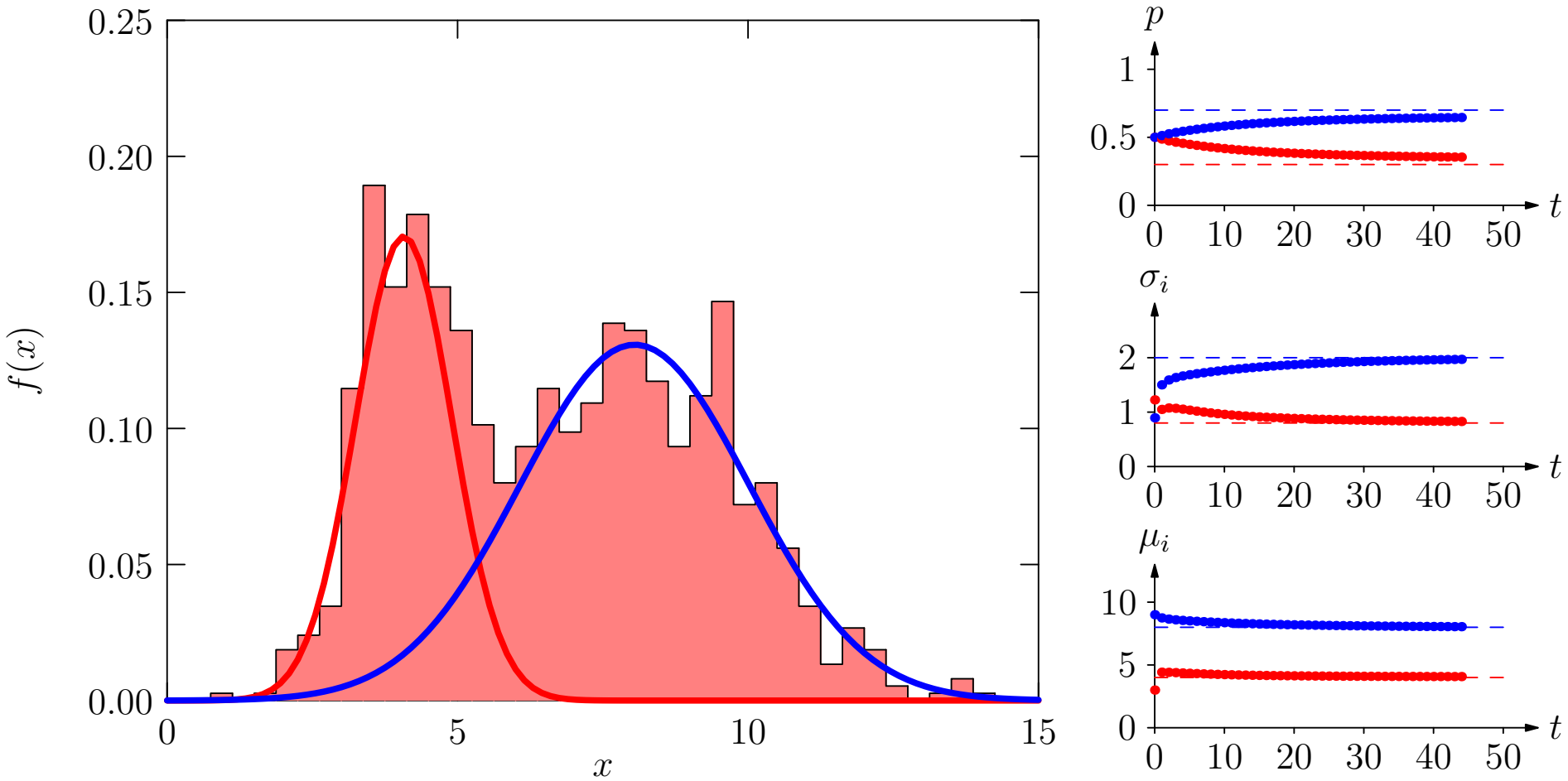
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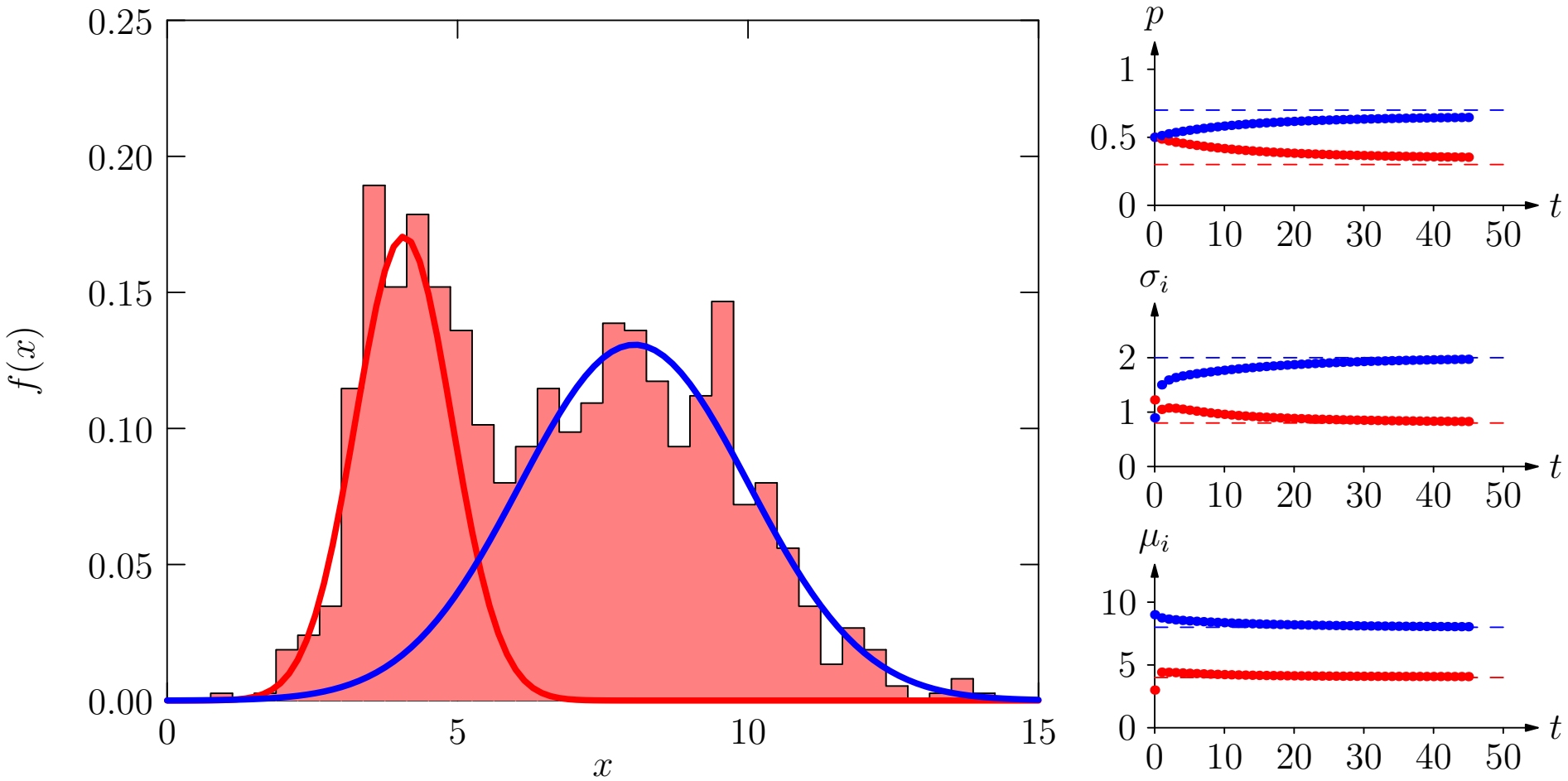
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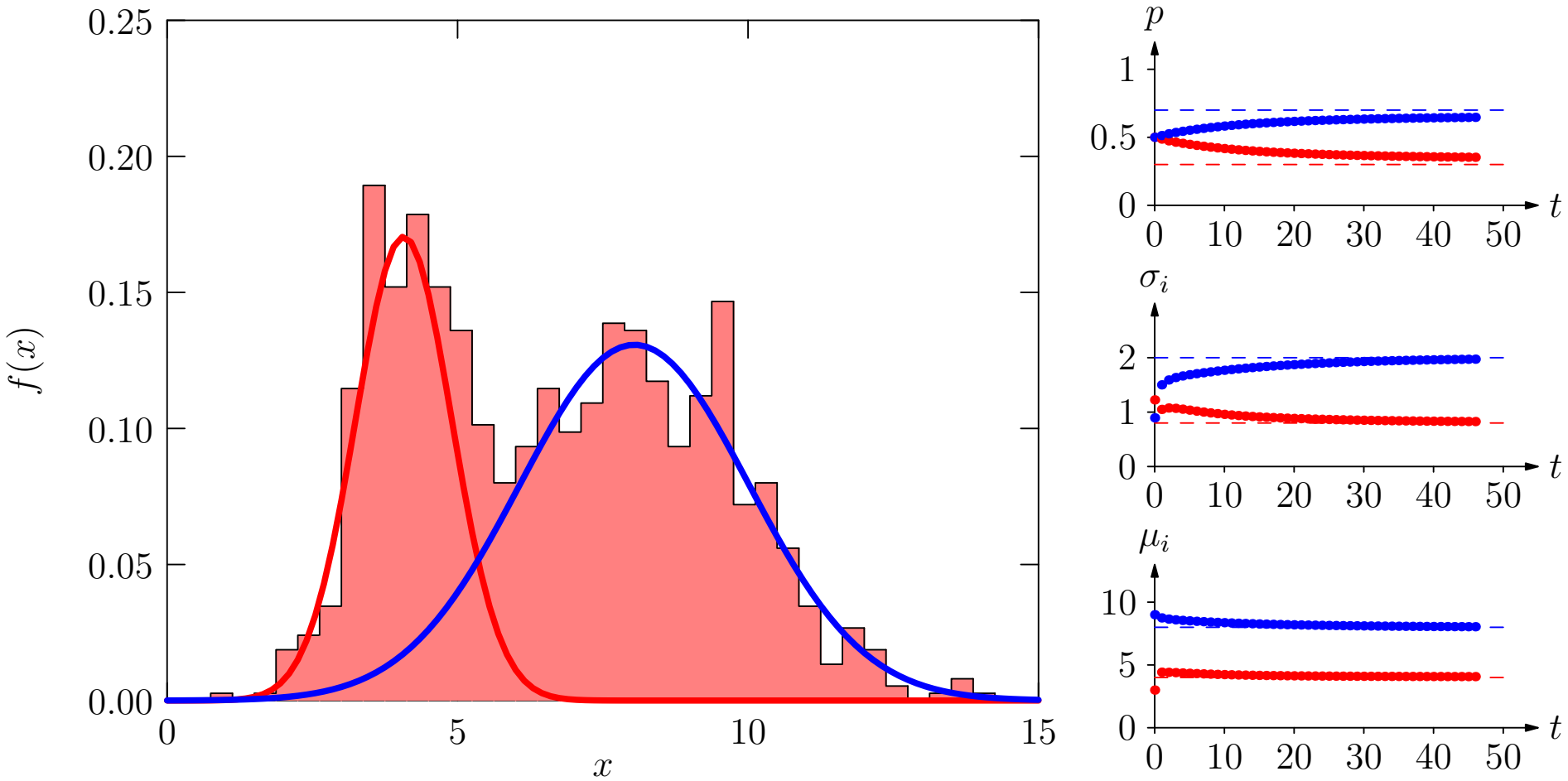
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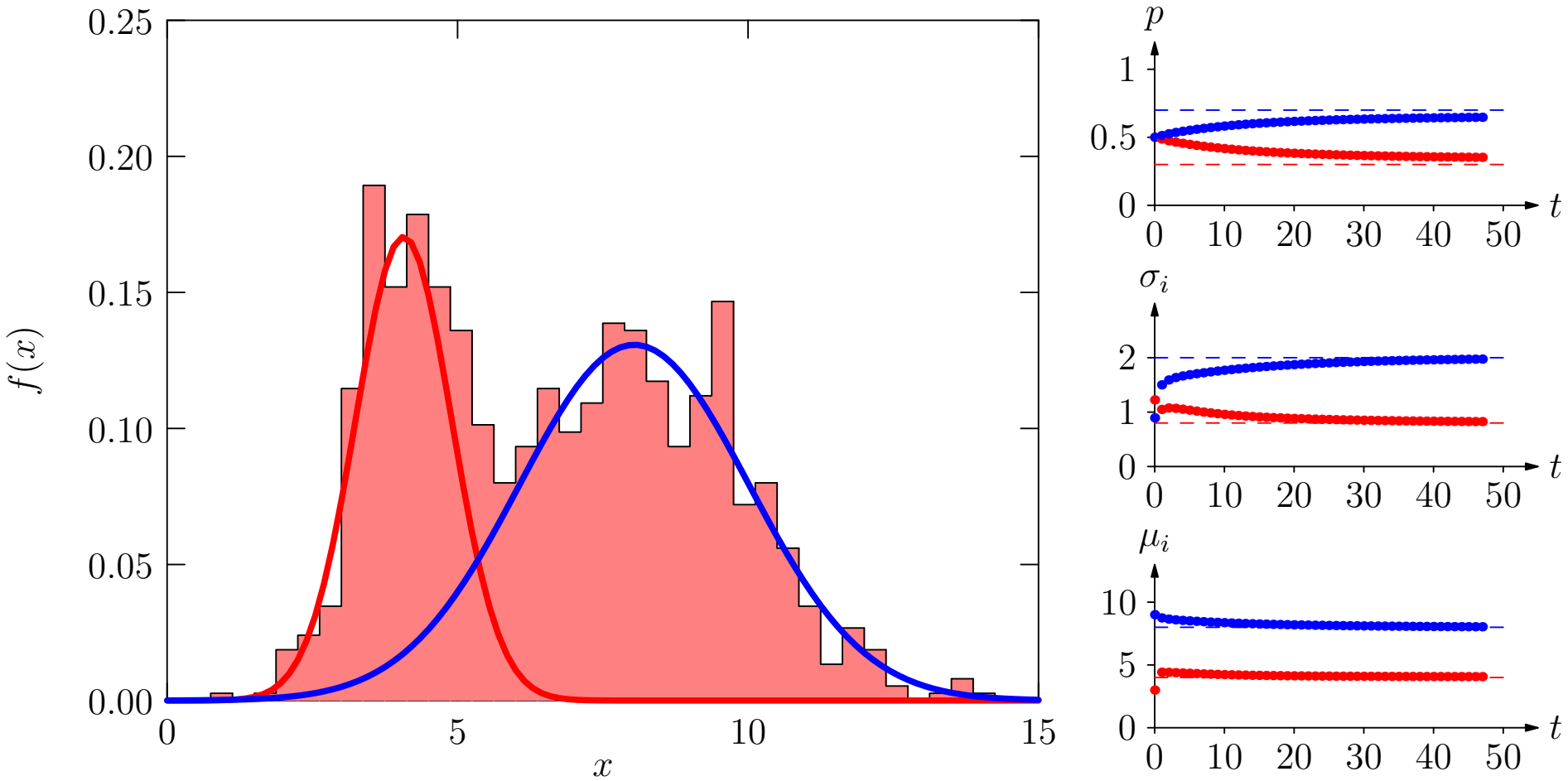
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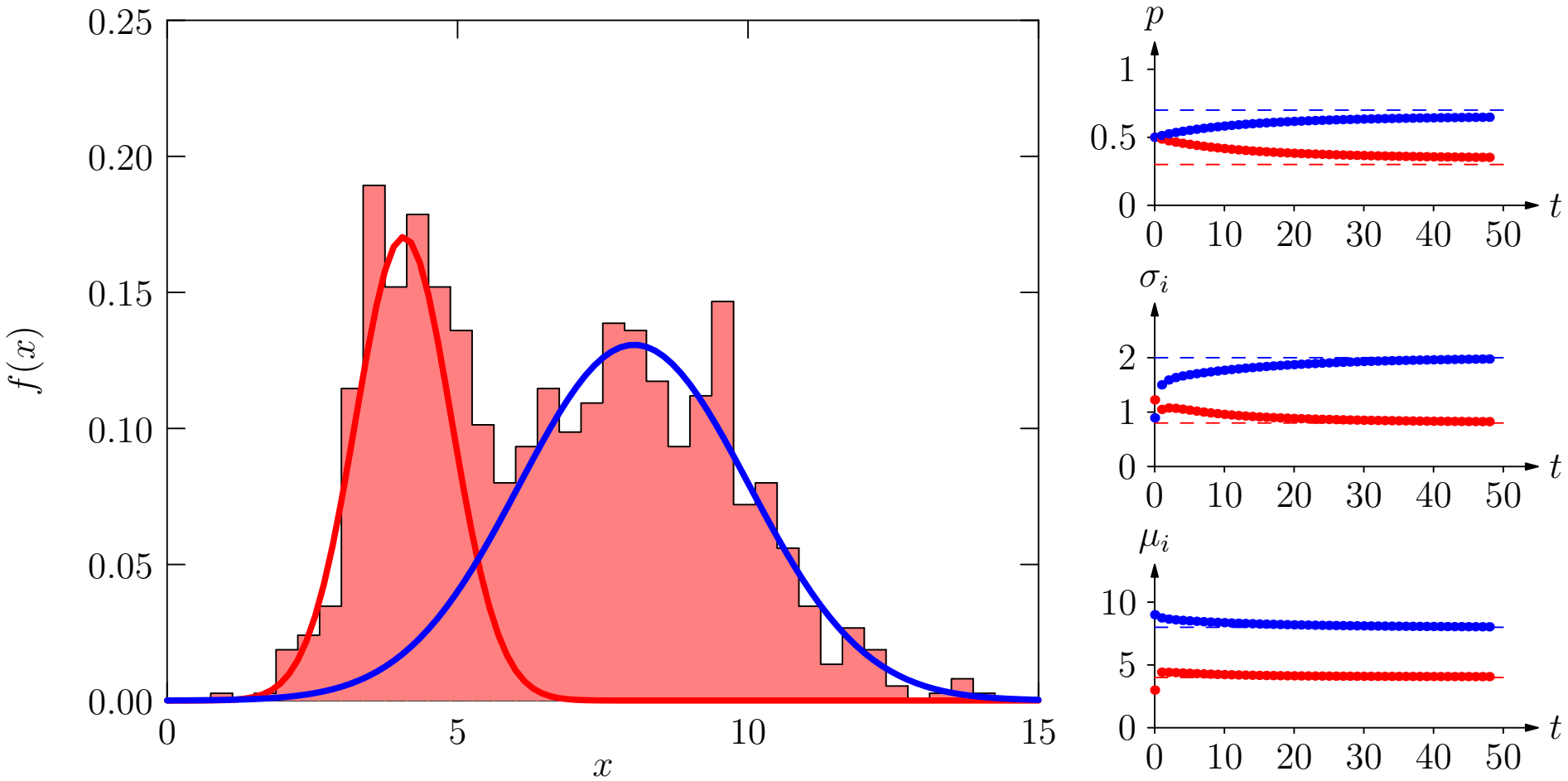
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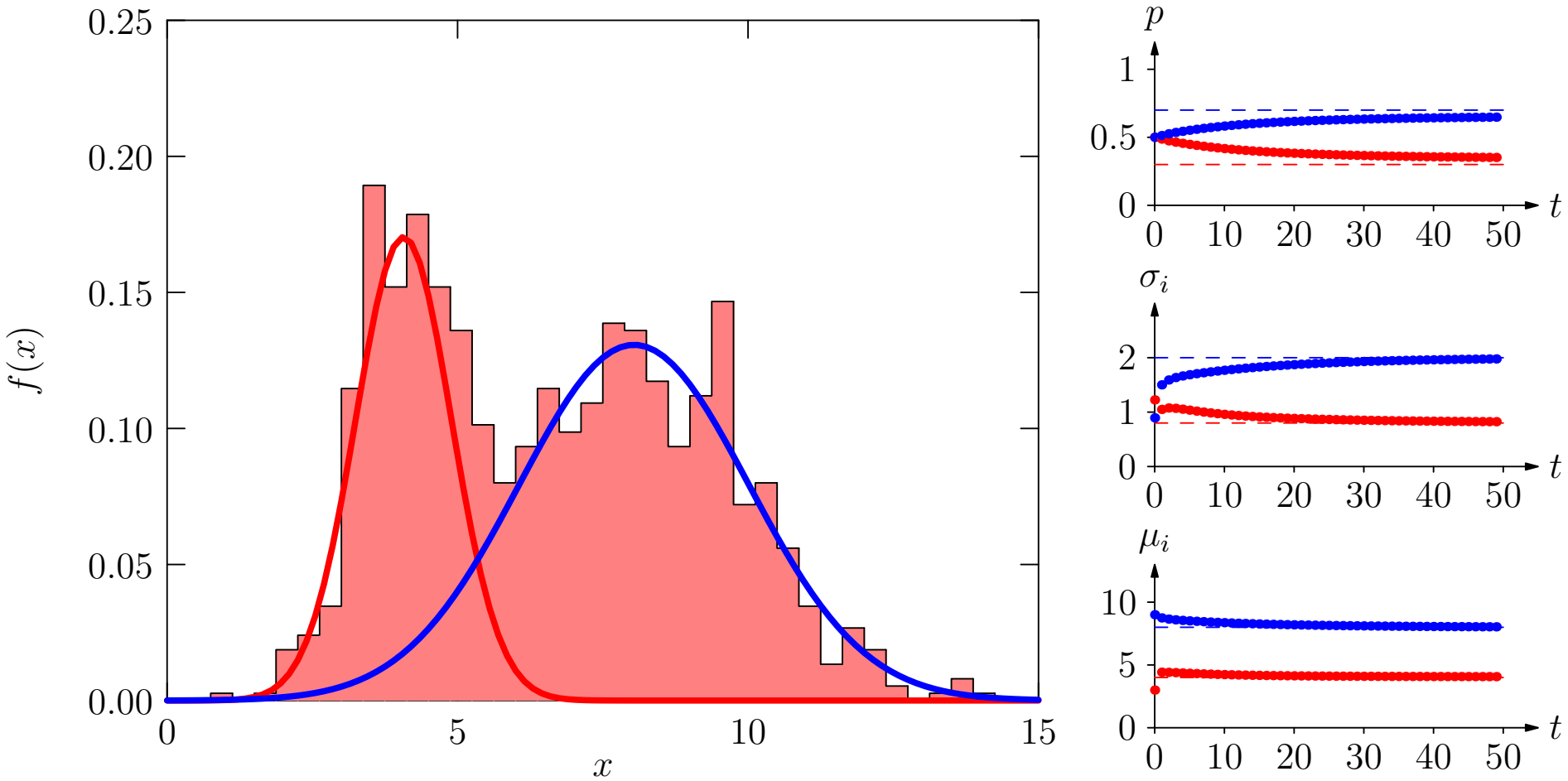
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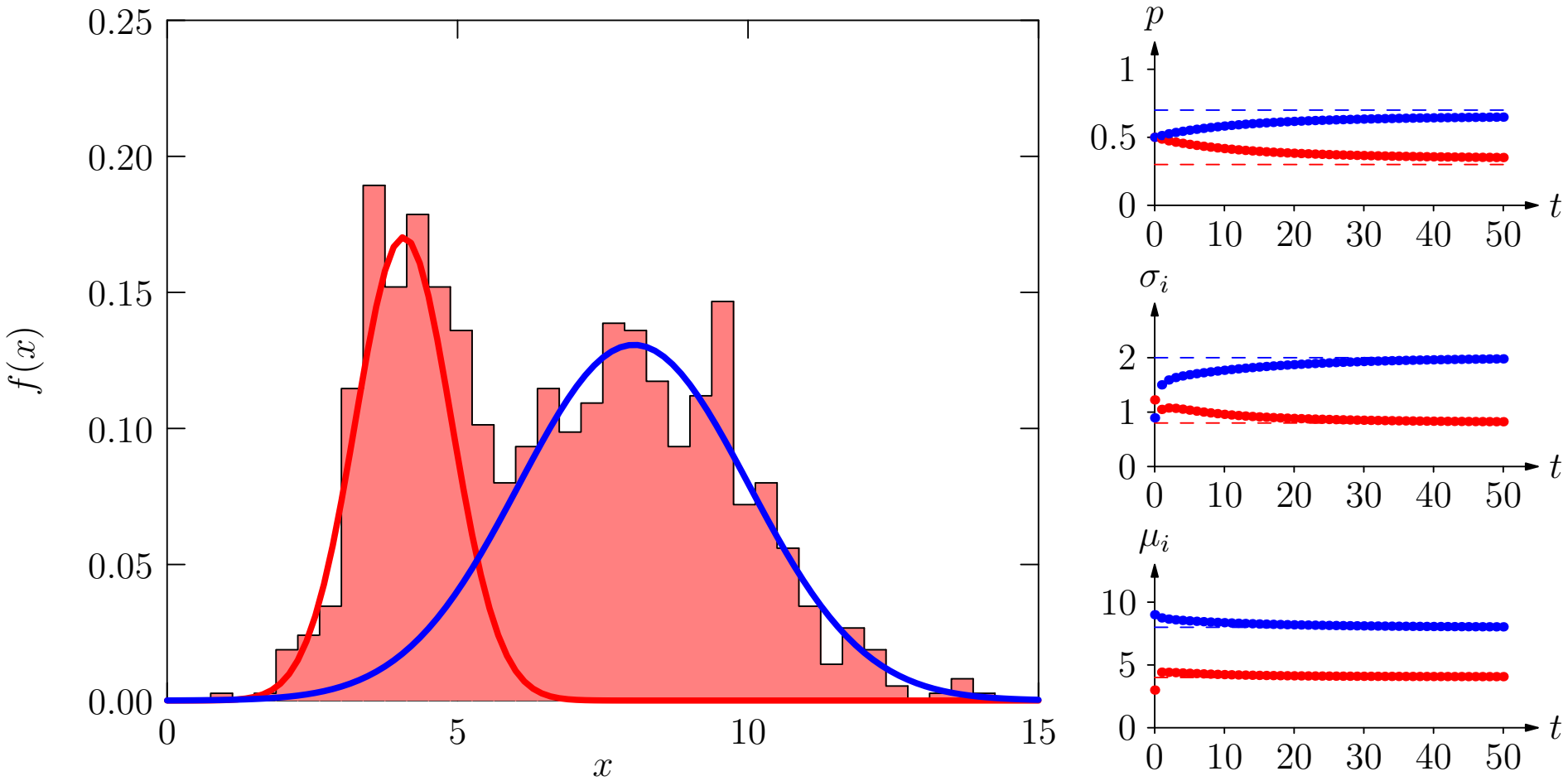
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EM in Practice

- With equal, fixed variances and $\sigma \to 0$ the responsibilities become 0 or 1: EM becomes k-means
- EM finds a local maximum: run it from several starts
- A component can collapse onto a single point ($\sigma \to 0$, likelihood $\to \infty$)
- Convergence can be slow when the components overlap (the latent variables are very uncertain)
- Simple updates, no step size, and it works for any model with latent variables (missing data, hidden Markov models, . . .)

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Summary

- Build a model by writing down how the data were generated: a generative story or graphical model
- Hierarchical models let similar groups share strength (shrinkage)
- Beyond conjugate priors there is a ladder of strategies: ML, MAP, empirical Bayes, EM, full Bayes with MCMC
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